The word concerning

Samuel, Saul and David

Comprising the text of the parts of scripture traditionally called First Samuel, Second Samuel and part of the first two chapters of First Kings.

An English translation of original language text based on the so-called "Palestinian" family of Hebrew and Greek copies

Edited by

Glen Prideaux

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The word concerning
Samuel Saul and David
Comprising the text of the parts of scripture traditionally called First Samuel,
Second Samuel and part of the first two chapters of First Kings
with English translation of the Palestinian copies of the text

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https://github.com/GlenPrideaux/SSD

The word concerning
Samuel, Saul and David
Comprising the books commonly referred to in English Bibles as
First Samuel, Second Samuel and part of First Kings

Foreword

The Reason for this Edition

There are a number of copies of the various books that make up what is called in English the Bible. Some of these copies are faithful but some, sadly, are less so. Differences between copies can make it difficult to know which truly represent the Word of God. There are tests, however, which we can use to recognise the true word of God. These are the tests that God has given for his people to use to discern if a person who claims to speak in His name does so truly or not.

For the Hebrew scriptures (the Law, the Prophets and the Writings), the 'standard' copies go by the name the "Masoretic" Text, or MT for short. These are the copies that virtually all English translations are based on, and many other translations, too. When Jerome translated the Latin Vulgate in the late 4th century he did so from the MT copies that had been provided to him by Jewish scholars. For most of the Hebrew scriptures, these copies can be shown to be substantially faithful and correct. However, that is not the case with the Word concerning Samuel and Kings Saul and David comprising the books that go by the names of First and Second Samuel and a little of First Kings. Here it can be shown that these 'standard' copies again and again fail the test of faithfulness. In some places the standard copies are virtually incomprehensible and in others they contradict other teachings of scriptures. Fortunately, this family of copies is not all we have. There exists a family of Hebrew and Greek copies that are sometimes called the "Palestinian" copies. These copies include the "Lucianic" Greek copies and the Hebrew Dead Sea Scrolls of Samuel, particularly that called 4Q51, also called 4QSam[a]. For the more obvious errors or omissions, many English translations will fill the gap with the reading from the Palestinian copies, but many remain uncorrected. The table below lists a few of the differences between the Palestinian and Masoretic copies with evidence for the reliability of the former over the latter.

Ref.	Palestinian text	Masoretic Text	Note
1 Sam 13:1	he reigned forty years	he reigned two years	Compare Acts 13:21.
1 Sam 13:1	Saul was thirty years old	Saul was years old	The number is omitted in the MT
1 Sam 13:8	a donkey loaded with an omer of bread	a donkey of bread	English translations will usually interpolate where the MT makes no sense.
1 Sam 18:27	a hundred men	two hundred men	Compare 2 Sam 3:14
2 Sam 8:4	1,000 chariots and 7,000 horsemen	one thousand seven hundred horsemen	Compare 1 Chr 18:4
2 Sam 8:13	18,000 Edomites	eighteen thousand men of the Syrians	Syrians (Arameans) is similar in Hebrew to Edomites. Compare 1 Chr 18:21
2 Sam 15:7	at the end of four years	At the end of forty years	Compare 1 Kings 2:11, 1 Chr 3:1–4
2 Sam 21:8	five sons of Merab	five sons of Michal	Some English translations render the the Palestinian text here to avoid the obvious error in the MT. Compare 1 Sam 18:19, 2 Sam 6:23.

The Palestinian copies are not a really rare or unusual form of Samuel. It is the version quoted by Josephus and many so-called ante-Nicene fathers. But it is not easy to obtain in English, which is the reason for this edition. This edition is a translation into English of these more faithful copies of this part of scripture.The translation is based on the American Standard Version of 1901, adjusted to match the Palestinian copies and updated to more contemporary English. Despite best efforts, it is likely that there have been some (hopefully minor) differences between the Palestinian text and the ASV English that have been overlooked.

It is worth commenting on one particular type of difference between the families of copies. Where the Palestinian text includes names like Mephibaal (see 2 Sam 4:4, for example), the MT has Mephibosheth. The -bosheth suffix means 'shame' and this is clearly a scribal euphemism to avoid naming the Canaanite false god Baal. The corresponding names in Chronicles retain the -baal form that is seen in the Palestinian copies.

The Name of This Document

This edition contains all of what is traditionally called "First Samuel" and "Second Samuel", and two chapters of what is traditionally called "First Kings". These traditional names are somewhat misleading, particularly as the death of Samuel is recorded in the first part (25:1). Even the division into a 'first' and a 'second' book is somewhat arbitrary, as is the distinction between the books of 'Samuel' and the books of 'Kings'. (In the Greek Septuagint translation of the Hebrew scriptures, all four of the books of Samuel and Kings go by the name 'Βασιλειῶν,' that is, 'of Kingdoms.') I have called this document "The word concerning Samuel, Saul and David" as this is descriptive of the content.

In previous editons of my translation I tried to avoid using traditional names where they might be considered misleading. For instance, the books of the Law were all referred to as Moses with a Roman numeral to indicate which book was being referenced. In

this edition I have reversed that practice as making those references unnecessarily obscure to readers with less familiarity with the Bible. There are some footnotes that still retain this more particular approach to naming parts of scripture. References in footnotes to "first part" or "second part" refer to the parts of this document corresponding to 1 Samuel and 2 Samuel.

Verse and Chapter Divisions

Different editions use slightly different verse numbering systems. The reader should remember that these divisions are entirely arbitrary. This edition follows, as much as possible, the numbering system used in the majority of English language editions.

The chapter numbering of the third section follows the traditional numbering system which has "First Kings" commencing at that point. Some other editions count the text included there as chapters 25 and 26 (of "2 Samuel")

Principles of Translation

I have favoured a word-for-word approach in preparing my translation, translating the words and grammatical structures from the original language to English, but leaving the idioms and linguistic style untranslated. This jumps out at the reader from the very first word: 'And'—a word not generally used to begin an account! Indeed, the Hebrew conjunction וְ could have been reasonably translated with many different words ('now', 'so', 'but', etc.) or left out entirely where English usage does not require it, but I have sought to make this not only readable, but usable for study where details like the actual words used in the original may be of interest.

Text presented *in italics* represents text not found in the original language, but needed to make the English text understandable.

'You'—Singular/Plural Ambiguity

Sometimes it is not possible with modern English to distinguish between you (singular) and you (plural), even though the original language text is unambiguous. Wherever I have noticed that the English translation is ambiguous as to whether the word 'you' refers to one person or more than one I have resolved the ambiguity for the reader unobtrusively by using a single dagger for singular and a double dagger for plural, thus: you† (singular); you‡ (plural).

The Name of God

The name of God is rendered in the Palestinian translation as "the LORD". In some places this is used with the ordinary word "lord". Although unambiguous in print, when reading aloud one may choose to use "Jehovah" or "GOD" instead.

Acknowledgements

The translation of the reliable copies was inspired by and relies heavily on a manuscript comparison prepared by Evan Blackmore. Translation is loosely based on word choice and syntax of the American Standard Version 1901 but extensively updated to reduce the archaisms characteristic of the ASV, and with extensive reference to Hebrew and Greek texts.

Glen Prideaux
March 2026

Samuel, Saul and David, First part called First Samuel

Chapter 1

1:1 And there was a man of Ramathaim, a Zuphite of the hill-country of Ephraim, and his name was Elkanah, the son of Jerahmeel, the son of Elihu, the son of Toah, the son of Zuph, an Ephraimite. 2 And he had two wives; the name of one was Hannah, and the name of the other Peninnah, and Peninnah had children, and Hannah had no children. 3 And this man went up from his city from days to days to worship and to sacrifice to the Lord of hosts in Shiloh. And Eli and his two sons, Hophni and Phinehas, priests to the Lord, were there. 4 And when the day came that Elkanah sacrificed, he gave to Peninnah his wife, and to all her sons and her daughters, portions: 5 and he gave Hannah one portion[a] , because she had no child. However, he loved Hannah, and the Lord had shut up her womb. 6 And her rival provoked her greatly, to trouble her, because the Lord had shut up her womb. 7 And so he did year by year. When she went up to the house of the Lord, she provoked her thus; and she wept, and didn't eat. 8 And Elkanah her husband said to her, "Hannah"; and she said to him, "Here I am, my lord"; and he said to her, "Why do you weep, and why don't you eat, and why is your heart grieved? Am I not better than ten sons to you?"

1:9 And Hannah rose up after they had eaten in Shiloh and after they had drunk and stood before the Lord. And Eli the priest was sitting upon his seat by the door-post of the temple of the Lord. 10 And her soul was bitter, and she prayed to the Lord, and wept greatly. 11 And she made a vow, and said, "O Lord of hosts, if you will indeed look on the affliction of your handmaid, and remember me, and not forget your handmaid, and will give to your handmaid a seed of men, then I will give him as a Nazirite before you till the day of his death, and he will not drink wine or strong drink, and no razor will come upon his head."

1:12 And it happened as she multiplied praying before the Lord, that Eli observed her mouth. 13 And Hannah was speaking in her heart; only her lips moved, and her voice was not heard, and Eli thought she was drunk. 14 And Eli said to her, "How long will you be drunk? Put your wine away from you." 15 And Hannah answered and said, "No, my lord, I am a woman hard of day: I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, and I have poured out my soul before the Lord. 16 Don't count your handmaid as a daughter of belial[b] ; because I have lingered till now because of the abundance of my complaint and my provocation." 17 And Eli answered and said, "Go in peace; and may the God of Israel grant your request that you have asked from him." 18 And she said, "Let your handmaid find favour in your eyes." And the woman went her way, and when she came to the room, she ate with her husband and drank, and her face was no longer fallen.

1:19 And they rose up early in the morning, and worshipped before the Lord, and returned, and came to their house at Ramah. And Elkanah knew Hannah his wife; and the Lord remembered her. 20 And it happened when the time had come about, that Hannah conceived, and bore a son; and she called his name Samuel, "Because I have asked him of the Lord."

1:21 And the man Elkanah, and all his house, went up to offer the sacrifice of the days in Shiloh, and to redeem all his vows and all the tithes of his hand. 22 And Hannah didn't go up, because she said to her husband, "Until the child comes up when I have weaned him, that he may appear before the Lord, and stay there forever." 23 And Elkanah her husband said to her, "Do what is good in your eyes; wait until you have weaned him; only may the Lord confirm what goes forth from your mouth." And the woman waited and nursed her son until she weaned him. 24 And she went up when she had weaned him, with a three-year-old bull and bread and one ephah of meal, and a jug of wine. And she came to the house of the Lord in Shiloh, and the child was with them. 25 And they went before the Lord, and his father slaughtered the offering, as he did from year to year to the Lord; and she took the child, and he slaughtered the bull. And Hannah, the mother of the child, went to Eli. 26 And she said, "O my lord, as your soul lives, I am the woman that stood here by you, praying to the Lord. 27 I prayed for this child, and the Lord has given me my request that I asked of him: 28 so I have also given him to the Lord. As long as he lives he is given to the Lord." And he worshipped the Lord there.

Chapter 2

2:1 And Hannah prayed, and said:

"My heart exults in the Lord; my horn is exalted in my God;
my mouth is enlarged over my enemies.
I rejoice in your salvation for
2 there is no-one holy as the Lord,
for there is no-one righteous like our God, nor is there any rock
besides you.
3 Don't boast, and don't speak proudly;
don't let arrogance come out of your‡ mouth,
for the Lord is a God of knowledge, and a God who weighs his
actions[a] .
4 The bows of the mighty men are broken,
and those who stumbled are girded with strength.
5 Those who were full have hired out themselves for bread;
and those who were hungry have ceased.
Also, the barren has borne seven, and she who has many children
languishes.
6 The Lord kills and makes alive.
He brings down to Sheol, and brings up.

[a] 1:5: cf. Deuteronomy 21:15-17; Exodus 21:8,10.
[b] 1:16: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.
[a] 2:3: "Are not my actions weighed?", Ezekiel 18:29; 25; cf. Isaiah 40:13.

[7]The Lord makes poor and makes rich.
He brings low, he also lifts up.
[8]He raises up the poor out of the dust; he lifts up the needy from
the rubbish heap,
to make them sit with princes, and inherit the throne of glory.
For the pillars of the earth are the Lord's, and he has set the world
upon them.
[9]He will keep the feet of his holy ones, and the wicked will be put
to silence in darkness.
He gives his petition to the one who prays, and he blesses the years
of the righteous,
for no man will prevail by strength.
[10]The Lord shatters his adversaries. The Lord is holy.
The Lord has gone up in the heavens, and he has thundered.
He will judge the ends of the earth, and he will give strength to our
king, and exalt the horn of his anointed."
[2:11]And she left him there before the Lord, and went to Ramah. And the child ministered to the Lord before Eli the priest.
[2:12]And the sons of Eli were sons of belial[b] ; they didn't know the Lord, [13]and the custom of the priests with the people. When any man offered sacrifice, the priest's servant came while the flesh was boiling with a flesh-hook of three teeth in his hand, [14]and he thrust it into the pan, or kettle, or cauldron, or pot. All that the flesh-hook brought up the priest took for himself. So they did in Shiloh to all the Israelites that came to sacrifice to the Lord: [15]even before they burnt the fat, the priest's servant came, and said to the man that sacrificed, "Give flesh to roast for the priest; because he will not have boiled flesh from the pan from you." [16]And the man who was sacrificing said to him, "Let the fat be burnt first, and take as much as your soul desires," and he said, "No, for you must give it to me now, and if not, I will take it by force." [17]And the sin of the young men was very great before the Lord, for they despised the offering of the Lord.
[2:18]And Samuel ministered before the Lord, being a child, girded with a linen ephod. [19]And his mother made him a little robe, and brought it to him from days to days, when she came up with her husband to offer the sacrifice of the days. [20]And Eli blessed Elkanah and his wife, and said, "May the Lord repay you seed from this woman in place of the gift that you have given to the Lord." And the man went to his own place. [21]And the Lord visited Hannah, and she conceived, and bore three sons and two daughters. And the child Samuel grew before the Lord.
[2:22]And Eli was very old; and he heard what his sons did to the sons of Israel, and how they lay with the women who did service at the door of the tent of meeting. [23]And he said to them, "Why do you do such things that I hear being said of you from the mouth of the Lord's people? [24]No, my sons, for the report that I hear isn't good. Don't do this, for the reports that I hear are not good, so that the people don't serve God. [25]If one man sins against another, they may pray to the Lord for him, and if a man sins against the Lord, who will intercede for him?" However, they didn't listen to the voice of their father, because the Lord was minded to put them to death.
[2:26]And the child Samuel went on, and was good both with the Lord, and with men. [27]And a man of God came to Eli, and said, "Thus says the Lord, 'I revealed myself to the house of your father, when they were in Egypt, slaves to Pharaoh's house, [28]and I chose the house of your father out of all the tribes of Israel to serve me as priests, to go up to my altar, to burn incense, to wear an ephod before me, and I gave to the house of your father as food all the offerings of the children of Israel made by fire. [29]Why do you look at my sacrifice and at my offering with distress of eye[c] and honour your sons above me, to be blessed with the first of all the offerings of Israel before me?' [30]Therefore the Lord, the God of Israel, says, 'I said that your house, and the house of your father, should walk before me for ever;' and now the Lord says, 'Far be it from me; for those who honour me I will honour, and those who despise me will be lightly esteemed. [31]Behold, the days are coming when I will cut off your seed and the seed of your father's house, [32]and you will not have an old man in my house forever. [33]And one man of yours I will not cut off from my altar, to waste away his eyes and to pine away his soul; and all the increase of your house will fall by the swords of men. [34]And this will be the sign to you that will come upon your two sons, on Hophni and Phinehas: in one day both of them will die. [35]And I will raise up a faithful priest for myself who will do according to that which is in my heart and in my mind: and I will build him a faithful house; and he will walk before my anointed forever. [36]And it will happen that every one who is left in your house will come and bow down to him for a piece of silver and a loaf of bread, and say, "Please put me into one of the priests' offices, so that I may eat a morsel of bread.'"

Chapter 3

[3:1]And the child Samuel ministered to the Lord before Eli. And the word of the Lord was precious in those days; no vision spread abroad.
[3:2]And it happened at that time, when Eli had laid down in his place (and his eyes had begun to grow dim; he couldn't see), [3]and the lamp of God hadn't yet gone out, and Samuel had laid down in the temple of the Lord, where the ark of God was, [4]that the Lord called and said, "Samuel, Samuel"; and he said, "Here I am." [5]And he ran to Eli, and said, "Here I am, for you called me." And he said, "I didn't call; lie down again." And he went and lay down. [6]And the Lord called yet again, "Samuel, Samuel." And he rose and went to Eli, and said, "Here I am, for you called me." And he answered, "I didn't call, my son; lie down again." [7]And Samuel didn't yet know God, neither had the word of the Lord been revealed to him yet. [8]And the Lord called Samuel again the third time. And he rose and went to Eli, and said, "Here I am; for you called me." And Eli perceived that the Lord had called the child, [9]and Eli said to Samuel, "Go, lie down: and it will be, if

[b]2:12: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.
[c]2:29: cf. first part 18:9; Genesis 42:21.

he calls you, that you will say, 'Speak, Lord; for your servant hears.'" And Samuel went and lay down in his place.

3:10 And the Lord came, and stood and called as at other times, "Samuel, Samuel." And Samuel said, "Speak; for your servant hears." 11 And the Lord said to Samuel, "Behold, I will do a thing in Israel, at which both the ears of every one who hears it will tingle. 12 In that day I will raise up against Eli all that I have spoken concerning his house, from the beginning even to the end. 13 For I have told him that I will judge his house forever, for the iniquity of his sons, because his sons spoke evil against God, and he didn't dim them. 14 And not so; I have promised to the house of Eli, that the iniquity of Eli's house will not be expiated with sacrifice nor offering forever."

3:15 And Samuel lay until the morning, and rose early in the morning, and opened the doors of the house of the Lord. And Samuel feared to show Eli the vision. 16 And Eli called Samuel, and said, "Samuel, my son." And he said, "Here I am." 17 And he said, "What is the word which he has spoken to you? Please don't hide it from me: God do so to you, and more also, if you hide anything from me of all the things that he spoke to you in your ears." 18 And Samuel told him every word, and hid nothing from him. And he said, "It is the Lord: let him do what is good in his eyes." 19 And Samuel grew, and the Lord was with him, and let none of his words fall to the ground. 20 And all Israel from Dan even to Beer-sheba knew that Samuel was faithful as a prophet of the Lord. 21 And the Lord appeared again in Shiloh; for the Lord revealed himself to Samuel. And Samuel was faithful as a prophet of the Lord to all Israel from one end of the land to the other. And Eli was very old, and his sons kept going on, and their way was evil before the Lord.

Chapter 4

4:1 And in those days the Philistines gathered against Israel to make war; and Israel went out to meet them in battle, and camped beside Eben-ezer: and the Philistines camped in Aphek. 2 And the Philistines put themselves in array against Israel: and the battle turned, and Israel was struck before the Philistines; and they killed about four thousand men of the army in the field.

4:3 And when the people had come into the camp, the elders of Israel said, "Why has the Lord struck us today before the Philistines? Let us bring the ark of our God to us from Shiloh, that it may come among us, and save us out of the hand of our enemies." 4 And the people sent to Shiloh; and they brought the ark of the covenant of the Lord of hosts, who sits *above* the cherubim, from there: and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there with the ark of the covenant of God. 5 And when the ark of the covenant of the Lord came into the camp, all Israel shouted with a great shout, and the earth resounded. 6 And when the Philistines heard the shout, they said, "What is this great shout in the camp of the Hebrews?" And they understood that the ark of the Lord had come into the camp. 7 And the Philistines were afraid, and they said, "These are the gods that have come to them into the camp." And they said, "Woe to us! For no such thing has happened previously[a] . 8 Woe to us! Who will deliver us out of the hand of these mighty gods? These are the gods that struck the Egyptians with all kinds of plagues, and in the wilderness. 9 Be strong, and be men, O Philistines, that you may not be servants to the Hebrews, as they have been to you: be men, and fight them." 10 And the Philistines fought them, and Israel was struck, and they fled every man to his tent: and there was a very great slaughter; for there fell 30,000 foot soldiers of Israel. 11 And the ark of God was taken; and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were killed.

4:12 And a man of Benjamin ran out of the army, and came to Shiloh the same day, with his clothes torn, and with earth on his head. 13 And when he came, behold, Eli was sitting on the seat by the gate, watching the road; for his heart trembled for the ark of God. And when the man came into the city, and told it, all the city cried out. 14 And when Eli heard the sound of the crying, he said, "What is the sound of this crying?" And the man hurried, and came and told Eli. 15 And Eli was ninety eight years old; and his eyes were set, and he couldn't see. And Eli said to those who were standing around him, What is the sound of this tumult? 16 And the man said to Eli, "I am the one who came out of the army, and I fled today out of the army." And he said, "How did it go, my son?" 17 And the one who brought the news answered and said, "Israel has fled before the Philistines, and there has also been a great slaughter among the people, and your two sons also are dead, and the ark of God is taken." 18 And it happened, when he made mention of the ark of God, that he fell backwards off his seat by the side of the gate; and his neck broke, and he died: for he was an old man, and heavy. And he had judged Israel twenty years.

4:19 And his daughter-in-law, Phinehas' wife, was with child, about to give birth: and when she heard the news that the ark of God was taken, and that her father-in-law and her husband were dead, she bowed herself and gave birth, for her pains came upon her. 20 And when her time came, she was about to die, and the women that stood by her said to her, "Don't be afraid, for you have given birth to a son." And she neither answered nor paid attention. 21 And she named the child Ichabod[b] , because of the ark of God, and because of her father-in-law and her husband. 22 And she said, "The glory of Israel departed when the ark of God was taken."

Chapter 5

5:1 And the Philistines had taken the ark of God, and they brought it from Eben-ezer to Ashdod. 2 And the Philistines took it and brought it into the house of Dagon, and set it by Dagon. 3 And when the people of Ashdod rose early the next day, behold, Dagon had fallen on his face to the ground before the ark of the Lord. And they raised Dagon up, and set him in his place again. 4 And when they arose early on the next morning, behold, Dagon had fallen on his face to the ground before the ark of the Lord; and the head of Dagon and both the soles of his feet were cut off on the threshold, and both the palms of his hands were fallen on the threshold; only the back of Dagon was left to him. 5 Therefore neither the priests of Dagon nor anyone who comes into Dagon's house tread on the threshold of Dagon in Ashdod to this day, for they leap

[a] 4:7: Hebrew: yesterday and the third day.
[b] 4:21: The name means "Woe to the glory".

over it.

5:6 And the hand of the Lord was heavy on the people
of Ashdod, and he destroyed them, and struck them with
swellings, Ashdod and its borders. And he brought mice on
them, and they swarmed in their ships, and mice went up into
their land; and there was a deadly confusion in the city. 7 And
when the men of Ashdod saw that it was so, they said, "The
ark of God will not stay with us; for his hand is hard on us, and
on Dagon our god." 8 And they sent and gathered all the lords
of the Philistines to them, and said, "What will we do with the
ark of the God of Israel?" And they answered, "Let the ark of
the God of Israel be carried around to us." And the ark of
God was brought to Gath. 9 And it happened that after it was
brought to Gath, the hand of the Lord was against the city
with a very great turmoil: and he struck the men of the city,
both small and great with swellings. 10 And the men of Gath
made golden swellings for themselves; and mice swarmed
among them. And they sent the ark of God to Ekron. And
it happened, as the ark of God came to Ekron, that the Ekro-
nites cried out, saying, "Why have you brought the ark of the
God of Israel around to us, to kill us and our people?" 11 And
they sent and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines,
and they said, "Send away the ark of the God of Israel, and let
it go to its own place again, that it may not kill us and our peo-
ple." For there was a deadly turmoil throughout all the city,
when the ark of God came there. 12 And the men that lived,
and didn't die, were struck with the swellings; and the cry of
the city went up to heaven.

Chapter 6

6:1 And the ark of the Lord was in the country of the
Philistines seven months; and their land swarmed with mice.
2 And the Philistines called for the priests and the diviners, say-
ing, "What will we do with the ark of the Lord? Show us with
what to send it to its place." 3 And they said, "If you send away
the ark of the covenant of the Lord, the God of Israel, don't
send it empty, for by all means return him a guilt offering:
then you will be healed, and atonement will be made for you.
Why should his hand not be removed from you?" 4 And they
said, "What will be the guilt offering which we will return to
him?" And they said, "Five golden swellings, the number of
the lords of the Philistines; for one plague was on you, and on
your lords, and on the people. 5 And you will make images of
your swellings, and images of your mice that destroy the land;
and you will give glory to the Lord, the God of Israel: perhaps
he will lighten his hand from you, and from your gods, and
from your land. 6 And why do you harden your hearts, as the
Egyptians and Pharaoh hardened their hearts? When he had
mocked among them, didn't they let the people go, and they
departed? 7 And now take and prepare a new cart, and two
milk cows without their calves; and hitch the cows to the cart,
and bring their calves home, away from them; 8 and take the
ark of the Lord, and place it on the cart; and put the articles
of gold, which you are returning to him for a guilt offering, in
a box by its side; and send it away, and it will go. 9 And watch;
if it goes up by the way of its own border to Beth-shemesh, he
has done us this great evil: and if not, then we will know that
it isn't his hand that struck us; it was a chance that happened
to us.

6:10 And the men did so, and took two milk cows and tied
them to the cart, and shut up their calves at home; 11 and they
put the ark of the Lord on the cart, and the mice of gold, and
the swellings of gold; and they put the box by its side. 12 And
the cows took the straight way by the way to Beth-shemesh;
they went along the highway, mooing as they went, and didn't
turn aside to the right hand or to the left; and the lords of the
Philistines went after them to the border of Beth-shemesh.

6:13 And *the people of* Beth-shemesh were reaping their
wheat harvest in the valley; and they lifted up their eyes, and
saw the ark, and rejoiced to meet it. 14 And the cart came into
the field of Joshua the Beth-shemite, and stood there, beside a
great stone: and they split the wood of the cart, and offered up
the cows for a burnt offering to the Lord. 15 And the Levites
took down the ark of the Lord, and the box that was with
it, which had the articles of gold in it, and put them on the
great stone: and the men of Beth-shemesh offered burnt offer-
ings and sacrificed sacrifices the same day to the Lord. 16 And
when the five lords of the Philistines had seen it, they returned
to Ekron the same day. 17 And these are the golden swellings
which the Philistines returned for a guilt offering to the Lord:
one for Ashdod, one for Gaza, one for Ashkelon, one for Gath,
one for Ekron; 18 and the golden mice, according to the num-
ber of all the cities of the Philistines belonging to the five lords,
both of fortified cities and of country villages. And the great
stone upon which they set down the ark of the Lord is to this
day in the field of Joshua the Beth-shemite.

6:19 And the sons of Jechoniah didn't rejoice with the men
of Beth-shemesh, when they saw the ark of the Lord; and
he struck down 70 men of them. And the people mourned,
because the Lord had struck the people with a great slaugh-
ter. 20 And the men of Beth-shemesh said, "Who is able to
stand before the Lord, this holy God? And who will the ark
of the Lord go up to from us?" 21 And they sent messengers
to the inhabitants of Kiriath-jearim, saying, "The Philistines
have brought back the ark of the Lord; come down, and take
it up to you."

Chapter 7

7:1 And the men of Kiriath-jearim came, and fetched up
the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and brought it into the
house of Abinadab in the hill, and sanctified Eleazar his son
to keep the ark of the covenant of the Lord. 2 And it happened,
from the day that the ark stayed in Kiriath-jearim that the time
was long; for it was twenty years: and all the house of Israel
turned after the Lord. 3 And Samuel spoke to all the house
of Israel, saying, "If you are returning to the Lord with all
your heart, put away the foreign gods and the Asherim[a] from
among you, and direct your hearts to the Lord, and serve him
only; and he will deliver you out of the hand of the Philistines."
4 And the children of Israel did put away the Masters[b] and the
Ashtaroth[c] , and served the Lord only. 5 And Samuel said,
"Gather all Israel to Mizpah, and I will pray to the Lord for

[a] 7:3: Or, groves. The word in Hebrew is plural of Asherah, usually identified with a Canaanite fertility goddess.

[b] 7:4: The Hebrew word is Baalim, plural of Baal. It is probably intended as a proper noun here referring to the chief Canaanite god, but the word is identical with the common noun 'master'.

[c] 7:4: Ashtaroth is plural of Ashtoreth, the name of a Canaanite goddess supposedly associated with the moon and fertility.

you." [6]And they gathered together to Mizpah, and drew water, and poured it out before the Lord, and fasted on that day, and said there, "We have sinned against the Lord." And Samuel judged the children of Israel in Mizpah.

[7:7]And when the Philistines heard that the children of Israel were gathered together to Mizpah, the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel. And when the children of Israel heard it, they were afraid of the Philistines. [8]And the children of Israel said to Samuel, "Don't stop crying to the Lord our God for us, that he will save us out of the hand of the Philistines." [9]And Samuel took a sucking lamb, and offered it for a whole burnt offering to the Lord: and Samuel cried to the Lord for Israel; and the Lord answered him. [10]And as Samuel was offering up the burnt offering, the Philistines drew near to battle against Israel; and the Lord thundered on the Philistines with a great thunder on that day, and crushed them; and they were struck down before Israel. [11]And the men of Israel went out of Mizpah, and pursued the Philistines, and struck them, until they came below Beth-car.

[7:12]And Samuel took a stone, and set it between Mizpah and Jeshanah, and named it the Help Stone, saying, "The Lord has helped us this far." [13]And the Lord subdued the Philistines, and they didn't come within the border of Israel any more: and the hand of the Lord was against the Philistines all the days of Samuel. [14]And the cities which the Philistines had taken from Israel were restored to Israel, from Ekron even to Gath; and they delivered their border out of the hand of the Philistines. And there was peace between Israel and the Amorites. [15]And Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life. [16]And he went from year to year in circuit to Bethel, and Gilgal, and Mizpah; and he judged Israel in all those places. [17]And his return was to Ramah, for his house was there; and there he judged Israel: and he built there an altar to the Lord.

Chapter 8

[8:1]And it happened, when Samuel was old, that he made his sons judges over Israel. [2]And these were the names of his sons: the first-born was Joel; and the name of his second, Abijah: they were judges in Beer-sheba. [3]And his sons didn't walk in his way, and turned aside after profit, and took bribes, and perverted justice. [4]And the men of Israel gathered themselves together, and came to Samuel at Ramah; [5]and they said to him, "Behold, you are old, and your sons don't walk in your way: and now make us a king to judge us like all the nations." [6]And the thing was evil in the eyes of Samuel, when they said, "Give us a king to judge us." And Samuel prayed to the Lord.

[8:7]And the Lord said to Samuel, "Listen to the voice of the people in all that they say to you; for they haven't rejected you, for they have rejected me, that I should not be king over them. [8]According to all the works which they have done since the day that I brought them up out of Egypt even to this day, in that they have forsaken me, and served other gods, so they also do to you. [9]And now listen to their voice: however you will testify to them, and you will show them the justice of the king that will reign over them.

[8:10]And Samuel told all the words of the Lord to the people that asked him for a king. [11]And he said, "This will be the justice of the king who will reign over you: he will take your sons, and appoint them to himself, for his chariots, and to be his horsemen; and they will run before his chariots; [12]and he will appoint them to himself for captains of thousands, and captains of hundreds, and to plough his ground, and to reap his harvest, and to gather his grapes, and to make his instruments of war, and the instruments of his chariots. [13]And he will take your daughters to be perfumers, and to be cooks, and to be bakers. [14]And he will take your fields, and your vineyards, and your olive groves, even the best of them, and give them to his servants. [15]And he will take the tenth of your seed, and of your vineyards, and give to his officers, and to his servants. [16]And he will take your men-servants, and your maid-servants, and your best cattle, and your donkeys, and tithe them for his work. [17]And he will take the tenth of your flocks: and you will be his servants. [18]And you will cry out in that day from before the face of your king you will have chosen for yourselves; and the Lord will not answer you in those days, because you have chosen a king for yourselves.

[8:19]And the people refused to listen to the voice of Samuel; and they said, "No, for we will have a king over us, [20]that we also may be like all the nations, and that our king may judge us, and go out before us, and fight our battles." [21]And Samuel heard all the words of the people, and he spoke them in the ears of the Lord. [22]And the Lord said to Samuel, "Listen to their voice, and make a king to reign over them." And Samuel said to the men of Israel, "Every man go to his city."

Chapter 9

[9:1]And there was a man of the children of Benjamin, whose name was Kish, the son of Abiel, the son of Zeror, the son of Bakir, the son of Aphiah, the son of a Benjamite, a mighty man of valour. [2]And he had a son, whose name was Saul, a young and good man, and there wasn't a better person than he among the children of Israel: from his shoulders and upward he was taller than any of the people.

[9:3]And some of the donkeys of Kish, Saul's father, were lost. And Kish said to Saul his son, "Take now one of the servants with you, and rise, go and look for the donkeys." And Saul rose, and took one of his father's servants with him, and went to look for the donkeys of Kish his father. [4]And they passed through the hill-country of Ephraim, and passed through the land of Shalishah, and they didn't find them: and they passed through the land of Shaalim, and they weren't there: and they passed through the land of Jabin, and they didn't find them.

[9:5]And they came to the land of Zuph, and Saul said to his servant who was with him, "Come, and let us return, lest my father stop caring for the donkeys, and be anxious for us." [6]And he said to him, "Behold now, there is a man of God in this city, and he is a man that is held in honour; all that he says surely happens: now let us go there. Perhaps he can tell us about the journey we are on." [7]And Saul said to his servant who was with him, "And, behold, if we go, what will we bring the man, for the bread in our vessels has run out, and there is no present to bring to the man of God: what do we have?" [8]And the servant answered Saul again, and said, "Behold, I have in my hand a quarter of a shekel of silver: give that to the man of God, to tell us our way." [9](Before in Israel, when a man went to inquire of God, he said thus, "Come, and let us go to the seer;" for the people called a Prophet a Seer

before.) [10]And Saul said to his servant, "Your word is good;
come, let us go." And they went to the city where the man of
God was.

[9:11]As they went up the ascent to the city, they found young
maidens going out to draw water, and said to them, "Is the
seer here?" [12]And they answered them, and said, "He is; be-
hold, *he is* before you: now he has come, today, into the city;
for the people have a sacrifice today in the high place. [13]As
soon as you have come into the city, you will find him straight
away, before he goes up to the high place to eat; for the peo-
ple will not eat until he comes, because he blesses the sacrifice;
and afterwards those who are invited eat. And now go up; for
you will find him at this time." [14]And they went up to the city.
As they came into the midst of the city, behold, Samuel came
out toward them, to go up to the high place.

[9:15]And the Lord had uncovered the ear of Samuel a day
before Saul came, saying, [16]"Tomorrow about this time I will
send you a man out of the land of Benjamin, and you will
anoint him to be prince over my people Israel; and he will
save my people out of the hand of the Philistines: for I have
seen the affliction of my people, because their cry has come
to me." [17]And when Samuel saw Saul, the Lord said to him,
"Behold, the man I spoke of to you! This one will have author-
ity over my people." [18]And Saul approached Samuel in the
midst of the city, and said, "Tell me, please, where the seer's
house is." [19]And Samuel answered Saul, and said, "I am he;
go up before me to the high place, for you will eat with me to-
day: and in the morning I will let you go, and will tell you all
that is in your heart. [20]And as for your donkeys that were lost
three days ago, don't set your mind on them; for they have
been found. And who are the treasures of Israel for? Aren't
they for you, and for all your father's house?" [21]And Saul an-
swered and said, "Am I not a Benjamite, of the smallest of the
tribes of Israel, and of the least family of all the tribe of Ben-
jamin? And why do you speak to me *a word* like this word?

[9:22]And Samuel took Saul and his servant, and brought
them into the guest-chamber, and made them sit in a place at
the head of those who were invited, who were about seventy
persons. [23]And Samuel said to the cook, "Bring the portion
which I gave you, of which I said to you, "Set it aside." [24]And
the cook took up the thigh, and that which was on it, and set it
before Saul. And Samuel said, "Behold, that which has been
reserved! Set it before you and eat; because it has been kept
from the people for you, until the appointed time. Break it."
And Saul ate with Samuel that day.

[9:25]And when they had come down from the high place
into the city, they spread a bed for Saul on the roof, and he
slept. [26]And it happened about daybreak, that Samuel called
to Saul on the roof, saying, "Get up, so I may send you on your
way." And Saul rose, and they both went out, he and Samuel.
[27]As they were going down at the end of the city, Samuel said
to Saul, "Bid the servant pass on before us, and you stand still
first, so I may make you hear the word of God."

Chapter 10

[10:1]And Samuel took the vial of oil, and poured it on his
head, and kissed him, and said, "Hasn't the Lord anointed
you to be prince over his people, over Israel? And you will
rule among the people of the Lord, and you will save them
from the hand of their enemies. [2]And this will be the sign to
you that the Lord has anointed you a ruler over his inheri-
tance: when you have departed from me today you will find
two men by Rachel's sepulchre, within the border of Benjamin,
rushing in the ascent; and they will say to you, 'The donkeys
which you went to look for have been found; and, behold, your
father has left off the matter[a] of the donkeys, and is anxious for
you, saying, "What will I do for my son?"' [3]And you will go
on from there and you will come to the oak of Tabor; and there
three men going up to God at Beth-el will meet you, one carry-
ing three kids, and another carrying three bags of bread, and
another carrying a bottle of wine: [4]and they will ask you of
your peace, and give you two wave offerings of bread, which
you will receive from their hand. [5]After that you will come to
the hill of God, where the garrison of the Philistines is. It will
happen when you have come to the city there, that you will
meet a band of prophets coming down from the high place
with a psaltery, and a timbrel, and a pipe, and a harp, before
them; and they will be prophesying: [6]and the Spirit of the
Lord will come on you mightily, and you will prophesy with
them, and you will be turned into another man. [7]And when
these signs have come to you, do what your hand finds for
you to do, for God is with you. [8]And you will go down before
me to Gilgal; and, behold, I will come down to you, to offer
burnt-offerings, and to sacrifice sacrifices of peace-offerings:
you will wait for seven days until I come to you and show you
what you will do."

[10:9]And it was so, that, when he had turned his back to
go from Samuel, God gave him another heart: and all those
signs happened that day. [10]And when they came from there
to the hill, behold, a band of prophets met him; and the Spirit
of God came mightily upon him, and he prophesied among
them. [11]And it happened that all who knew him previously[b]
saw that, behold, he prophesied with the prophets, and the
people said to one another, "What is this that has come to the
son of Kish? Is Saul also among the prophets?" [12]And one of
them answered and said, "And who is his father?" Therefore
it became a proverb, "Is Saul also among the prophets?

[10:13]And when he had finished prophesying, he came to
the hill. [14]And his uncle said to him and to his servant,
"Where did you go?" And he said, "To look for the don-
keys; and when we saw that they weren't found, we came
to Samuel." [15]And Saul's uncle said, "Please tell me what
Samuel said to you." [16]And Saul said to his uncle, "He told us
plainly that the donkeys were found." And he didn't tell him
about the word of the kingdom which Samuel had spoken of.

[10:17]And Samuel called the people together to the Lord at
Mizpah; [18]and he said to the children of Israel, "Thus says the
Lord, the God of Israel, "I brought up Israel out of Egypt, and
I saved you from the hand of the Egyptians, and from the hand
of all the kingdoms that oppressed you: [19]and today you have
rejected your God, who himself saves you from all your evils
and your distresses; and you have said, 'No, for you will set
a king over us.' And now present yourselves before the Lord
by your tribes, and by your families."

[10:20]And Samuel brought all the tribes of Israel near, and

[a]10:2: Hebrew: words.

[b]10:11: Hebrew, from yesterday and the third day.

the tribe of Benjamin was taken. [21]And he brought the tribe
of Benjamin near by their families; and the family of the Ma-
trites was taken; and he brought the family of Matri near, man
by man, and Saul the son of Kish was taken: and when they
looked for him, he couldn't be found. [22]And he asked fur-
ther of the Lord, "Has the man come here?" And the Lord
answered, "Behold, he has hidden himself among the bag-
gage." [23]And he ran and brought him from there, and he
stood among the people; and he was taller than any of the
people from his shoulders up. [24]And Samuel said to all the
people, "Do you see him who the Lord has chosen, that there
is none like him among you all?" And all the people shouted,
and said, "May the king live!"

[10:25]And Samuel told the people the justice of the kingdom,
and wrote it in a book, and placed it before the Lord. And
Samuel sent all the people away, and they went every man to
his place. [26]And Saul also went to his house to Gibeah; and the
sons of valour whose hearts God had touched went with Saul.
[27]And certain sons of belial[c] said, "How will this man save
us?" And they despised him, and brought him no present.

Chapter 11

[11:1]And Nahash, the king of the Ammonites, had been op-
pressing the sons of Gad and the sons of Reuben grievously,
and he put out the right eye of each of them, and allowed Is-
rael no deliverer; and no man of the sons of Israel who were
across the Jordan remained, whose right eye Nahash, king of
the Ammonites hadn't put out; and 7,000 men had escaped
from the Ammonites and entered into Jabesh-gilead. And
about a month later Nahash the Ammonite came up, and
camped against Jabesh-gilead: and all the men of Jabesh said
to Nahash, "Make a covenant with us, and we will serve you."
[2]And Nahash the Ammonite said to them, "I will make it with
you on this condition: that all your right eyes be put out; and
I will make it for a reproach on all Israel." [3]And the elders of
Jabesh said to him, "Give us seven days' respite, that we may
send messengers to all the borders of Israel; and if there is no
one to save us, then we will come out to you."

[11:4]And the messengers came to Gibeah of Saul, and spoke
these words in the ears of the people: and all the people lifted
up their voice, and wept. [5]And, behold, Saul came following
the oxen out of the field; and Saul said, "What is the matter
with the people, why do they weep?" And they told him the
words of the men of Jabesh. [6]And the Spirit of the Lord came
mightily on Saul when he heard those words, and his anger
was kindled greatly because of them. [7]And he took a yoke
of oxen, and cut them in pieces, and sent them throughout
all the borders of Israel by the hand of messengers, saying,
"Whoever doesn't come forth after Saul and after Samuel, so
will it be done to his oxen." And the dread of the Lord fell
on the people, and they came out as one man. [8]And he num-
bered them in Bezek at the high place; and the children of
Israel were 600,000, and the men of Judah 70,000.

[11:9]And he said to the messengers that had come, "Thus
you will say to the men of Jabesh, 'Tomorrow, by the time the
sun is hot, you will have deliverance.'" And the messengers
came and told the men of Jabesh; and they were glad. [10]And
the men of Jabesh said to Nahash the Ammonite, "Tomorrow
we will come out to you, and you will do with us all that is
good in your eyes." [11]And it happened on the next day, that
Saul put the people into three companies; and they came into
the midst of the camp in the morning watch, and struck the
Ammonites until the heat of the day: and it happened that
those who remained were scattered, and no two of them were
left together.

[11:12]And the people said to Samuel, "Who is the one who
said, 'Saul will not reign over us?' Bring the men, that we may
put them to death." [13]And Samuel said, "Not a man will be
put to death this day; for today the Lord has worked salvation
in Israel." [14]And Samuel said to the people, saying, "Come,
and let us go to Gilgal, and renew the kingdom there." [15]And
all the people went to Gilgal; and there Samuel anointed Saul
king before the Lord in Gilgal; and there they offered sacri-
fices of peace-offerings before the Lord; and Samuel and all
the men of Israel rejoiced greatly.

Chapter 12

[12:1]And Samuel said to all Israel, "Behold, I have listened
to your voice in all that you said to me, and have made a king
over you. [2]And now, behold, the king walks before you; and
I am old and grey headed; and, behold, my sons are with
you: and I have walked before you from my youth to this day.
[3]Here I am: answer against me before the Lord, and before
his anointed: whose ox have I taken, or whose donkey have
I taken, or who have I defrauded? Who have I oppressed, or
of whose hand have I taken a ransom or a pair of shoes[a] ? Ac-
cuse me and I will restore it to you." [4]And they said to Samuel,
"You haven't defrauded us, nor oppressed us, nor afflicted us,
neither have you taken anything from any man's hand." [5]And
he said to them, "The Lord is witness against you, and his
anointed is witness this day, that you haven't found anything
in my hand." And they said, "He is witness."

[12:6]And Samuel said to the people, "The Lord is witness,
who appointed Moses and Aaron, and who brought your fa-
thers up out of the land of Egypt. [7]And now stand still, that
I may judge you before the Lord, and I will recount for you
all the righteous acts of the Lord, which he did to you and
to your fathers, [8]as when Jacob and his sons had come into
Egypt, and the Egyptians oppressed them, and your fathers
cried to the Lord, and the Lord sent Moses and Aaron, and
he brought forth your fathers out of Egypt, and made them
to dwell in this place. [9]And they forgot the Lord their God;
and he sold them into the hand of Sisera, captain of the host of
Jabin king of Hazor, and into the hand of the Philistines, and
into the hand of the king of Moab; and they fought against
them. [10]And they cried to the Lord, and they said, 'We have
sinned, because we have forsaken the Lord, and have served
the Masters[b] and the Ashtaroth[c] : and now deliver us out of
the hand of our enemies, and we will serve you.' [11]And the
Lord sent Jerubbaal, and Barak, and Jephthah, and Samson,

[c]10:27: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.

[a]12:3: c.f. Amos 2:6; 8:6.

[b]12:10: The Hebrew word is Baalim, plural of Baal. It is probably intended as a proper noun here referring to the chief Canaanite god, but the word is identical with the common noun 'master'.

[c]12:10: Ashtaroth is plural of Ashtoreth, the name of a Canaanite goddess supposedly associated with the moon and fertility.

and delivered you out of the hand of your enemies on every side; and you lived in safety. [12]And when you saw that Nahash the king of the children of Ammon came against you, you said to me, 'No, for a king will reign over us.' [13]And now behold the king who you have chosen, and who you have asked for: and, behold, the Lord has set a king over you. [14]If you will fear the Lord, and serve him, and listen to his voice, and not rebel against the mouth of the Lord, and both you and also the king who reigns over you be followers of the Lord your God, then he will deliver you. [15]And if you will not listen to the voice of the Lord, and rebel against the mouth of the Lord, then the hand of the Lord will be against you and against your king to destroy you. [16]Also now stand still and see this great thing, which the Lord will do before your eyes. [17]Isn't it wheat harvest today? I will call to the Lord, that he may send thunder and rain; and you will know and see that your wickedness is great, which you have done in the eyes of the Lord, in asking for a king.

[12:18]And Samuel called to the Lord, and the Lord sent thunder and rain that day: and all the people greatly feared the Lord and Samuel. [19]And all the people said to Samuel, "Pray for your servants to the Lord your God, that we may not die; for we have added evil to all our sins, to ask for a king." [20]And Samuel said to the people, "Don't be afraid; you have indeed done all this evil, only don't turn aside from following the Lord, and serve the Lord with all your heart: [21]and don't turn aside after vain things which cannot profit or deliver, for they are vain. [22]For the Lord will not forsake his people for his great name's sake, because it has pleased the Lord to make you a people for himself. [23]And as for me, far be it from me that I should sin against the Lord in ceasing to pray for you: and I will serve the Lord and I will instruct you in the good and the right way. [24]Only fear the Lord, and serve him in truth with all your heart; for you have seen what great things he has done for you. [25]And if you still do evil, you will be consumed, both you and your king.

Chapter 13

[13:1]Saul was thirty years old when he began to reign; and he reigned forty years over Israel. [2]And Saul chose for himself 3,000 men of Israel; 2,000 of them were with Saul in Michmash and on the mount of Beth-el, and 1,000 were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin: and he sent each man of the rest of the people to his tent. [3]And Jonathan struck the garrison of the Philistines that was in Gibeah: and the Philistines heard of it. And Saul blew the trumpet throughout all the land, saying, "The slaves have rebelled." [4]And all Israel heard, saying "Saul has struck the garrison of the Philistines", and Israel was also had in abomination by the Philistines. And the people were gathered together to Gilgal after Saul.

[13:5]And the Philistines assembled themselves together to fight with Israel, and they brought up against Israel 3,000 chariots, and 6,000 horsemen, and people as the sand which is on the sea shore in multitude: and they came up, and camped in Michmash, eastward of Beth-horon. [6]And the men of Israel saw that they were oppressed and distressed, and the people hid themselves in caves, and in thickets, and in rocks, and in coverts, and in pits. [7]And they crossed the fords of the Jordan to the land of Gad and Gilead; and as for Saul, he was still in Gilgal, and all the people followed him trembling.

[13:8]And he waited seven days, according to the set time that Samuel had set: and Samuel didn't come to Gilgal; and the people were scattered from him. [9]And Saul said, "Bring the burnt offering here, and the peace offerings, so that I may offer them." And he offered the burnt offering. [10]And it happened that, as soon as he had finished offering the burnt offering, behold, Samuel came; and Saul went out to meet him, that he might bless him. [11]And Samuel said, "What have you done?" And Saul said, "Because I saw that the people were scattered from me, and that you didn't come within the set days, and that the Philistines assembled themselves together at Michmash; [12]and I said, "Now the Philistines will come down upon me to Gilgal, and I haven't entreated the favour of the Lord:" and I forced myself, and offered the burnt offering." [13]And Samuel said to Saul, "You have acted foolishly; you haven't kept my command which the Lord your God commanded you: for now the Lord would have established your kingdom upon Israel for ever. [14]And now your kingdom will not continue: the Lord has sought for himself a man after his own heart, and the Lord has appointed him to be prince over his people, because you haven't kept that which the Lord commanded you."

[13:15]And Samuel rose, and went from Gilgal, and the rest of the people went up after Saul to meet the army, and they went from Gilgal to Gibeah of Benjamin. And Saul numbered the people who were present with him, about 600 men. [16]And Saul and Jonathan his son and the people who were present with them stayed in Geba of Benjamin and they wept; and the Philistines camped in Michmash. [17]And the destroyers came out of the camp of the Philistines in three companies: one company turned to the way that leads to Ophrah, to the land of Shual; [18]and another company turned to the way to Beth-horon; and another company turned to the road of Geba that looks down on the valley of Zeboim.

[13:19]And there was no smith found throughout all the land of Israel; for the Philistines said, "So the Hebrews don't make swords or spears for themselves." [20]And all the Israelites went down to the land of the Philistines, each man to sharpen his ploughshare, his mattock, his axe, and his goad; [21]and there was a charge of a pim for sharpening the ploughshares and the mattocks; and three shekels for the forks and the axes, and for setting the goads. [22]And it happened in the days of the battle of Michmash, that there was neither sword nor spear found in the hand of any of the people who were with Saul and Jonathan (and they were found with Saul and with Jonathan his son). [23]And the garrison of the Philistines went out to the pass of Michmash.

Chapter 14

[14:1]And a day came when Jonathan the son of Saul said to the young man who bore his armour, "Come, and let us go over to the Philistines' garrison, that is on the other side." And he didn't tell his father. [2]And Saul stayed in the furthest part of Gibeah under the pomegranate-tree which is in Migron: and the people who were with him were about 600 men; [3]and Ahijah, the son of Ahitub, Ichabod's brother, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eli, the priest of the Lord in Shiloh, wearing an ephod. And the people didn't know that Jonathan had

gone. [4]And between the passes by which Jonathan sought to
go over to the Philistines' garrison there was a rocky crag on
the one side, and a rocky crag on the other side: and the name
of the one was Bozez, and the name of the other Seneh. [5]One
crag was on the north in front of Michmash, and the other on
the south in front of Geba.

[14:6]And Jonathan said to the young man who bore his armour, "Come, and let us go over to the garrison of these uncircumcised: it may be that the Lord will work for us; for the Lord isn't constrained to save by many or by few." [7]And his armour bearer said to him, "Do all that your heart desires: here I am with you; my heart is as your heart". [8]And Jonathan said, "Behold, we will pass over to the men, and we will show ourselves to them. [9]If they say to us, 'Wait until we come to you;' then we will stand still in our place, and will not go up to them. [10]And if they say, 'Come up to us;' then we will go up; for the Lord has delivered them into our hand: and this will be the sign to us." [11]And both of them showed themselves to the garrison of the Philistines: and the Philistines said, "Behold, the Hebrews come forth out of the holes where they had hidden themselves." [12]And the men of the garrison answered Jonathan and his armour bearer, and said, "Come up to us, and we will show you something." And Jonathan said to his armour bearer, "Come up after me; for the Lord has delivered them into the hand of Israel."

[14:13]And Jonathan climbed up on his hands and on his feet, and his armour bearer after him: and they turned towards Jonathan, and he struck them down, and his armour bearer put them to death after him. [14]And that first slaughter, which Jonathan and his armour bearer made, was about twenty men, with arrows and slingstones and flints of the field. [15]And there was a trembling in the camp, in the field, and among all the people; and the garrison and the destroyers trembled; and they would not labour; and the earth quaked: so there was a trembling from God.

[14:16]And some of the watchmen of Saul in Gibeah of Benjamin looked; and, behold, the multitude was melting away, here and there. [17]And Saul said to the people who were with him, "Number now, and see who has gone from us." And they numbered, and behold, Jonathan and his armour bearer weren't found. [18]And Saul said to Ahijah, "Bring the ephod here;" for he wore the ephod at that time before Israel. [19]And it happened, while Saul was talking to the priest, that the disturbance that was in the camp of the Philistines continued and increased: and Saul said to the priest, "Withdraw your hand." [20]And Saul and all the people who were with him were gathered together, and came to the battle: and, behold, every man's sword was against his fellow, a very great confusion. [21]And the slaves that were with the Philistines as previously[a] , and that went up with them into the camp, even they also turned to be with the Israelites who were with Saul and Jonathan. [22]And all the men of Israel who had hidden themselves in the hill country of Ephraim heard that the Philistines were fleeing and they also followed hard after them in the battle. [23]And the Lord saved Israel that day: and the battle passed over by Beth-horon. And all Israel was with Saul, about 10,000 men, and the battle spread into every city in the hill country of Ephraim.

[14:24]And Saul committed a great error on that day, for he had bound the people with an oath, saying, "Any man who eats food until it is evening and I am avenged on my enemies is cursed." And none of the people[b] tasted food, [25]and all the land tasted food. And a honeycomb was on the ground, [26]and the people came to it; and the bees had gone, and no man put his hand to his mouth; for the people feared the promise. [27]And Jonathan hadn't heard when his father made the people promise: and he reached out the end of the rod that was in his hand, and dipped it in the honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes brightened. [28]And one of the people answered and said, "Your father made the people promise a promise, saying, 'Whoever eats food this day is cursed.'" And the people were faint. [29]And Jonathan knew, and he said, "My father has troubled the land: please see how my eyes have brightened because I tasted a little of this honey. [30]How much more, if only the people had eaten freely today from the spoil of their enemies which they found! For now the slaughter among the Philistines would have been greater."

[14:31]And they struck those of the Philistines that day at Michmash, and the people were very faint; [32]and the people rushed upon the spoil, and took sheep, and cattle, and calves, and killed them on the ground; and the people ate them with the blood. [33]And they told Saul, saying, "Behold, the people sin against the Lord, in that they eat with the blood." And he said, "You[‡] have acted treacherously: roll a great stone here to me." [34]And Saul said, "Disperse yourselves among the people, and say to them, 'Every man bring his ox, and every man bring his sheep here, and kill them here, and eat; and don't sin against the Lord by eating with the blood.'" And all the people brought what every man had in his hand and slaughtered it there at night. [35]And Saul built an altar to the Lord: this was the first altar that he built to the Lord.

[14:36]And Saul said, "Let us go down after the Philistines by night, and take spoil among them until the morning light, and let us not leave a man of them." And they said, "Do whatever is good in your eyes." And the priest said, "Let us come near to God here." [37]And Saul asked counsel from God, "Will I go down after the Philistines? Will you deliver them into the hand of Israel?" And he didn't answer him that day. [38]And Saul said, "Come here, all you families of the people; and know and see who this sin has been in this day. [39]For, as the Lord lives, who saves Israel, though it be in Jonathan my son, he will surely die." And there wasn't a man among all the people who answered him. [40]And he said to all the men of Israel, "You be on one side, and I and Jonathan my son will be on the other side." And the people said to Saul, "Do what is good in your eyes." [41]And Saul said, "O Lord God of Israel, why haven't you answered your servant today? If this guilt is on account of me or on account of Jonathan my son, O Lord God of Israel, give Urim[c] ; and if it is on account of your people Israel, give Thummim[d] ." And Jonathan and Saul were taken; and the people escaped. [42]And Saul said, "Cast between me and Jonathan my son. Whoever the Lord takes, let him die." And the people said to him, "Let it not be so;"

[a]14:21: Hebrew: yesterday and the third day.
[b]14:24: That is, the army, as in Numbers 20:20, etc.
[c]14:41: (lights)
[d]14:41: (perfections)

and Saul prevailed over them, and they cast between him and Jonathan his son. And Jonathan was taken.

14:43 And Saul said to Jonathan, "Tell me what you have done." And Jonathan told him, and said, "I certainly did taste a little honey with the end of the rod that was in my hand; and, behold, I must die." 44 And Saul said, "God do so to me and more also; for you will surely die today." 45 And the people said to Saul, "Will the person who has worked this great salvation in Israel die today? Far from it: as the Lord lives, not one hair of his head will fall to the ground; for he has worked with God this day." And the people interceded for Jonathan, and he didn't die.

14:46 And Saul went up from following the Philistines; and the Philistines went to their own place. 47 And Saul took the kingdom, and he took property outside Israel, and he fought against all his enemies on every side, against Moab, and the children of Ammon, and against Edom, and Beth-rehob and the king of Zobah, and against the Philistines: and wherever he turned himself, he worked salvation. 48 And he acted valiantly, and struck the Amalekites, and delivered Israel out of the hands of those who despoiled them.

14:49 And the sons of Saul were Jonathan, and Ishiah, and Malchishua, and Eshbaal; and the names of his two daughters were these: the name of the first-born Merob, and the name of the younger Michal: 50 and the name of Saul's wife was Ahinoam the daughter of Ahimaaz. And the name of the captain of his host was Abiner the son of Ner, Saul's uncle. 51 And Kish the father of Saul, and Ner the father of Abiner, were the sons of Abiel of Benjamin. 52 And there was severe war against the Philistines all the days of Saul: and when Saul saw any mighty man, or any son of valour, he took him to himself.

Chapter 15

15:1 And Samuel said to Saul, "The Lord sent me to anoint you to be king over his people, over Israel: and now listen to the voice of the words of the Lord. 2 Thus says the Lord of hosts, 'I have noticed what Amalek did to Israel, how he met him in the way, when he came up out of Egypt. 3 And now, go and strike Amalek, and completely destroy all that they have, and don't spare them; and kill both man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and donkey.'"

15:4 And Saul summoned the people, and numbered them in Gilgal, 400,000 footmen, and 30,000 men of Judah. 5 And Saul came to the cities of Amalek, and laid wait in the valley. 6 And Saul said to the Kenites, "Go, depart from among Amalek, lest I destroy you with them; for you showed kindness to all the children of Israel, when they came up out of Egypt." And the Kenites departed from being among the Amalekites. 7 And Saul struck the Amalekites, from Havilah as you go to Shur, that is before Egypt. 8 And he took Agag the king of the Amalekites alive, and completely destroyed all the people with the edge of the sword. 9 And Saul and the people spared Agag, and the best of the sheep, and of the oxen, and of the fatlings, and the lambs, and all that was good, and would not completely destroy them: and everything that was despised and worthless, that they completely destroyed.

15:10 And the word of the Lord came to Samuel, saying, 11 I repent that I have made Saul king; for he has turned back from following me, and hasn't raised up my words. And Samuel was angry; and he cried to the Lord all night. 12 And Samuel rose early and went to meet Israel in the morning; and it was told Samuel, saying, "Saul came to Carmel, and, behold, he set up a monument, and turned his chariot, and passed on, and went down to Gilgal." 13 And Samuel came to Saul; and behold, he was offering a burnt offering to the Lord, the first of the spoils that he had taken from Amalek; and Samuel came to Saul, and Saul said to him, "Blessed are you of the Lord: I have raised up the word of the Lord." 14 And Samuel said, "And what is this sound of the sheep in my ears, and the sound of the cattle which I hear?" 15 And Saul said, "I have brought them from Amalek: for the people spared the best of the sheep and of the cattle to sacrifice to the Lord your God; and the rest I have completely destroyed."

15:16 And Samuel said to Saul, "Stay, and I will tell you what the Lord has said to me this night." And he said to him, "Say on." 17 And Samuel said, "Though you were little in your own eyes, weren't you made the head, being of the tribe of Benjamin, the smallest of the families of Israel? And the Lord anointed you king over Israel; 18 and the Lord sent you on a journey, and said, 'Go, and completely destroy the sinners against me, the Amalekites, and fight against them until you have exterminated them.' 19 And why didn't you obey the voice of the Lord? And you flew upon the spoil, and did that which was evil in the eyes of the Lord."

15:20 And Saul said to Samuel, "Yes, I have obeyed the voice of the people, and I have gone the way which the Lord sent me, and have brought Agag the king of Amalek, and have completely destroyed the Amalekites. 21 And the people took from the spoil, sheep and cattle, the chief of the devoted things, before the Lord your God in Gilgal." 22 And Samuel said, "Does the Lord have as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the voice of the Lord? Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to listen than the fat of rams. 23 For rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft, and stubbornness is as the iniquity of teraphim[a] . Because you have rejected the word of the Lord, he has also rejected you from being king over Israel."

15:24 And Saul said to Samuel, "I have sinned; for I have transgressed the commandment of the Lord, and your words, because I feared the people, and obeyed their voice. 25 And now, please, pardon my sin, and turn again with me, that I may worship the Lord." 26 And Samuel said to Saul, "I will not return with you; for you have rejected the word of the Lord, and the Lord has rejected you from being king over Israel." 27 And as Samuel turned about to go away, he laid hold of the skirt of his robe, and it tore. 28 And Samuel said to him, "The Lord has torn the kingdom of Israel from you this day, and has given it to your neighbour, who is better than you. 29 And Israel will be divided in two. And the Holy One of Israel will not turn nor repent; for he isn't like a man, that he should repent."

15:30 And Saul said, "I have sinned: yet honour me now, please, before the elders of my people, and before Israel, and turn again with me, that I may worship the Lord your God." 31 And Samuel turned again after Saul; and Saul worshipped the Lord. 32 And Samuel said, "Bring Agag the king of the Amalekites here to me." And Agag came to him in bonds.

[a] 15:23: 'Teraphim' is some kind of household idol, although the exact nature is unknown. See Genesis 31:19, 30, 34.

And Agag said, "Would the bitterness of death have been
thus?" 33And Samuel said to Agag, "As your sword has made
women childless, so will your mother be childless among
women." And Samuel cut Agag in pieces before the LORD in
Gilgal. 34And Samuel went to Ramah; and Saul went up to
his house, to Gibeah. 35And Samuel didn't come to see Saul
any more until the day of his death; for Samuel mourned for
Saul: and the LORD repented that he had made Saul king over
Israel.

Chapter 16

16:1And the LORD said to Samuel, "How long will you
mourn over Saul, for I have rejected him from being king over
Israel? Fill your horn with oil and go; I will send you to Jesse,
to Bethlehem, for I have seen a king for myself among his
sons." 2And Samuel said, "How can I go? When Saul hears,
he will kill me!" And the LORD said, "Take a heifer with you
and say, 'I have come to sacrifice to the LORD.' 3And call Jesse
to the sacrifice, and I will make you know what you will do.
And you will anoint for me the one I say to you." 4And Samuel
did all that the LORD said to him, and came to Bethlehem. And
the elders of the city came trembling to meet him, and they
said, "Do you come in peace, O seer?" 5And he said, "Peace!
I have come to sacrifice to the LORD. Sanctify yourselves and
rejoice with me today." And he sanctified Jesse and his sons
and called them to the sacrifice.

16:6And it happened when they entered that he saw Eliab
and said, "Surely the LORD's anointed is before him." 7And
the LORD said to Samuel, "Don't look at his appearance or at
the greatness of his height, for I have rejected him, for God
sees not as man sees, for man sees to the face, and the LORD
sees to the heart." 8And Jesse called to Amminadab and he
passed before Samuel, and he said, "Neither has the LORD
chosen this one." 9And Jesse made Shammah pass *before him*,
and he said, "Neither has the LORD chosen this one." 10And
Jesse made seven of his sons pass before Samuel, and Samuel
said to Jesse, "The LORD hasn't chosen from among these."
11And Samuel said to Jesse, "Are these all the young men?"
And he said, "The youngest still remains, and behold, he is
tending the flock." And Samuel said to Jesse, "Send and bring
him, for we will not go around until he comes here." 12And
he sent and brought him, and he was reddish, with beautiful
eyes and a good appearance to the LORD, and the LORD said,
"Arise, anoint him, for this is he." 13And Samuel took the horn
of oil and anointed him among his brothers. And the Spirit of
the LORD came mightily upon David from that day onward.
And Samuel rose up and went to Ramah.

16:14And the spirit of the LORD left from *being* with Saul and
an evil spirit from the LORD frightened him. 15And Saul's ser-
vants said to him, "Behold now, an evil spirit from the LORD
frightens you. 16Let our lord now command[a] your servants
before you, let them seek a man who knows how to play the
harp, and it will be that when the evil spirit of God is on you,
then he will play *it* with his hand, and you will be well, it
will let you alone." 17And Saul said to his servants, "Look
for me now for a man who plays well, and bring him to me."
18And one of the young men answered and said, "Behold, I
have seen a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite who knows how to
play, a mighty, valiant man, and a man of battle, and under-
standing in speech, and a handsome man[b] , and the LORD is
with him.

16:19And Saul sent messengers to Jesse and said, "Send to
me your son David who is with the flock." 20And Jesse took
a donkey loaded with an omer of bread and a jug of wine,
and one young goat, and sent them to Saul by his son David.
21And David came to Saul and stood before him, and he loved
him greatly, and David became his armour bearer. 22And
Saul sent to Jesse, saying, "Let David stand before me now,
for he has found favour in my eyes." 23And it happened that
when the evil spirit of God came to Saul, then David would
take the harp and play *it* with his hand and Saul would have
relief, and be well, and the evil spirit would depart from upon
him.

Chapter 17

17:1And the Philistines gathered their armies for battle and
they gathered at Socoh (which is Judah's), and they camped
between Socoh and Azekah in Ephes-dammim. 2And Saul
and the men of Israel gathered and camped in the valley of
Elah and they arrayed for battle to meet the Philistines. 3And
the Philistines stood on the mountain on this *side* and Israel
stood on the mountain on that *side*, and the valley was be-
tween them. 4And a man between the two went out from the
armies of the Philistines, named Goliath of Gath. His height
was four cubits and a span[a] , 5and a helmet of bronze was
on his head, and he was clothed with scaled armour, and the
weight of the armour was five thousand shekels[b] of bronze
and iron. 6And he had greaves of bronze upon his legs, and
a javelin of bronze between his shoulders. 7And the shaft of
his spear was like a weaver's beam, and the head of his spear
was six hundred shekels of iron, and his shield bearer went
before him. 8And he stood and called to the armies of Israel,
and he said to them, "Why have you come out to array for bat-
tle against us? Am I not a Philistine, and you Saul's Hebrews?
Choose a man for yourselves, and let him come down to me.
9If he is able to fight with me, and strike me, then we will be
your servants, and if I prevail against him, and strike him, then
you will be our servants, and serve us." 10And the Philistine
said, "I defy the armies of Israel this day. Give me a man and
let us fight together." 11And Saul and all Israel heard these
words of the Philistine, and they were dismayed, and greatly
afraid.

17:12And David was the son of that Ephrathite of Bethle-
hem of Judah whose name was Jesse (and he had eight sons).
And in the days of Saul the man came to be old, going on
in years. 13And the three eldest[c] sons of Jesse had gone af-

[a]16:16: Hebrew, say to.

[b]16:18: Hebrew, a man of form.

[a]17:4: A cubit is about the length of a man's thigh (Judges 3:16) so man's height is about four cubits. See also the account of the Generations and Kings (called 1 Chronicles 11:23) "a man of stature, five cubits high".

[b]17:5: Archelological evidence suggests a weight between 9 and 17 grams for a shekel. Based on this Goliath's armour weighed between 45kg and 85kg, and his spear head weighed between 5½kg and 10kg.

[c]17:13: Hebrew, great.

ter Saul to the battle. And the names of his three sons who
went to the battle were Eliab, the first-born, and his second,
Abinadab, and the third Shammah. [14]And David was the
youngest, and the three eldest had gone after Saul. [15]And
David went and returned from Saul to feed his father's flock
at Bethlehem. [16]And the Philistine drew near morning and
evening, and presented himself for forty days before Israel.
[17]And Jesse said to David his son, "Take now to your broth-
ers an ephah of this roasted grain, and these ten loaves, and
run to the camp, and give them to your brothers. [18]And bring
these ten cuttings of cheese to the captain of the thousand, and
you will visit your brothers for peace, and bring their pledge.
[19]And Saul and they and every man of Israel were in the valley
of Elah fighting with the Philistines.

[17:20]And David got up early in the morning and left the
flock with a keeper, and took *the food* and went, as Jesse had
commanded him. And he came to the track and the army was
going out to the battle array and they shouted for the battle.
[21]And Israel and the Philistines put the battle in array, rank
to meet rank. [22]And David left his baggage in the hand of
the keeper of the baggage and ran to the rank and came and
asked his brothers as to *their* peace. [23]And he was speaking
with them, and behold, the man between the two came up
out of the ranks of the Philistines, Goliath the Philistine was
his name, of Gath. And he spoke according to these words,
and David heard them. [24]And every man of Israel, when they
saw the man, ran away from before him and were very much
afraid.

[17:25]And a man of Israel said, "Have you seen this man
who has come up? He has surely come up to reproach Is-
rael, and whoever strikes him, the king will enrich him with
great riches, and he will give him his daughter, and make
his father's house free in Israel." [26]And David spoke to the
men who stood by him, saying, "What will be done to the
man who strikes this Philistine and takes away the reproach
from Israel? For who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he
should reproach the armies of the living God?" [27]And the
people answered him according to this word[d] , saying, "So
will it be done to the man who strikes him." [28]And Eliab, his
eldest brother, heard when he spoke to the men, and Eliab's
anger burned against David, and he said, "Why have you
come down, and who have you left that small flock with in
the wilderness? I know your pride, and the evil of your heart,
for you have come down to see the battle." [29]And David said,
"What have I done now? Wasn't it *just* a word?" [30]And he
turned away from him to another and said the same thing, and
the people answered him as before. [31]And the words David
spoke were heard, and they told them before Saul, and he re-
ceived him. [32]And David said to Saul, "Let no man's heart
fail because of him! Your servant will go and fight with this
Philistine." [33]And Saul said to David, "You are not able to go
and fight with this Philistine, for you are a young man, and
he has been a man of war from his youth." [34]And David said
to Saul, "Your servant was tending among the flock for his fa-
ther, and the lion came, and the bear, and took away a sheep
from the flock, [35]and I went out after him, and struck him,
and I rescued it from his mouth, and when he rose against me
I took hold of his beard and struck him and killed him. [36]Your
servant struck both the lion and the bear. This uncircumcised
Philistine will be as one of them. Will I not go and strike him,
and remove the reproach from Israel today? For who is that
uncircumcised one, that he should taunt the armies of the liv-
ing God?" [37]And David said, "The Lord who rescued me
from the hand of the lion and from the hand of the bear, *it is*
he who will rescue me from the hand of this uncircumcised
Philistine." And Saul said to David, "Go, and the Lord be
with you."

[17:38]And Saul clothed David with his gear, and he put a
helmet of brass on his head, and he clothed him with armour.
[39]And David put on his sword over his gear, and he wearied
himself to walk, for he hadn't proved it. And David said to
Saul, "I cannot walk with these, for I haven't proved them."
And David took them off, [40]and he took his staff in his hand,
and he chose five smooth stones from the brook, and put them
in the shepherds' bag which he had, that is, in a pouch, and
his sling was in his hand, and he drew near to the Philistine.

[17:41]And the Philistine came and drew near to David, and
his shield bearer was before him. [42]And the Philistine looked
and saw David, and he disdained him, for he was a young
man, and reddish, and with a beautiful appearance. [43]And
the Philistine said, "Am I a dog, that you come to me with
sticks?" And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. [44]And
the Philistine said to David, "Come to me and I will give your
flesh to the birds of the heavens and to the beasts of the field."
[45]And David said to the Philistine, "You come to me with a
sword and with a spear and with a javelin, and I come to you
in the name of the Lord of hosts, the God of the armies of
Israel who you have reproached. [46]This day the Lord will
shut you up into my hand, and I will strike you and take off
your head from you, and I will give your dead body and the
dead bodies of the army of the Philistines to the birds of the
heavens and to the wild beasts of the earth, and all the earth
will know that there is a God for Israel, [47]and all this assembly
will know that the Lord doesn't save with sword and spear,
for the battle is the Lord's, and he will give you into our hand.

[17:48]And it happened that when the Philistine rose and
came and drew near to meet David, that David hurried and
ran toward the rank to meet the Philistine. [49]And David put
his hand into his bag, and took a stone out of it, and he slung
it and struck the Philistine in his forehead, and the stone sank
through the helmet into his forehead, and he fell on his face
to the earth. [50]Thus David took hold of a sling and a stone
on that day and struck the Philistine and killed him. And
there was no sword in David's hand; [51]and David ran and
stood over the Philistine and took his sword and drew it out
of its sheath and killed him, and cut off his head with it. And
the Philistines saw that their warrior was dead, and they fled.
[52]And the men of Israel and Judah arose and shouted, and
they pursued the Philistines until you come to Gath and to the
gates of Ekron. And the wounded of the Philistines fell down
by the way of Shaaraim, even to Gath and to Ekron. [53]And the
children of Israel returned from chasing after the Philistines
and they plundered their camp. [54]And David took the head
of the Philistine and brought it to Jerusalem, and he put his
armour in his tent.

[17:55]And as Saul saw David go out against the Philistine,
he said to Abiner, the captain of the host, "Whose son is this
young man?" And Abiner said, "As your soul lives, O king,

[d]17:27: That is, as in verse 25.

I don't know." [56]And the king said, "Ask whose son this stripling is." [57]And as David returned from striking the Philistine, Abiner took him, and brought him before Saul with the head of the Philistine in his hand. [58]And Saul said to him, "Whose son are you, young man?" And David said, "The son of your servant Jesse, the Bethlehemite.

Chapter 18

[18:1]And it happened that when he had finished speaking to Saul, that Jonathan saw David, and the soul of Jonathan was knit together with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul. [2]And Saul took him that day, and would not let him return to his father's house. [3]And Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul. [4]And Jonathan took off the robe that he had on and gave it to David, and his gear, even to his sword and his bow and his belt. And Saul let him be over the men of war. [5]And he went out and came in, and in whatever Saul sent him to do, he prospered. And it was good in the eyes of all the people, and also in the eyes of Saul's servants.

[18:6]And it happened that as they came, as David returned from striking the Philistine, that the women came out of all the cities of Israel, singing and dancing, to meet king Saul with timbrels, with joy, and with musical instruments[a] . [7]And the women who danced answered and said, "Saul has struck his thousands, and David his ten thousands." [8]And Saul was very angry, and this word was evil in his eyes, and he said, "They have given David ten thousands, and me thousands. What more can he have? Only the kingdom!" [9]And Saul was eyeing David from that day on.

[18:10]And it happened on the next day that an evil spirit of God came mightily upon Saul and he prophesied in the midst of the house. And David was playing *the harp* with his hand, as he did day by day. And Saul had his spear in his hand, [11]and Saul raised the spear, and he said, "I will strike David, and the wall." And twice David turned aside from before him. [12]And Saul was afraid of David, because the Lord was with him and had departed from Saul. [13]And Saul removed him from *being* before him, and made him his captain over a thousand, and he went out and came before the people. [14]And David behaved wisely in all his ways, and the Lord was with him. [15]And Saul saw that he behaved himself very wisely, and he feared him. [16]And all Israel and Judah loved David, for he went out and came before the people.

[18:17]And Saul said to David, "Behold my elder daughter Merob; I will give her to you for a wife; only be a son of valour for me, and fight the Lord's battles." For Saul said, "Let my hand not be on him, and let the hand of the Philistines be on him." [18]And David said to Saul, "Who am I, and what is my father's family in Israel, that I should be the king's son-in-law?" [19]And it happened when it was time to give Merob, Saul's daughter, to David, that she was afraid of David, and was given to Adriel the Meholathite for a wife.

[18:20]And Michal, Saul's daughter, loved David, and they told Saul, and the thing was right in his eyes. [21]And Saul said, "I will give her to him that she may be a snare to him, and that the hand of the Philistines may be on him." And Saul said to David a second time, "You will be my son-in-law today." [22]And Saul commanded his servants, "Speak secretly to David, and say 'Behold, the king has delight in you, and all his servants love you; and now, be the king's son-in-law.'"

[18:23]And Saul's servants spoke these words in David's ears, and David said, "Is it a light thing in your eyes to be the king's son-in-law? For I am a poor man, and lightly esteemed." [24]And the servants of Saul told him, saying, "This is how David spoke." [25]And Saul said, "Say thus to David: 'The king has no delight in a dowry except a hundred foreskins of the Philistines, to be avenged on the king's enemies.'" And Saul planned him to fall into the hand of the Philistines. [26]And Saul's servants told David these words, and it was right in David's eyes to be the king's son-in-law. And the days had not been fulfilled, [27]and David rose and went, he and his men, and struck a hundred Philistine men. And David brought their foreskins and gave them in full to the king, to be the king's son-in-law. And Saul gave him Michal his daughter for a wife. [28]And Saul saw that the Lord was with David, and Michal, his daughter, and all Israel loved him. [29]And Saul was even more afraid before David, and Saul hated David continually.

[18:30]And the captains of the Philistines went out, and it happened that whenever they went out, that David behaved himself more wisely that all the servants of Saul, and his name was greatly esteemed.

Chapter 19

[19:1]And Saul spoke to Jonathan his son, and to all his servants, that they should kill David. And Jonathan, Saul's son, took much delight in David. [2]And Jonathan told David, saying, "My father Saul is seeking to kill you, and please be watchful now in the morning, and hide yourself, and stay in a secret place, [3]and I will go out and stand by my father in the field where you are, and I will speak to my father about you; and I will see what happens and I will tell you." [4]And Jonathan spoke well of David to Saul his father, and said to him, "Let the king not sin against his servant, against David, for he hasn't sinned against you, and his works have been very good for you, [5]for he put his soul in his hand and struck the Philistine, and the Lord made a great salvation by his hand; and all Israel saw it and rejoiced; and why do you sin against innocent blood, to kill David for nothing?" [6]And Saul paid attention to the voice of Jonathan, and Saul promised, "As the Lord lives, he will not be killed." [7]And Jonathan called to David and told him all these words. And Jonathan brought David to Saul, and he was before him as previously[a] .

[19:8]And there was war again against the Philistines, and David went out and fought with the Philistines, and struck them with a very great slaughter; and they fled before him.

[19:9]And an evil spirit from God was on Saul, as he sat in his house with his spear in his hand; and David was playing *the harp* with his hand. [10]And Saul sought to strike David with the spear; and he slipped away out of Saul's presence, and he struck the spear into the wall: and David fled, and escaped. [11]And that night Saul sent messengers to David's house to watch him and to kill him in the morning: and Michal, David's wife, told him, saying, "If you don't save your soul tonight,

[a]18:6: The Hebrew word suggests some kind of three-element musical instrument, such as a triangle or a three-stringed instrument.
[a]19:7: Hebrew, as yesterday and the third day.

you will be killed tomorrow." [12]And Michal let David down
through the window: and he went, and fled, and escaped.
[13]And Michal took the teraphim[b] , and laid it in the bed, and
put a pillow of goats' *hair* at its head, and covered it with
the clothes. [14]And Saul sent messengers to take David; and
they said, "He is sick." [15]And Saul sent the messengers to
see David, saying, "Bring him up to me in the bed, that I may
kill him." [16]And when the messengers came in, behold, the
teraphim was in the bed, with the pillow of goats' *hair* at its
head. [17]And Saul said to Michal, "Why have you deceived
me like this, and let my enemy go, and he has escaped?" And
Michal answered Saul, "He said to me, 'Let me go; and if not,
I will kill you.'"

[19:18]And David fled, and escaped, and came to Samuel, to
Ramah, and told him all that Saul had done to him. And he
and Samuel went and stayed in Naioth. [19]And it was told Saul,
saying, "Behold, David is at Naioth in Ramah." [20]And Saul
sent messengers to take David: and they saw the company of
the prophets prophesying, and Samuel standing as head over
them, and the Spirit of God came upon the messengers of Saul,
and they prophesied. [21]And when it was told Saul, he sent
other messengers, and they also prophesied. And Saul sent
messengers again the third time, and they also prophesied.
And Saul became angry. [22]And he himself went to Ramah,
and came as far as the well that is on the bare height. And
he asked and said, "Where are Samuel and David?" And one
said, "Behold, they are at Naioth in Ramah." [23]And he went
there to Naioth in Ramah: and the Spirit of God came upon
him also, and he went on, and prophesied, until he came to
Naioth in Ramah. [24]And he stripped off his clothes, and he
prophesied before them, and lay down naked all that day and
all that night. Therefore they say, "Is Saul also among the
prophets?"

Chapter 20

[20:1]And David fled from Naioth in Ramah, and came be-
fore Jonathan and said, "What have I done? What is my in-
iquity and what is my sin before your father, that he seeks
my soul?" [2]And Jonathan said to him, "Far from it; you will
not die: behold, my father does nothing either great or small
that he doesn't uncover my ear; and why should my father
hide this thing from me? It isn't so." [3]And David answered
Jonathan and said, "Your father knows well that I have found
favour in your eyes, and he says, "Don't let Jonathan know
this, lest he take counsel with David: and truly as the Lord
lives, and as your soul lives, he has promised *an oath* between
me and death. [4]And Jonathan said to David, "Whatever your
soul desires, I will also do it for you." [5]And David said to
Jonathan, "Behold, tomorrow is the new moon, and I should
certainly sit with the king at meat: and let me go, that I may
hide myself in the field until evening. [6]If your father misses
me at all, then say, 'David earnestly asked leave of me that
he might run to Bethlehem his city; for it is the yearly sacri-
fice there for all the family.' [7]If he says thus: 'It is well,' your
servant will have peace: and if he answers you harshly, then
you will know that evil is determined by him. [8]And show lov-
ingkindness to your servant; for you have brought your ser-
vant into a covenant of the Lord with you: and if there is in-
iquity in me, kill me yourself; for why should you bring me
to your father?" [9]And Jonathan said, "Far be it from you; for
if I should at all know that evil were determined by my father
to come upon you, and if he came to your cities, I would tell
you." [10]And David said to Jonathan, "Who will tell me if your
father answers you roughly?" [11]And Jonathan said to David,
"Come, and let us go out into the field." And they both went
out into the field. [12]And Jonathan said to David, "The Lord,
the God of Israel, be witness: when I have sounded my father
about this time tomorrow, *or* the third day, behold, if there is
good toward David, I will send to you in the field. [13]God do so
to Jonathan, and more also, if it pleases my father to do you
evil, and I don't uncover your ear, and send you away, that
you may go in peace: and the Lord be with you, as he has
been with my father. [14]And if I am still alive, show me the
lovingkindness of the Lord; and if I die, [15]don't cut off your
lovingkindness from my house forever; and when the Lord
cuts off every one of the enemies of David from the face of the
earth, [16]if the name of Jonathan is cut of from the house of
David, may the Lord require it at the hand of David." [17]And
Jonathan promised to David again, for the love that he had to
him; for he loved him as he loved his own soul.

[20:18]And Jonathan said to him, "Tomorrow is the new
moon: and you will be missed; because your seat will be
missed. [19]And since you will be missed on the third day, come
to the place where you hid yourself when the work was in
hand, and you will remain by the mound. [20]And on the third
day I will shoot an arrow on the side of it, as though I shot at a
mark. [21]And, behold, I will send the lad, *saying*, 'Go, find the
arrow.' If I say to the lad, 'Behold, the arrow is on this side
of you;' take it, and come; for there is peace to you and there
is no evil, as the Lord lives. [22]And if I say thus to the boy,
'Behold, the arrow is beyond you;' go your way; for the Lord
has sent you away. [23]And as for the word which you and I
have spoken, behold, the Lord is a witness between you and
me forever.

[20:24]And David hid himself in the field, and when the new
moon had come the king sat down to eat. [25]And the king
sat on his seat as at other times, on the seat by the wall; and
Jonathan was in front, and Abiner sat by Saul's side: and
David's place was missing. [26]Nevertheless Saul didn't say
anything that day for he thought, "Something has happened
to him, he isn't clean; surely he isn't clean." [27]And it hap-
pened on the next day after the new moon, the second *day*,
that David's place was missing. And Saul said to Jonathan his
son, "Why doesn't the son of Jesse come to meat, neither yes-
terday nor today?" [28]And Jonathan answered Saul, "David
earnestly asked leave of me to go to Bethlehem his city, [29]and
he said, 'Let me go, I pray, for our family has a sacrifice in the
city; and as for me, my brothers have commanded me *to be
there*: and now, if I have found favour in your eyes, please let
me get away and see my brothers.' Therefore he hasn't come
to the king's table." [30]And Saul's anger was greatly kindled
against Jonathan, and he said to him, "You son of a rebellious
young woman, don't I know that you are in league with the
son of Jesse to your own shame, and to the shame of your
mother's nakedness? [31]For all the days that the son of Jesse
lives on the earth, you will not establish your kingdom. And
now send and fetch him to me, for he is a son of death." [32]And

[b]19:13: 'Teraphim' is some kind of household idol, although the exact nature is unknown. See Genesis 31:19, 30, 34.

Jonathan answered Saul, "Why should he be put to death?
what has he done?" 33And Saul raised his spear at him to
strike him; and Jonathan knew that this evil was determined
by his father to put David to death. 34And Jonathan sprang
up from the table in fierce anger, and ate no food the second
day of the month; because his father had shamed him.

20:35And it happened in the morning that Jonathan went
out into the field at the time appointed with David, and a lit-
tle lad with him. 36And he said to his lad, "Run, find now
the arrow which I shoot." And as the lad ran, he shot an ar-
row beyond him. 37And when the lad had come to the place
of the arrow which Jonathan had shot, Jonathan called after
the lad, and said, "Further; the arrow is beyond you." 38And
Jonathan called after the lad, "Make speed, haste, don't stay."
And Jonathan's lad gathered up the arrow, and came to his
master. 39And the lad didn't know anything, only Jonathan
and David knew the matter[a] .

20:40And Jonathan gave his weapons to his lad, and said
to him, "Go to the city." 41And as soon as the lad was gone,
David rose out from the mound, and fell on his face to the
ground, and bowed himself three times: and they kissed one
another, and wept together greatly. 42And Jonathan said to
David, "Go in peace, as we have both promised in the name
of the Lord, saying, 'The Lord will be a witness between me
and you, and between my seed and your seed, forever.'" And
David rose and departed: and Jonathan went into the city.

Chapter 21

21:1And David came to Nob, to Ahimelech the priest: and
Ahimelech came to meet David trembling, and said to him,
"Why are you alone, and no man with you?" 2And David
said to Ahimelech the priest, "The king has commanded me
a word today, and has said to me, 'Let no man know any-
thing of the word on which I am sending you, and what I
have commanded you; and I have appointed the young men
to such and such a place.' 3And now, if there are five loaves
of bread under your hand, give into my hand whatever can be
found." 4And the priest answered David, and said, "There is
no common bread under my hand, for there is holy bread; if
the young men have kept themselves from women, then they
may eat of it." 5And David answered the priest, and said to
him, "Surely we have kept ourselves from women; in the past,
when I set out on a journey, each of the young men was holy,
even though it was a common journey; and how much more
today, when they are sanctified together with the weapons?
6And Ahimelech the priest gave him the bread of the face; for
there was no bread there except the bread of the face, that was
taken from before the face of the Lord, to put hot bread in the
day when it was taken away.

21:7And a certain man of the servants of Saul was there
that day, detained before the Lord; and his name was Doeg
the Edomite, the keeper of Saul's mules. 8And David said to
Ahimelech, "Is there here under your hand a spear or a sword?
For I have brought neither my sword nor my weapons with
me, because the king's word required haste." 9And the priest
said, "The sword of Goliath the Philistine, who you killed in
the valley of Elah, behold, it is here wrapped in a cloth behind
the ephod. If you will take that, take it; for there is no other
here except that." And David said, "There is none like that;
give it to me."

21:10And David rose, and fled that day for fear from Saul,
and went to Achish the king of Gath. 11And the servants of
Achish said to him, "Isn't this David, the king of the land?
Didn't they sing one to another of him in dances, saying,
'Saul has killed his thousands, and David his ten thousands?'"
12And David laid up these words in his heart, and was very
afraid of Achish the king of Gath. 13And he changed his face
before him, and pretended to be mad in their hands, and spat
on the doors of the gate, and let his spittle fall down upon his
beard. 14And Achish said to his servants, "Behold, you see the
man is mad; why have you brought him to me? 15Do I lack
madmen, that you have brought this fellow to play the mad-
man in my presence? Will this fellow come into my house?"

Chapter 22

22:1And David went from there, and escaped, and came to
the cave of Adullam. And when his brothers and all his fa-
ther's house heard it, they went down to him there. 2And ev-
eryone who was in distress, and everyone who was in debt,
and everyone who was bitter of soul, gathered themselves to
him; and he became captain over them: and there were about
four hundred men with him.

22:3And David went from there to Mizpeh of Moab. And he
said to the king of Moab, "Please let my father and my mother
be with you till I know what God will do for me." 4And he
brought them before the king of Moab, and they stayed with
him all the days that David was in the stronghold.

22:5And the prophet Gad said to David, "Don't stay in the
stronghold; leave, and go into the land of Judah." And David
left, and came and stayed in the city of Hereth. 6And Saul
heard that David had been discovered. And Saul was sitting
in Gibeah, under the tamarisk tree in Ramah, with his spear
in his hand, and all his servants were standing around him.
7And Saul said to his servants who stood around him, "Hear
now, you Benjamites! Will the son of Jesse give every one
of you fields and vineyards, will he make you all captains of
thousands and captains of hundreds, 8that all of you have con-
spired against me, and there is no one who uncovers my ear
when my son makes *a covenant* with the son of Jesse, and there
is no one of you who has compassion for me, or uncovers my
ear that my son has stirred up my servant against me, as an
enemy, as at this day?" 9And Doeg the Edomite who stood
by the donkeys of Saul, answered, and said, "I saw the son
of Jesse coming to Nob, to Ahimelech the son of Ahitub the
priest. 10And he inquired of the Lord for him, and gave him
victuals, and gave him the sword of Goliath the Philistine."

22:11And the king sent to call Ahimelech the priest, the son
of Ahitub, and all his father's house, the priests who were
in Nob, and all of them came to the king. 12And Saul said,
"Hear now, son of Ahitub." And he answered, "Here I am;
speak, my lord." 13And Saul said to him, "Why have you con-
spired against me, you and the son of Jesse, in that you have
given him bread, and a sword, and have inquired of God for
him, that he should rise against me as an enemy, as at this
day?" 14And Ahimelech answered the king, and said, "And
who among all your servants is as faithful as David, who is

[a]20:39: Hebrew, word.

the king's son-in-law, and is captain over your guard, and is
honourable in your house? 15Have I today begun to inquire
of God for him? Far be it from me: let the king not impute
anything to his servant, nor to all the house of my father; for
your servant knows nothing of all this, small or great." 16And
the king said, "You will surely die, Ahimelech, you, and all
your father's house." 17And the king said to the guard that
stood about him, "Turn, and kill the priests of the Lord; be-
cause their hand also is with David, and because they knew
that he fled, and didn't uncover my ear. And the servants of
the king would not put forth their hand to fall on the priests
of the Lord. 18And the king said to Doeg, "Turn and fall on
the priests." And Doeg the Edomite turned, and he killed the
priests of the Lord on that day, eighty five persons who wore
a linen ephod. 19And he struck Nob, the city of the priests,
with the edge of the sword, from man even to woman, from
child even to suckling, and ox and donkey and sheep, with the
edge of the sword. 20And one of the sons of Ahimelech, the
son of Ahitub, named Abiathar, escaped, and fled after David.
21And Abiathar told David that Saul had killed the Lord's
priests. 22And David said to Abiathar, "I knew on that day,
when Doeg the Edomite was there, that he would surely tell
Saul. I am guilty of every soul of your father's house. 23Stay
with me, don't fear; for he who seeks my soul seeks your soul:
for with me you will be in *safe* keeping."

Chapter 23

23:1And they told David, saying, "Behold, the Philistines
are fighting against Keilah, and are robbing the threshing-
floors." 2And David inquired of the Lord, saying, "Will
I go and strike these Philistines?" And the Lord said to
David, "Go, and strike the Philistines, and save Keilah." 3And
David's men said to him, "Behold, we are afraid here in Judah:
and how much more if we go to Keilah into the remote parts of
the Philistines?" 4And David inquired of the Lord yet again.
And the Lord answered him, and said, "Arise, go down
to Keilah; for I will deliver the Philistines into your hand."
5And David and his men went to Keilah, and fought with
the Philistines, and they fled before him, and they brought
away their cattle, and killed them with a great slaughter. And
David saved the inhabitants of Keilah.

23:6And it happened, when Abiathar the son of Ahimelech
fled to David at Keilah, that he came down with an ephod
in his hand. 7And it was told to Saul that David had come
to Keilah. And Saul said, "God has sold him into my hand;
for he is shut in, by entering into a town that has gates and
bars." 8And Saul summoned all the people to war, to go
down to Keilah, to besiege David and his men. 9And David
knew that Saul was devising mischief against him; and he said
to Abiathar the priest, "Bring the ephod of the Lord here."
10And David said, "O Lord, the God of Israel, your servant
has surely heard that Saul seeks to come to Keilah, to destroy
the city for my sake. 11And now, will Saul come down, as
your servant has heard? O Lord, the God of Israel, please
tell your servant." And the Lord said, "He will come down."
12And David said, "Will the masters of Keilah deliver me and
my men up into the hand of Saul?" And the Lord said, "They
will deliver you up." 13And David and his men, about six hun-
dred men, rose and departed out of Keilah, and went wher-
ever they could go. And it was told to Saul that David had
escaped from Keilah; and he refrained from going forth.

23:14And David stayed in the wilderness in the strongholds,
and stayed in the hill-country in the wilderness of Ziph. And
Saul sought him every day, and the Lord didn't deliver him
into his hand. 15And David was afraid, for Saul had come
out to seek his soul, and David was in the wilderness of Ziph
in the wood. 16And Jonathan, Saul's son, rose, and went
to David, into the wood, and strengthened his hand in God.
17And he said to him, "Don't fear; for the hand of Saul my fa-
ther will not find you; and you will be king over Israel, and
I will be next to you; and my father Saul knows this also."
18And the two of them made a covenant before the Lord. And
David stayed in the wood, and Jonathan went to his house.
19And the Ziphites came up to Saul, to Gibeah, saying, "Be-
hold, David is hiding himself with us in the strongholds in
the wood, in the hill of Hachilah, which is on the south of the
desert. 20And now come down, according to all the desire of
the king to come down, let him come down; and our part will
be to deliver him up into the king's hand." 21And Saul said,
"You are blessed of the Lord; for you have had compassion
on me. 22Please go and make even more sure, and know, and
see his place where his foot hastens;" for he said, "Perhaps
he is very cunning. 23And see, and find out all the lurking-
places where he hides himself, and be sure to come again to
me, and I will go with you: and it will happen that if he is
in the land I will search him out among all the thousands of
Judah." 24And they rose, and went to Ziph before Saul: and
David and his men were in the wilderness of Simeon, in the
plain on the south of the desert. 25And Saul and his men went
to search for him. And they told David, and he came down to
the rock which is in the wilderness of Simeon. And when Saul
heard, he pursued David in the wilderness of Simeon. 26And
Saul went on this side of the mountain, and David and his
men on the other side of the mountain: and David hurried
to get away for fear of Saul and his men; for Saul and his men
were crossing over against David and his men round about, to
take them. 27And a messenger came to Saul, saying, "Hurry,
and come; for the Philistines have made a raid on the land."
28And Saul returned from pursuing David, and went against
the Philistines: therefore they called that place The Rock of
Divisions[a] . 29b And David went up from there, and dwelt in
the strongholds of En-gedi.

Chapter 24

24:1And it happened that when Saul had returned from fol-
lowing the Philistines it was told him, saying, "Behold, David
is in the wilderness of En-gedi." 2And Saul took three thou-
sand chosen men out of all Israel, and went to seek David and
his men upon the rocks of the wild goats. 3And he came to the
sheep enclosures by the way, where there was a cave; and Saul
went in to cover his feet. And David and his men were stay-
ing in the innermost parts of the cave. 4And the men of David
said to him, "Behold, the day of which the Lord said to you,
'Behold, I will give your enemy into your hand, and you will

[a]23:28: The word here for divisions is as in the Word on the Generations and the Kings (so-called 1 Chr chapter 27).
[b]23:29: Some editions count chapter 24 from this verse.

do to him as it will be good in your eyes.'" And David rose,
and cut off the skirt of Saul's robe secretly. 5And it happened
afterward, that David's heart struck him, because he had cut
off the edge of Saul's robe. 6And he said to his men, "Far be
it from me before the Lord that I should do this thing to the
Lord's anointed, to put forth my hand against him, seeing he
is the Lord's anointed." 7And David persuaded his men with
these words, and didn't let them rise and kill Saul. And Saul
rose up out of the cave, and went on his way.

24:8And David rose afterward, and went out of the cave,
and cried after Saul, saying, "My lord the king." And when
Saul looked behind him, David bowed with his face to the
earth, and prostrated himself. 9And David said to Saul, "Why
do you listen to men's words, saying, 'Behold, David seeks
your soul?' 10Behold, this day your eyes have seen how that
the Lord had given you today into my hand in the cave: and
I refused to kill you, and spared you; and I said, 'I will not put
forth my hand against my lord; for he is the Lord's anointed.'
11And see the skirt of your robe in my hand; for in that I cut
off the skirt of your robe, and didn't kill you, know and see
that there is neither evil nor transgression in my hand, and I
haven't sinned against you, though you hunt my soul to take
it. 12The Lord judge between me and you, and the Lord
avenge me of you; and my hand will not be upon you. 13As the
proverb of the ancients says, 'Out of the wicked comes forth
wickedness;' and my hand will not be upon you. 14And now,
who have you come out after, O the king of Israel? Who do
you pursue? After a dead dog, after a flea? 15And the Lord
be judge, and give justice between me and you, and see, and
plead my cause, and give me justice out of your hand."

24:16And it happened, when David had finished speaking
these words to Saul, that Saul said, "Is this your voice, my son
David?" And Saul lifted up his voice, and wept. 17And he
said to David, "You are more righteous than I; for you have
rendered good to me, and I have rendered evil to you. 18And
you have declared to me this day how that you have dealt well
with me, in that when the Lord had delivered me up into your
hand, you didn't kill me. 19For if a man finds his enemy, will
he let him go on a good way? And the Lord will reward you
with good for that which you have done to me this day. 20And
now, behold, I know that you will surely be king, and that the
kingdom of Israel will be established in your hand. 21And
now promise to me by the Lord, that you will not cut off my
seed after me, and that you will not destroy my name out of
my father's house. 22And David promised to Saul. And Saul
went home; and David and his men went up to the stronghold.

Chapter 25

25:1And Samuel died; and all Israel gathered themselves
together, and lamented him, and buried him in his house at
Ramah. And David rose, and went down to the wilderness of
Simeon.

25:2And there was a man in the wilderness, whose posses-
sions were in Carmel; and the man was very great, and he
had three thousand sheep, and a thousand goats: and he was
shearing his sheep in Carmel. 3And the man's name was Na-
bal[a] ; and the name of his wife was Abigail; and the woman
was of good understanding, and of a beautiful countenance:
and the man was churlish and evil in his doings; and he was
a Calebite. 4And David heard in the wilderness that Nabal
was shearing his sheep. 5And David sent ten young men, and
David said to the young men, "Go up to Carmel, and go to Na-
bal, and ask him as to his peace in my name: 6and thus you
will say to my brother, 'Peace to you, and peace to your house,
and peace to all that you have. 7And now I have heard that
you have shearers: your shepherds have been with us in the
wilderness, and we did them no harm, neither was there any-
thing missing to them, all the while they were in Carmel. 8Ask
your young men, and they will tell you: and let the young men
find favour in your eyes; for we come in a good day: please
give whatever comes to your hand to your servants and to
your son David.'"

25:9And when David's young men came, they spoke to Na-
bal according to all those words in the name of David, and he
sprang up. 10And Nabal answered David's servants, and said,
"Who is David and who is the son of Jesse? There are many
servants today who break away every man from his master.
11And will I take my bread, and my wine, and my flesh that
I have killed for my shearers, and give it to men not know-
ing where they are from?" 12And David's young men turned
on their way, and went back, and came and told him accord-
ing to all these words. 13And David said to his men, "Every
man gird on his sword." And every man girded on his sword;
and David also girded on his sword: and there went up after
David about four hundred men; and two hundred stayed by
the baggage.

25:14And one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal's wife,
saying, "Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness
to bless our master; and he railed at them. 15And the men
were very good to us, and we weren't hurt, neither did we
miss anything, as long as we went with them, when we were
in the fields: 16they were a wall to us both by night and by day,
all the days we were with them keeping the sheep. 17And now
know and see what you will do; for evil is determined against
our master, and against all his house: for he is such a son of be-
lial[b] that one cannot speak to him." 18And Abigail made haste,
and took two hundred loaves, and two bottles of wine, and
five sheep made ready, and five seahs of parched grain, and
one omer of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid
them on donkeys. 19And she said to her young men, "Go on
before me; behold, I come after you." And she didn't tell her
husband Nabal. 20And it happened, as she rode on her don-
key, and came up by the covert of the mountain, that behold,
David and his men came down toward her; and she met them.
21And David had said, "Surely in vain have I kept all that this
fellow has in the wilderness, and nothing was missed of all
that was his: and he has returned me evil for good. 22God do
so to David, and more also, if I leave of all that are his by the
morning light one that passes urine against the wall."

25:23And when Abigail saw David, she hurried, and dis-
mounted from her donkey, and fell before David on her face,
and bowed herself to the ground 24at his feet, and said, "Upon
me, my lord, be the iniquity; and please let your handmaid

[a]25:3: Nabal (נבל) means Fool.
[b]25:17: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.
[c]25:25: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.

speak in your ears, and hear the words of your handmaid.
25 Please let my lord not regard this man of belial[c] , Nabal; for
as his name is, so is he; Nabal is his name, and folly is with
him: and I, your handmaid, didn't see the young men of my
lord, who you sent. 26 And now, my lord, as the Lord lives,
and as your soul lives, seeing the Lord has withheld you from
coming in with innocent blood, and from saving yourself with
your own hand, and now let your enemies, and them that seek
evil to my lord, be as Nabal. 27 And now take this blessing
which your servant has brought to my lord, and let it be given
to the young men who follow my lord. 28 Please forgive the
trespass of your handmaid: for the Lord will certainly make
my lord a faithful house, because my lord fights the battles
of the Lord; and evil will not be found in you all your days.
29 And though men rise up to pursue you, and to seek your
soul, yet the soul of my lord will be bound in the bundle of
life with the Lord your God; and he will sling out the souls
of your enemies, in the hollow of a sling. 30 And it will happen, when the Lord will have done to my lord according to
all the good that he has spoken concerning you, and will have
appointed you prince over Israel, 31 that this will be no grief to
you, nor offence of heart to my lord, neither that you have shed
innocent blood without cause, nor that my lord has saved himself. And when the Lord will have dealt well with my lord,
then remember your handmaid."

25:32 And David said to Abigail, "Blessed be the Lord, the
God of Israel, who sent you this day to meet me: 33 and blessed
be your discretion, and blessed be you, who have kept me this
day from coming in with blood, and from saving myself with
my own hand. 34 For in very deed, as the Lord, the God of Israel, lives, who has withheld me from doing evil to you, unless
you had hurried and come to meet me, surely there would not
have been left to Nabal by the morning light one that passes
urine against the wall. 35 And David received from her hand
that which she had brought him: and he said to her, "Go up
in peace to your house; see, I have listened to your voice, and
have lifted up your face."

25:36 And Abigail came to Nabal; and, behold, he held a
feast in his house, like the feast of a king; and Nabal's heart
was merry within him, for he was very drunk: and she didn't
tell him a word, less or more, until the morning light. 37 And
it happened in the morning, when the wine had gone out
of Nabal, that his wife told him these things, and his heart
died within him, and he became as a stone. 38 And it happened about ten days after, that the Lord struck Nabal, and
he died. 39 And when David heard that Nabal was dead, he
said, "Blessed be the Lord, who has pleaded the cause of my
reproach from the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his servant from the hand of evil-doers: and the Lord has returned
the evil-doing of Nabal upon his own head." And David sent
and spoke concerning Abigail, to take her to him as a wife.

25:40 And when the servants of David had come to Abigail
to Carmel, they spoke to her, saying, "David has sent us to
you, to take you to him as a wife." 41 And she rose, and bowed
herself with her face to the earth, and said, "Behold, your
handmaid is a servant to wash the feet of the servants of my
lord." 42 And Abigail hurried, and rose, and rode upon a donkey, with five maids of hers that followed her; and she went
after the messengers of David, and became his wife. 43 David
also took Ahinoam of Jezreel; and they both became his wives.
44 And Saul had given Michal his daughter, David's wife, to
Palti the son of Laish, who was of Gallim.

Chapter 26

26:1 And the Ziphites came to Saul at Gibeah, saying, "Behold, David is hiding himself with us in the hill of Hachilah,
which is before the desert." 2 And Saul rose, and went down
to the wilderness of Ziph with three thousand chosen men
of Israel to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph. 3 And Saul
camped in the hill of Hachilah, which is before the desert, by
the way. And David stayed in the wilderness, and he saw that
Saul came after him into the wilderness. 4 And David sent
out spies, and understood that Saul was coming to Hachilah.
5 And David rose in secret, and came to the place where Saul
had camped; and David saw the place where Saul lay; and
there was Abiner the son of Ner, the captain of his host. And
Saul lay within the track, and the people were camped round
about him.

26:6 And David answered and said to Ahimelech the Hittite, and to Abishai the son of Zeruiah, brother to Joab, saying, "Who will go down with me to Saul, to the camp?" And
Abishai said, "I will go down with you." 7 And David and
Abishai came to the people by night: and behold, Saul lay
sleeping within the track with his spear stuck in the ground
at his head; and Abiner and the people lay round about him.
8 And Abishai said to David, "The Lord has delivered up your
enemy into your hand this day: and now please let me strike
him with the spear to the earth at one stroke, and I will not
repeat it to him." 9 And David said to Abishai, "Don't destroy
him, for who puts forth his hand against the Lord's anointed
and is guiltless?" 10 And David said, "As the Lord lives, the
Lord will strike him, or his day will come to die, or he will
go down into battle and perish. 11 Far be it from be before
the Lord that I should put forth my hand against the Lord's
anointed: and now please take the spear that is at his head,
and the jar of water, and let us go." 12 And David took the
spear and the jar of water from Saul's head; and they went
away: and no man saw it, nor knew it, neither did any awake;
for they were all asleep, because a deep sleep from the Lord
had fallen on them.

26:13 And David went over to the other side, and stood on
the top of the mountain a long way off, with a great space between them; 14 and David called to the people, and to Abiner
the son of Ner, saying, "Don't you answer, Abiner?" And
Abiner answered and said, "Who is it who calls to me?" 15 And
David said to Abiner, "Aren't you a man, and who is like you
in Israel? And why haven't you kept watch over your lord the
king? For one of the people came in to destroy the king your
lord. 16 This thing[a] that you have done isn't good. As the Lord
lives, you are sons of death, because you haven't kept watch
over your lord, the Lord's anointed. And now see where the
king's spear is, and the jar of water that was at his head.

26:17 And Saul knew David's voice, and said, "Is this your
voice, my son David?" And David said, "It is your servant,
my lord, O king." 18 And David said, "Why does my lord the
king pursue his servant? For how have I sinned, and what evil
is found in me? 19 And now please let my lord the king hear

[a] 26:16: Hebrew, word.

the words of his servant. If it be God who has stirred you up
against me, let him smell an offering: and if it be the children
of men, let them be cursed before the Lord: for they have
driven me out this day that I should not hold fast to the in-
heritance of the Lord, saying, "Go, serve other gods." 20And
now, don't let my blood fall to the earth away from the face of
the Lord: for the king of Israel has come out to seek my soul,
as one hunts a partridge in the mountains.

26:21And Saul said, "I have sinned: return, my son David;
for I will not do evil to you any more, because my soul was pre-
cious in your eyes this day: behold, I have played the fool, and
have erred exceedingly." 22And David answered and said,
"Behold the king's spear! And let one of the young men come
over and fetch it. 23And the Lord will render to every man his
righteousness and his faithfulness; for the Lord gave you into
my hand today, and I would not put forth my hand against the
Lord's anointed. 24And behold, as your soul was highly re-
garded in my eyes this day, so let my soul be highly regarded
in the eyes of the Lord, and let him deliver me out of all dis-
tress." 25And Saul said to David, "May you be blessed, my
son David: you will both do mightily, and will surely prevail."
And David went his way, and Saul returned to his place.

Chapter 27

27:1And David said in his heart, "I will now perish one day
by the hand of Saul: there is nothing better for me except that I
escape into the land of the Philistines; and Saul will despair of
me, to seek me any more in all the borders of Israel: and I will
escape out of his hand." 2And David rose, and passed over,
he and the six hundred men who were with him, to Achish the
son of Maoch, king of Gath. 3And David stayed with Achish
at Gath, he and his men, every man with his household, even
David with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abi-
gail the Carmelite, Nabal's wife. 4And it was told Saul that
David had fled to Gath: and he didn't look for him any more.
5And David said to Achish, "If now your servant has found
favour in your eyes, let them give me a place in one of the cities
in the country, that I may stay there: for why should your ser-
vant stay in the royal city with you?" 6And Achish gave him
Ziklag that day: therefore Ziklag belongs to the kings of Judah
to this day. 7And the number of the days that David stayed in
the country of the Philistines was four months.

27:8And David and his men went up, and made a raid upon
the Geshurites, and the Girzites, and the Amalekites; for the
land was inhabited from of old, as you go to Shur, and to
Egypt. 9And David struck the land, and saved neither man
nor woman alive, and took away the sheep, and the oxen,
and the donkeys, and the camels, and the apparel; and he re-
turned, and came to Achish. 10And Achish said, "Who have
you made a raid against today?" And David said, "Against
the South of Judah, and against the South of the Jerahmeelites,
and against the South of the Kenizzites." 11And David saved
neither man nor woman alive, to bring them to Gath, saying,
"Lest they should tell Gath of us, saying, 'So did David, and
so has been his justice all the days he has stayed in the coun-
try of the Philistines.'" 12And Achish believed David, saying,
"He has made his people Israel utterly to abhor him; and he
will be my servant for ever."

[a]28:10: Hebrew, word.

Chapter 28

28:1And it happened in those days, that the Philistines gath-
ered their hosts together for warfare, to fight with Israel. And
Achish said to David, "Know that you will surely go out with
me to battle, you and your men." 2And David said to Achish,
"Therefore you will know what your servant will do." And
Achish said to David, "Therefore I will make you keeper of
my head for ever."

28:3And Samuel was dead, and all Israel had lamented him,
and buried him in Ramah his own city. And Saul had put
away the necromancers, and the wizards, out of the land.
4And the Philistines gathered themselves together, and came
and camped in Shunem: and Saul gathered all Israel together,
and they camped in Gilboa.

28:5And when Saul saw the host of the Philistines, he was
afraid, and his heart trembled greatly. 6And when Saul in-
quired of the Lord, the Lord didn't answer him, neither by
dreams, nor by Urim, nor by prophets. 7And Saul said to his
servants, "Find me a woman who is a mistress of necromancy,
that I may go to her, and inquire of her." And his servants said
to him, "Behold, there is a woman who is a mistress of necro-
mancy at En-dor." 8And Saul disguised himself, and put on
other clothes, and went, he and two men with him, and they
came to the woman by night: and he said, "Please divine to
me by necromancy, and bring me up whoever I will say to
you." 9And the woman said to him, "Behold, you know what
Saul has done, how he has cut off the necromancers, and the
wizards, out of the land: and why do you lay a snare for my
soul, to cause me to die?" 10And Saul promised to her by the
Lord, saying, "As the Lord lives, no punishment will happen
to you for this thing[a] ."

28:11And the woman said, "Who will I bring up to you?"
And he said, "Bring me up Samuel." 12And when the woman
saw Samuel, she cried with a loud voice; and the woman
spoke to Saul, saying, "Why have you deceived me? for you
are Saul." 13And the king said to her, "Don't be afraid: for
what do you see? Speak." And the woman said to Saul, "I
see a god coming up out of the earth." 14And he said to
her, "What form does he have?" And she said, "An upright
man is coming up; and he is covered with a robe." And Saul
perceived that it was Samuel, and he bowed with his face to
the ground, and bowed down to him. 15And Samuel said to
Saul, "Why have you disquieted me, to bring me up?" And
Saul answered, "I am severely distressed; for the Philistines
make war against me, and God has departed from me, and an-
swers me no more, neither by prophets, nor by dreams: and I
have called you, that you may make known to me what I will
do." 16And Samuel said, "And why do you ask of me, seeing
the Lord has departed from you to be with your neighbour?
17And the Lord has done to you as he spoke by me: and the
Lord has torn the kingdom out of your hand, and given it to
your neighbour, to David. 18Because you didn't listen to the
voice of the Lord, and didn't execute his fierce wrath upon
Amalek, therefore the Lord has done this word to you this
day. 19And the Lord will deliver Israel also with you into the
hand of the Philistines; and tomorrow you and your sons will
fall; and the Lord will also give the host of Israel into the hand
of the Philistines."

28:20 And Saul fell straight away his full length upon the earth, and was very afraid, because of the words of Samuel: and there was no strength in him; for he had eaten no bread all the day, nor all the night. 21 And the woman came to Saul, and saw that he was very troubled, and said to him, "Behold, your handmaid has listened to your voice, and I have put my soul in my hand, and have listened to your words which you spoke to me. 22 And now please you also listen to the voice of your handmaid, and let me set a morsel of bread before you; and eat, that you may have strength, when you go on your way." 23 And he refused, and would not eat. And his servants, together with the woman, urged him; and he listened to their voice. And he rose from the earth, and sat on the bed. 24 And the woman had a fatted calf in the house; and she hurried, and killed it; and she took flour, and kneaded it, and baked unleavened bread from it: 25 and she brought it before Saul, and before his servants; and they ate. And they rose up, and went away that night.

Chapter 29

29:1 And the Philistines gathered together all their hosts to Aphek: and the Israelites camped by the fountain which is in Jezreel. 2 And the lords of the Philistines passed on by hundreds, and by thousands; and David and his men passed on in the rear with Achish. 3 And the princes of the Philistines said, "What are these Hebrews?" And Achish said to the princes of the Philistines, "Isn't this David, the servant of Saul the king of Israel, who has been with me these days this year, and I have found no fault in him from the time he fell to me to this day?" 4 And the princes of the Philistines were angry with him; and they said to him, "Make the man return, that he may go back to his place where you have appointed him, and let him not go down with us to battle, and be an adversary in the camp: for how should this fellow reconcile himself with his lord if not with the heads of these men? 5 Isn't this David, who they answered one another about in dances, saying, 'Saul has slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands?'"

29:6 And Achish called David, and said to him, "As the Lord lives, you have been upright, and your going out and your coming in with me in the host is good in my eyes; for I haven't found evil in you since the day of your coming to me to this day: nevertheless you are not good in the eyes of the lords. 7 And now return, and go in peace, and you will not do evil in the eyes of the lords of the Philistines." 8 And David said to Achish, "For what have I done, and what have you found in your servant so long as I have been before you to this day, that I may not go and fight against the enemies of my lord the king?" 9 And Achish answered and said to David, "I know that you are good in my eyes, as an angel of God: however the princes of the Philistines have said, "He will not go up with us to the battle." 10 And now arise early in the morning, you and the servants of your lord who have come with you, and go to the place which I appointed for you. And as for evil words, take none to heart, for you have been good in my eyes. And arise early for the road, and when you have light, depart." 11 And David rose up early, he and his men, to depart in the morning, to return into the land of the Philistines. And the Philistines went up to Jezreel.

Chapter 30

30:1 And it happened when David and his men had come to Ziklag on the third day, that the Amalekites had made a raid upon the South, and upon Ziklag, and had struck Ziklag, and burned it with fire, 2 and of the women, and of all who were in it, both small and great, they didn't kill anyone; and they carried them off captive, and went their way. 3 And when David and his men came to the city, behold, it was burned with fire; and their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, were taken captive. 4 And David and the people who were with him lifted up their voice and wept, until they had no more power to weep. 5 And David's two wives were taken captive, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite. 6 And David was greatly distressed; for the people spoke of stoning him, because the soul of all the people was grieved, every man for his sons and for his daughters: and David strengthened himself in the Lord his God.

30:7 And David said to Abiathar the priest, the son of Ahimelech, "Please bring the ephod here to me." And Abiathar brought the ephod to David. 8 And David asked the Lord, saying, "Will I pursue this troop? Will I overtake them?" And he answered him, "Pursue; for you will surely overtake, and will surely deliver *them*." 9 And David went, he and the six hundred men who were with him, and came to the brook Besor, and those who were left behind stayed. 10 And David pursued, he and four hundred men; for two hundred stayed behind, who were so faint that they couldn't go over the brook Besor.

30:11 And they found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David, and gave him bread, and he ate; and they gave him water to drink. 12 And they gave him a piece of a cake of figs, and two clusters of raisins: and when he had eaten, his spirit came to him again; for he had eaten no bread, nor drunk any water, three days and three nights. 13 And David said to him, "Who do you belong to and where are you from?" And he said, "I am a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days ago I fell sick. 14 We made a raid upon the South of the Cherethites, and upon that which belongs to Judah, and upon the South of Caleb; and we burned Ziklag with fire." 15 And David said to him, "Will you bring me down to this troop?" And he said, "Promise to me by God, that you will neither kill me, nor deliver me up into the hands of my master, and I will bring you down to this troop." And he promised to him.

30:16 And when he had brought him down, behold, they were spread abroad over all the ground, eating and drinking, and dancing, because of all the great spoil that they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Judah. 17 And David went against them and struck them from the twilight even to the evening of the next day, and he put them to death; and not a man of them escaped, except four hundred young men, who rode upon camels and fled. 18 And David delivered all that the Amalekites had taken; and David delivered his two wives. 19 And nothing that belonged to them was missing, neither small nor great, neither sons nor daughters, neither spoil, nor anything that they had taken to them: David brought back all. 20 And David took all the flocks and the herds, and he drove them ahead of the spoil; and they said, "This is David's spoil."

30:21 And David came to the two hundred men, who were so faint that they couldn't follow David, those they had made

to stay at the brook Besor; and they went out to meet David,
and to meet the people who were with him: and when David
came near to the people, he asked them as to *their* peace.
22 And all the evil men and ones of belial[a] , of those who went
with David, answered and said, "Because they didn't pursue
with us, we will not give them any of the spoil that we have
delivered, except to every man his wife and his children, that
they may lead them away, and depart." 23 And David said,
"You will not do so, my brothers, after the Lord has given us
the adversaries, and he has preserved us, and delivered the
troop that came against us into our hand. 24 And who will lis-
ten to you in this word? For they are not less than you; for the
share of him who waits by the baggage will be as the share
of him who goes down to the battle: they will share alike."
25 And it was so from that day forward, that it became a statute
and an ordinance for Israel to this day.

30:26 And when David came to Ziklag, he sent of the spoil
to the elders of Judah, and to his friends, saying, "Behold,
a blessing for you of the spoil of the enemies of the Lord,"
27 to those who were in Beth-zur, and to those who were in
Ramoth of the South, and to those who were in Jattir, 28 and to
those who were in Aroer, and to those who were in Siphmoth,
and to those who were in Eshtemoa, 29 and to those who were
in Carmel, and to those who were in the cities of the Jerah-
meelites, and to those who were in the cities of the Kenizzites,
30 and to those who were in Hormah, and to those who were in
Beer-sheba, and to those who were in Athach, 31 and to those
who were in Hebron, and to all the places where David him-
self and his men had gone up and down.

Chapter 31

31:1 And the Philistines fought against Israel: and the men
of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down killed
in mount Gilboa. 2 And the Philistines followed hard on Saul
and his sons; and the Philistines killed Jonathan, and Abi-
nadab, and Malchi-shua, the sons of Saul. 3 And the battle
went very badly against Saul, and the archers found him; and
he was greatly wounded in the belly. 4 And Saul said to his
armour bearer, "Draw your sword, and thrust me through
with it, lest these uncircumcised come and thrust me through,
and abuse me." And his armour bearer would not; for he was
very afraid. And Saul took his sword, and fell upon it. 5 And
when his armour bearer saw that Saul was dead, he likewise
fell upon his sword, and died with him. 6 And Saul died, and
his three sons, and his armour bearer, and all his men, that
same day together.

31:7 And when the men of Israel who were on the other side
of the valley, and those who were beyond the Jordan, saw that
the men of Israel fled, and that Saul and his sons were dead,
they abandoned the cities, and fled; and the Philistines came
and stayed in them. 8 And it happened on the next day, when
the Philistines came to strip the slain, that they found Saul and
his three sons fallen on Mount Gilboa. 9 And they cut off his
head, and stripped off his armour, and sent into the land of
the Philistines round about, to carry the tidings to their idols,
and to the people. 10 And they put his armour in the house of
the Ashtaroth[a] ; and they fastened his body to the wall of Beth-
shan. 11 And when the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead heard con-
cerning him that which the Philistines had done to Saul, 12 all
the valiant men arose, and went all night, and took the body
of Saul and the bodies of his sons from the wall of Beth-shan;
and they came to Jabesh, and burnt them there. 13 And they
took their bones, and buried them under the tamarisk-tree in
Jabesh, and fasted seven days.

[a] 30:22: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.
[a] 31:10: Ashtaroth is plural of Ashtoreth, the name of a Canaanite goddess supposedly associated with the moon and fertility.

Samuel, Saul and David, Second part called Second Samuel

Chapter 1

1:1 And it happened after the death of Saul, when David had returned from killing Amalek, and David had stayed two days in Ziklag, 2 it happened on the third day that, behold, a man came out of the camp from Saul, with his clothes torn, and earth on his head. And so it was, when he came to David, that he fell on his face to the earth, and did obeisance. 3 And David said to him, "Where have you come from?" And he said to him, "I have escaped out of the camp of Israel." 4 And David said to him, "How did the matter go? Please tell me." And he answered, "The people have fled from the battle, and many of the people also have fallen, and Saul and Jonathan his son are dead also." 5 And David said to the young man who told it to him, "How do you know that Saul and Jonathan his son are dead?" 6 And the young man who told it to him said, "It happened that I happened to be on Mount Gilboa, and behold, Saul was leaning on his spear, and, behold, the chariots and the horsemen followed hard after him. 7 And when he looked behind him, he saw me, and called to me. And I answered, 'Here I am.' 8 And he said to me, 'Who are you?' And I answered him, 'I am an Amalekite.' 9 And he said to me, 'Please stand beside me and kill me, for anguish has taken hold of me, because my soul is still in me.' 10 And I stood beside him, and killed him, because I was sure that he could not live after he had fallen. And I took the crown that was on his head, and the bracelet that was on his arm, and have brought them here to my lord."

1:11 Then David took hold of his clothes and tore them, and all the men who were with him did the same. 12 And they mourned, and wept, and fasted until evening, for Saul, and for Jonathan his son, and for the people of the Lord, and for the house of Israel, because they had fallen by the sword. 13 And David said to the young man who told it to him, "Where do you come from?" And he answered, "I am the son of a sojourner, an Amalekite." 14 And David said to him, "Why were you not afraid to put forth your hand to destroy the Lord's anointed one?" 15 And David called one of the young men, and said, "Go near, and fall on him." And he struck him, and threw him to the ground. 16 And David said to him, "Your blood is on your head, for your mouth has given witness against you, saying, 'I have killed the Lord's anointed one.'"

1:17 And David lamented with this lamentation over Saul and over Jonathan his son, 18 and he told them to teach it to the sons of Israel and Judah. Behold, it is written in the book of Jashar. And he said:

1:19 Take your stand, O Israel, over your dead who are slain. How the mighty ones have fallen!

1:20 Tell it not in Gath, Announce it not in the streets of Ashkelon, Lest the daughters of the Philistines rejoice, Lest the daughters of the uncircumcised triumph.

1:21 You mountains of Gilboa, Let it not fall upon you, And let there be no dew nor rain upon your ridges, O mountains of death, For there the shield of the mighty was vilely cast away, The shield of Saul, not anointed with oil.

1:22 From the blood of the slain, from the fat of the mighty, The bow of Jonathan turned not back, And the sword of Saul returned not empty.

1:23 Saul and Jonathan were lovely and pleasant. They were not separated in their life, And in their death they were not divided. They were swifter than eagles, They were stronger than lions.

1:24 Weep over Saul, O daughters of Israel, Who clothed you delicately in scarlet, Who put ornaments of gold on your clothing.

1:25 How are the mighty fallen in the midst of the battle! Jonathan is slain upon death.

1:26 I am distressed for you, my brother Jonathan, Very pleasant have you been to me, Your love fell on me like the love of the women.

1:27 How are the mighty fallen, And the precious articles have perished!

Chapter 2

2:1 And it happened after this, that David asked of the Lord, saying, "Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah?" And the Lord said to him, "Go up." And David said, "Where shall I go up?" And he said, "To Hebron." 2 And David went up to Hebron with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite, 3 and his men who were with him, every man with his household, and they lived in the cities of Hebron. 4 And the men of Judah came and anointed David king over the house of Judah there. And they told David, saying, "The men of Jabesh-gilead were the ones who buried Saul."

2:5 And David sent messengers to the men of Jabesh-gilead, and said to them, "You are blessed of the Lord, in that you have shown this kindness to your lord, to Saul, and have buried him. 6 And now may the Lord show kindness and truth to you, and I also will do good to you because you have done this thing. 7 And now let your hands be strong, and be sons of valour, for Saul your lord is dead, and the house of Judah have also anointed me king over them."

2:8 And Abiner the son of Ner was captain of Saul's host and he had taken Eshbaal the son of Saul, and brought him over to Mahanaim. 9 And he made him king over the Gileadites, and over the Ashurites, and over Jezreel, and over Ephraim, and over Benjamin, and over all Israel. 10 Eshbaal, Saul's son, was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and he reigned two years. But the house of Judah followed David. 11 And the time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months.

2:12 And Abiner the son of Ner and the servants of Eshbaal the son of Saul went out from Mahanaim to Gibeon. 13 And Joab the son of Zeruiah and the servants of David went out and met them by the pool of Gibeon, and they sat, one on one side of the pool, and the other on the other side of the pool. 14 And Abiner said to Joab, "Please let the young men rise and play before us." And Joab said, "Let them rise." 15 Then they

rose and went over by number: twelve of the Benjamites of
Eshbaal the son of Saul, and twelve of the servants of David.
16And each caught his neighbour by the head, and *thrust* his
sword in his neighbour's side and they fell down together.
And that place was called Helkath-hazodim[a] , which is in
Gibeon.

2:17And the battle was very severe that day, and Abiner and
the men of Israel were beaten before the servants of David.
18And the three sons of Zeruiah were there: Joab, and Abishai,
and Asahel. And Asahel was as light of foot as a wild doe.
19And Asahel pursued Abiner, and in going he did not turn
to the right hand nor to the left from following Abiner. 20Then
Abiner looked behind him, and said, "Is it you, Asahel?" And
he answered, "It is I." 21And Abiner said to him, "Turn aside
to your right hand or to your left, and lay hold on one of the
young men, and take his armour." And Asahel would not
turn from following him. 22And again Abiner said to Asa-
hel, "Turn from following me! Why should I strike you to
the ground? How then should I hold up my face to Joab
your brother? And how can these things be? Return to your
brother Joab." 23And Asahel refused to turn aside; and Abiner
struck him in the body with the foot of the spear, and the spear
came out behind him, and he fell down there and died in the
same place. And it happened, that whoever came to the place
where Asahel fell down and died stood still.

2:24And Joab and Abishai pursued Abiner, and the sun
went down when they had come to the hill of Ammah that lies
before Giah by the way of the wilderness of Gibeon. 25And
the children of Benjamin gathered themselves together after
Abiner, and became one band, and stood on the top of a hill.
26Then Abiner called to Joab, and said, "Shall the sword de-
vour forever? Don't you know that the end will be bitter?
How long shall it be, then, before you tell the people to re-
turn from following their brothers?" 27And Joab said, "As the
Lord lives, surely if you had not spoken then in the morning
the people would have gone away and each would not have
followed his brother." 28And Joab blew the trumpet and all
the people stood still, and did not pursue Israel any more, nor
did they fight any more. 29And Abiner and his men went all
that night through the Arabah, and they passed over the Jor-
dan, and went through all Bithron, and came to Mahanaim.
30And Joab returned from following Abiner, and when he had
gathered all the people together, there were missing those of
David's servants who had fallen: nineteen men and Asahel.
31And of the children of Benjamin and of Abiner's men the
servants of David had struck 360 men. 32And they took up
Asahel, and buried him in the sepulchre of his father, which
was in Beth-lehem. And Joab and his men went all night, and
the day broke on them at Hebron.

Chapter 3

3:1And there was a long war between the house of Saul and
the house of David, and David grew stronger and stronger,
and the house of Saul grew weaker and weaker. 2And six sons
were born to David in Hebron: his first-born was Aminon, by
Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; 3and his second, Daluiah, by Abi-
gail of Carmel; and the third, Abishalom the son of Maacah
the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur; 4and the fourth,
Adonijah the son of Haggith; and the fifth, Shephatiah by
Abital; 5and the sixth, Ithream, by Eglah, David's wife. These
were born to him, to David in Hebron.

3:6And it happened, while there was war between the
house of Saul and the house of David, that Abiner made him-
self strong in the house of Saul. 7And Saul had a concubine,
whose name was Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah, and Abiner
took her. And Eshbaal said to Abiner, "Why have you gone
in to my father's concubine?" 8Then Abiner was very angry
over this word of Eshbaal, and said, "Am I a dog's head? Is it
for myself that I have done all these things today and shown
kindness to the house of Saul your father, to his brothers, and
to his friends, and have not made peace with the house of
David? And yet this day you charge me with a fault con-
cerning a woman. 9God do so to me, and more also, if I do
not do to David as the Lord has promised to him, 10to trans-
fer the kingdom from the house of Saul, and to set up the
throne of David over Israel and over Judah, from Dan even to
Beer-sheba." 11And Eshbaal could not answer Abiner another
word, because he feared him.

3:12And Abiner sent messengers to David on his behalf, say-
ing, "Make a covenant with me, and, behold, my hand shall
be with you, to bring all Israel around to you." 13And David
said, "Good! I will make a covenant with you, but I require
one thing from you: you shall not see my face unless you bring
Michal, Saul's daughter with you, when you come to see my
face." 14And David sent messengers to Eshbaal, Saul's son,
saying, "Give me my wife Michal, who I took for a hundred
foreskins of the Philistines." 15And Eshbaal sent, and took
her from her husband, Paltiel the son of Laish. 16And her hus-
band went with her, weeping as he went, and followed her
to Bahurim. Then Abiner said to him, "Go, return," and he
returned.

3:17And Abiner had a word with the elders of Israel, saying,
"Previously you sought for David to be king over you. 18Now
then do it, for the Lord has spoken of David, saying, 'By the
hand of my servant David I will save my people Israel out of
the hand of the Philistines, and out of the hand of all their ene-
mies.'" 19And Abiner also spoke in the ears of the children of
Benjamin, and Abiner also went to Hebron to speak in the ears
of David all that seemed good to Israel, and to the children of
Benjamin. 20And Abiner came with twenty men to David at
Hebron. And David made a feast for Abiner and the men who
were with him. 21And Abiner said to David, "I will rise and
go and gather all the people of Israel to my lord the king, that
they may make a covenant with you, and that you may reign
over all that your soul desires." And David sent Abiner away,
and he went in peace.

3:22And behold, the servants of David and Joab came from
a foray, and brought in spoil with them. And Abiner was not
with David in Hebron for he had sent him away, and he had
gone in peace. 23When Joab and all the host who were with
him had come, it was told to Joab, saying, "Abiner the son
of Ner came to David, and he has sent him away, and he has
gone in peace." 24Then Joab came to the king and said to him,
"What have you done? Behold, Abiner the son of Ner came
to you. Why have you sent him away, and he is quite gone?
25You know Abiner the son of Ner, that he came to deceive
you and to know your going out and your coming in, and to

[a]2:16: That is, Field of plotters, as in the first part, 24:11.

know all that you are doing."

3:26 And when Joab had come out from David, he sent messengers after Abiner, and they brought him back from the well of Sirah, and David did not know about it. 27 And when Abiner had returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside beside the gate to speak with him quietly, and struck him there in the body, and he died, for the blood of Asahel his brother. 28 And afterward, when David heard it, he said, "My kingdom and I are guiltless before the Lord from now on and forever, and may the blood of Abiner the son of Ner 29 be on the head of Joab, and on all his father's house, and let there not fail from the house of Joab one who has an issue, or who is a leper, or who leans on a staff, or who falls by the sword, or who lacks bread."

3:30 And Joab and Abishai his brother killed Abiner, because he had lain in wait for their brother Asahel at Gibeon in the battle. 31 And David said to Joab, and to all the people who were with him, "Tear your clothes, and clothe yourselves with sackcloth, and mourn before Abiner." And king David followed the bier. 32 And they buried Abiner in Hebron. And the king lifted up his voice, and wept at the grave of Abiner, and all the people wept. 33 And the king lamented for Abiner, and said, "Alas, Abiner has died as a fool dies.

3:34 Your hands were not bound, nor your feet put into fetters: As a fool falls, so did you fall." And all the people gathered to weep over him.

3:35 And all the people came to make David eat bread while it was still day, and David promised, saying, "God do so to me, and more also, if I taste bread, or anything else, until the sun is down." 36 And all the people took notice of it, and whatever the king did pleased all the people. 37 And all the people and all Israel understood that day that the killing of Abiner the son of Ner was not from the king. 38 And the king said to his servants, "Don't you know that a prince and a great man has fallen in Israel this day? 39 And he was a relative and an appointed officer of the king this day, and these men the sons of Zeruiah are too hard for me. The Lord reward the evil-doer according to his wickedness."

Chapter 4

4:1 And when Eshbaal, Saul's son, heard that Abiner was dead in Hebron, his hands became feeble, and all the Israelites were troubled. 2 And Eshbaal, Saul's son, had two men who were captains of bands. The name of the one was Baanah, and the name of the other Rechab, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, of the children of Benjamin (for Beeroth is reckoned to Benjamin, 3 and the Beerothites fled to Gittaim, and have been sojourners there until this day).

4:4 And Jonathan, Saul's son, had a son whose feet were lame. He was five years old when the news of Saul and Jonathan came out of Jezreel. And his nurse took him up, and fled. And it happened, as she hurried to flee, that he fell, and became lame. And his name was Mephibaal.

4:5 And the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, Rechab and Baanah his brother, went, and came about the heat of the day to the house of Eshbaal, as he was resting at noon. 6 And behold, the porter of the house had been gathering wheat, and she slumbered and fell asleep. And Rechab and Baanah his brother slipped past. 7 And when they came into the house, as he lay on his bed in his bedroom, they struck him, and killed him, and cut off his head, and took it, and went by the way of the Arabah all night. 8 And they brought the head of Eshbaal to David to Hebron, and said to the king, "Behold, the head of Eshbaal, the son of Saul, your enemy, who sought your life! The Lord has avenged my lord the king this day on Saul, your enemy, and on his seed." 9 And David answered Rechab and Baanah his brother, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, and said to them, "As the Lord lives, who has redeemed my soul out of all adversity, 10 when someone told me, saying, 'Behold, Saul is dead,' thinking to have brought good tidings, I took hold of him, and killed him in Ziklag. That was the reward I gave him for his tidings. 11 How much more, when wicked men have killed a righteous person in his own house on his bed, shall I now seek his blood from your hand, and take you away from the earth." 12 And David commanded his young men, and they killed them, and cut off their hands and their feet, and hung them up beside the pool in Hebron. And they buried the head of Eshbaal in the grave of Abiner in Hebron.

Chapter 5

5:1 Then all the rod-bearers of Israel came to David at Hebron, and spoke, saying, "Behold, we are your bone and your flesh. 2 In the past, when Saul was king over us, you were the one who led Israel out and brought Israel in, and the Lord said to you, 'You shall be shepherd of my people Israel, and you shall be prince over Israel.'" 3 And all the elders of Israel came to the king at Hebron, and king David made a covenant with them in Hebron before the Lord. And they anointed David king over all Israel. 4 David was thirty years old when he became king, and he reigned forty years. 5 He reigned over Judah in Hebron for seven years and six months, and he reigned over all Israel and Judah in Jerusalem for thirty three years.

5:6 And the king and his men went to Jerusalem against the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land, who spoke to David, saying, "You shall not come in here," for the blind and the lame had incited them, saying, "David cannot come in here." 7 And David took the stronghold of Zion. This is the city of David. 8 And David said on that day, "Whoever strikes the Jebusites, let him get up to the watercourse, and *strike* the lame and the blind, who are hated of David's soul." Therefore they say, "There are the blind and the lame, he cannot come into the house."

5:9 And David lived in the stronghold, and called it the city of David. And he built the city round about from Millo and inward. 10 And David grew greater and greater, for the Lord, the God of hosts, was with him. 11 And Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar-trees, and carpenters, and builders of walls, and they built David a house. 12 And David perceived that the Lord had established him as king over Israel, and that his kingdom was exalted for the sake of his people Israel. 13 And David took for himself more concubines and wives out of Jerusalem, after he had come from Hebron, and more sons and daughters were born to David. 14 And these are the names of those who were born to him in Jerusalem: Shammua, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, 15 and Ibhar, and Elishua, and Eliphelet, and Nogah, and Nepheg, and Japhia, 16 and Elishama, and Beeliada, and

Eliphelet.

5:17 And when the Philistines heard that David had been anointed king over Israel, the Philistines went up to look for David. And David heard of it, and went down to the stronghold. 18 And the Philistines had come and made a raid in the valley of Rephaim. 19 And David inquired of the Lord, saying, "Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will you give them into my hand?" And the Lord said to David, "Go up, for I will certainly give them into your hand." 20 And David came to Baal-perazim[a] , and David struck them there, and David said, "The Lord has broken my enemies before me, like the breach of waters." Therefore he called the name of that place Baal-perazim. 21 And the Philistines left their gods there, and David and his men took them away, and David spoke, and they were burned with fire.

5:22 And the Philistines came up yet again, and made a raid in the valley of Rephaim. 23 And when David inquired of the Lord, he said, "You shall not go up. Circle behind them, and come on them over against Bacaim. 24 And it shall be, when you hear the sound of turmoil in the groves[b] of Bacaim, then you shall stir yourself, for then the Lord has gone out before you to strike the host of the Philistines." 25 And David did so, as the Lord commanded him, and struck the Philistines from Gibeon until Gezer.

Chapter 6

6:1 And David again gathered together all the chosen men of Israel, 70,000 *men*. 2 And David rose, and went with all the people who were with him, from Baalah, that is Kiriath-jearim, which belongs to Judah, to bring up from there the ark of God which is called by the name of the Lord of hosts who sits *above* the cherubim. 3 And they set the ark of God on a new cart, and brought it out of the house of Abinadab that was in the hill. And Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, were leading the new cart 4 with the ark, and Uzzah was walking alongside and Ahio was walking ahead of the ark. 5 And David and all the children of Israel played before the Lord with all their might, with songs, and with harps, and with psalteries, and with timbrels, and with castanets, and with cymbals.

6:6 And when they came to the threshing-floor of Chidon, Uzzah put his hand out onto the ark to take hold of it, for the oxen stumbled. 7 And the anger of the Lord was kindled against Uzzah, and God struck him there because he put his hand out onto the ark. And he died there by the ark of God. 8 And David was displeased, because the Lord had broken forth on Uzzah, and he called that place Perez-uzzah[a] , to this day.

6:9 And David was afraid of the Lord that day, and he said, "How shall the ark of the Lord come to me?" And when the ark of the Lord came, 10 David was unwilling to remove the ark of the Lord to himself in the city of David, and David carried it aside into the house of Obed-edom the Gittite. 11 And the ark of the Lord remained in the house of Obed-edom the Gittite three months. And the Lord blessed Obed-edom, and all his house.

6:12 And it was told king David, saying, "The Lord has blessed the house of Obed-edom and all that is his because of the ark of God." And David said, "I will bring the blessing back to my house." And David went and brought up the ark of the Lord from the house of Obed-edom into the city of David with joy. 13 And seven companies were with him bearing the ark, and he sacrificed an ox and a fatling. 14 And David danced before the Lord with all his might. And he was girded with a linen ephod. 15 And David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of the Lord with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet.

6:16 And it happened, as the ark of the Lord came into the city of David, that Michal the daughter of Saul looked down through the window, and saw king David leaping and dancing before the Lord, and she despised him in her heart. 17 And they brought in the ark of the Lord, and set it inside the tent that David had pitched for it. And David offered burnt-offerings and peace-offerings before the Lord. 18 And when David had finished offering the burnt-offerings and the peace-offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the Lord of hosts. 19 And he distributed among all the people, from Dan to Beersheba, among the whole multitude of Israel, both to men and women, to every one a cake of bread, and a portion, and a cake of raisins. And all the people left, every one to his house.

6:20 Then David returned to bless his household. And Michal the daughter of Saul came out to meet David, and greeted him and said, "How glorious was the king of Israel today, who uncovered himself today in the eyes of the handmaids of his servants, as one of the dancers shamelessly uncovers himself!" 21 And David said to Michal, "Before the Lord I will dance. Blessed be the Lord who chose me above your father, and above all his house, to appoint me prince over his people, over Israel; therefore I will play and dance before the Lord. 22 And I will uncover myself like this again and I will be lowly in your eyes, and with the handmaids you spoke about, with them I will be honoured." 23 And Michal the daughter of Saul had no child to the day of her death.

Chapter 7

7:1 And it happened, when the king lived in his house, and the Lord had given him rest from all his enemies all around, 2 that the king said to Nathan the prophet, "See now, I live in a house of cedar, and the ark of God lives inside curtains of the Lord. 3 And Nathan said to the king, "Go, do all that is in your heart, for God is with you."

7:4 And it happened on the same night, that the word of the Lord came to Nathan the prophet, saying, 5 "Go and tell my servant David, 'Thus says the Lord, "You are not the one who should build a house for me to live in,

7:6 for I have not lived in a house since the day I brought the children of Israel up out of Egypt, even to this day, and have walked in a tent, in a tabernacle. 7 In all places where I have walked with all Israel, did I speak a word with one of the rod-bearers of Israel, who I commanded to be shepherd of my people Israel, saying, "Why haven't you[‡] built me a house of

[a] 5:20: That is, Master of the breaches.
[b] 5:24: Or, Asherim.
[a] 6:8: That is, Breach of Uzzah.

cedar?"'

7:8 "And now you shall say thus to my servant David, 'Thus
says the LORD of hosts, "I took you from the habitation, from
following the sheep, to be prince over my people, over Israel,
7:9 and I have been with you wherever you went, and have
cut off all your enemies from before you, and I will make you
a great name, like the name of the great ones who are in the
earth. 10 And I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and
will plant them, that they may live in their own place, and not
tremble any more. Neither shall the son of wickedness afflict
them any more, as at the first, 11 and from the day that I com-
manded judges to be over my people Israel. And I will cause
you to rest from all your enemies. Moreover the LORD tells
you that, as for a house, the LORD will make one for you.

7:12 "When your days are fulfilled, and you sleep with your
fathers, I will set up your seed after you, who shall come from
your body[a] , and I will establish his kingdom. 13 He shall build
me a house for my name, and I will establish his throne for-
ever. 14 I will be his father, and he shall be my son. When
he sins I will chasten him with the rod of men, and with the
strokes of the children of men. 15 And I will not take my lov-
ingkindness away from him, as I took it from the one I put
away before you. 16 And his house and his kingdom shall be
made sure forever before my face. And his throne shall be
established forever."'"

7:17 According to all these words, and according to all this
vision, so Nathan spoke to David.

7:18 Then David the king went in, and sat before the LORD,
and he said, "Who am I, O LORD the LORD, and what is my
house, that you have brought me this far?

7:19 And this was a small thing in your eyes, O LORD the
LORD, and you have spoken of your servant's house concern-
ing a time far off, and this is the law of men, O LORD the LORD!
20 And what more can David say to you? For you know your
servant, O LORD the LORD. 21 For your servant's sake, and ac-
cording to your own heart, you have done all this greatness,
to make your servant know it. 22 Therefore you are great, O
LORD the LORD, for there is none like you, neither is there any
God besides you, according to all that we have heard with our
ears.

7:23 "And what other nation on earth is like your people, like
Israel, who God went to redeem for you as a people, to make
you a name, and to do for you a great and awesome thing in
driving out, before your people who you have redeemed for
yourself from Egypt, a nation and its tents? 24 And you estab-
lished for yourself your people Israel to be your people for-
ever, and you, the LORD, became their God.

7:25 "And now, O LORD the LORD, let the word that you have
spoken concerning your servant, and concerning his house,
be established forever, and do as you have spoken. 26 And let
your name be magnified forever, saying, 'The LORD of hosts is
God over Israel,' and the house of your servant David shall be
established before you. 27 For you, O LORD of hosts, the God
of Israel, have revealed to your servant, saying, 'I will build
you a house.' Therefore your servant has found in his heart in
God to pray this prayer to you.

7:28 "And now, O LORD the LORD, you are God, and your
words are truth, and you have promised this good thing con-
cerning your servant. 29 And now let it please you to bless
the house of your servant, that it may continue forever before
you. For you, O LORD the LORD, have spoken it, and with your
blessing let the house of your servant be blessed forever."

Chapter 8

8:1 And after this it happened that David struck the
Philistines, and subdued them, and David took the suburbs
out of the hand of the Philistines.

8:2 And he struck Moab, and measured them with the line,
making them to lie down on the ground. And two lines were
to be put to death, and one full line to be kept alive. And the
Moabites became servants to David, and brought tribute.

8:3 David also struck Hadarezer the son of Rehob, king of
Zobah, as he went to recover his dominion at the River Eu-
phrates. 4 And David took from him 1,000 chariots and 7,000
horsemen, and 20,000 footmen, and David hocked all the char-
iot horses, and reserved *enough* of them for a hundred chariots
for himself.

8:5 And when the Arameans of Damascus came to help
Hadarezer king of Zobah, David struck 22,000 men of the
Arameans. 6 Then David put an officer in Aram of Damascus,
and the Arameans became servants to David, and brought
tribute. And the LORD gave victory to David wherever he
went.

8:7 And David took the shields of gold that were on the
servants of Hadarezer king of Zobah, and brought them to
Jerusalem. (And Shishak king of Egypt took them when
he came up to Jerusalem in the days of Rehoboam son of
Solomon.) 8 And from Tebah and from the choice cities of
Hadarezer, king David took very much bronze, and with it
Solomon made the bronze sea and the pillars and the basin
and all the bronze utensils.

8:9 And when Tou, king of Hamath heard that David had
struck all the host of Hadarezer, 10 then Tou sent Hadoram
his son to king David, to salute him, and to bless him, be-
cause he had fought against Hadarezer and had struck him,
for Hadarezer had wars with Tou. And he brought with him
vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and vessels of bronze.
11 King David also dedicated these to the LORD, with the sil-
ver and gold that he dedicated from all the nations which he
subdued; 12 of Edom, and of Moab, and of the children of Am-
mon, and of the Philistines, and of Amalek, and of the spoil
of Hadarezer, son of Rehob, king of Zobah.

8:13 And David got himself a name, and when he returned
he killed 18,000 Edomites in the Valley of Salt. 14 And David
put garrisons in Edom. He put garrisons throughout all Edom
and all in Edom were servants to David. And the LORD saved
David wherever he went.

8:15 And David reigned over all Israel, and David executed
justice and righteousness to all his people. 16 And Joab the
son of Zeruiah was over the host, and Jehoshaphat the son
of Ahilud was recorder, 17 and Zadok the son of Ahitub and
Ahimelech the son of Abiathar were priests, and Shavsha
was scribe, 18 and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the
Cherethites and the Pelethites, and David's sons were princes.

[a] 7:12: Hebrew: inward parts. The word is used to refer to either reproductive (as here) or digestive organs.

Chapter 9

9:1 And David said, "Is there still anyone left from the house
of Saul, that I may show him kindness for Jonathan's sake?"
2 And there was a servant of the house of Saul whose name
was Ziba, and they called him to David, and the king said to
him, "Are you Ziba the servant?" And he said, "Your servant
is he." 3 And the king said, "Isn't there anyone left from the
house of Saul, who I may show the kindness of God?" And
Ziba said to the king, "Jonathan still has a son, who has lame
feet." 4 And the king said to him, "Where is he?" And Ziba
said to the king, "Behold, he is in the house of Machir the son
of Ammiel, in Lo-debar."

9:5 Then king David sent, and fetched him out of the
house of Machir the son of Ammiel, from Lo-debar. 6 And
Mephibaal, the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, came to
David, and fell on his face, and did obeisance to him. And
David said to him, "Mephibaal." And he answered, "Behold,
your servant!" 7 And David said to him, "Don't be afraid, for
I will surely show you kindness for the sake of Jonathan your
father, and will restore you all the land of Saul your father,
and you will eat bread at my table continually." 8 And he did
obeisance, and said, "What is your servant, that you should
look on such a dead dog as I am?"

9:9 Then the king called to Ziba, Saul's servant, and said to
him, "All that belonged to Saul and to all his house I have
given to your master's son. 10 And you shall till the land for
him, you, and your sons, and your servants, and you shall
bring food into your master's house and they will eat, and
Mephibaal your master's son shall always eat bread at my ta-
ble." And Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants. 11 Then
Ziba said to the king, "According to all that my lord the
king commands his servant, so shall your servant do." And
Mephibaal ate at the king's table, as one of the king's sons.

9:12 And Mephibaal had a young son, whose name was
Mica. And all who lived in the house of Ziba were servants
to Mephibaal. 13 And Mephibaal lived in Jerusalem, for he ate
continually at the king's table. And he was lame in both his
feet.

Chapter 10

10:1 And it happened after this, that the king of the chil-
dren of Ammon died, and Hanun his son reigned in his place.
2 And David said, "I will show kindness to Hanun the son of
Nahash, as his father showed kindness to me." And David
sent to comfort him concerning his father by the hand of his
servants. And David's servants came into the land of the chil-
dren of Ammon. 3 And the princes of the children of Ammon
said to Hanun their lord, "Is David honouring your father
in your eyes because he has sent comforters to you? Hasn't
David sent his servants to you to search the city, and to spy it
out, and to overthrow it?" 4 And Hanun took David's servants,
and shaved off their beards, and cut off their garments in the
middle, even to their buttocks, and sent them away. 5 And
when David was told about the men, he sent to meet them,
for the men were greatly ashamed. And the king said, "Stay
in Jericho until your beards have grown, and then return."

10:6 And when the children of Ammon saw that they
stank to David, the children of Ammon sent and hired the
Arameans of Beth-rehob, and the Arameans of Zobah, 20,000
footmen, and the king of Maacah with 1,000 men, and the men
of Tob: 12,000 men. 7 And when David heard of it, he sent
Joab, and all the host of the mighty men. 8 And the children of
Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the entrance
of the city. And the Arameans of Zobah and of Rehob, and
the men of Tob and Maacah, were by themselves in the field.
9 And when Joab saw that the battle was set against him be-
fore and behind, he chose from all the choice men of Israel,
and put them in array against the Arameans. 10 And the rest
of the people he gave into the hand of Abishai his brother, and
he put them in array against the children of Ammon. 11 And
Joab said to Abishai, "If the Arameans are too strong for me
then you shall help me, and if the children of Ammon are too
strong for you then I will come and help you. 12 Be strong,
and let us be strong and fight for our people, and for the cities
of our God, and the Lord do that which is good in his eyes
concerning us."

10:13 And Joab and the people who were with him ap-
proached the battle against the Arameans, and the Arameans
fled before him. 14 And when the children of Ammon saw
that the Arameans had fled, they likewise fled before Abishai,
and entered into the city. Then Joab returned from the chil-
dren of Ammon, and came to Jerusalem. 15 And when Aram
saw that they were beaten before the children of Israel, they
gathered themselves together. 16 And Hadarezer sent, and
brought out the Arameans who were beyond the River, and
they came to Helam, with Shobach the captain of the host of
Hadarezer at their head. 17 And it was told David, and he
gathered all Israel together, and passed over the Jordan, and
came to Helam. And the Arameans set themselves in array
against David, and fought with him. 18 And the Arameans fled
before Israel, and David killed 7,000 charioteers, and 40,000
foot soldiers of Aram, and struck Shobach the captain of their
host and he died there. 19 And when all the kings who were
servants to Hadarezer saw that they were beaten before Is-
rael, they made peace with Israel, and served them. And the
Arameans feared to help the children of Ammon any more.

Chapter 11

11:1 And it happened, at the return of the year, at the time
when kings go out, that David sent Joab together with his ser-
vants and all Israel and they destroyed the children of Am-
mon, and besieged Rabbah. And David stayed in Jerusalem.
2 And it happened at evening, that David rose from his bed,
and walked on the roof of the king's house. And from the
roof he saw a woman bathing, and the woman was very beau-
tiful in appearance. 3 And David sent and asked about the
woman. And *someone* said, "Isn't this Bath-sheba, the daugh-
ter of Eliam, the wife of Uriah the Hittite?" 4 And David sent
messengers, and took her, and he went in to her, and he lay
with her, and she purified herself from her uncleanness, and
she returned to her house.

11:5 And the woman conceived, and she sent and told
David, and said, "I am with child." 6 And David sent to Joab
and said, "Send me Uriah the Hittite." And Joab sent Uriah to
him. 7 And when Uriah had come to David, David asked him
about Joab's peace and the peace of the people and the peace
of the war. And he said, "There is peace." 8 And David said
to Uriah, "Go down to your house, and wash your feet." And
Uriah left the king's presence, and he went out after those who

stand by the king. [9]And Uriah slept at the door of the king's
house with all the servants of his lord, and did not go down
to his house.

[11:10]And when they had told David the king, saying,
"Uriah did not go down to his house," David said to Uriah,
"Haven't you come from a journey? And why didn't you go
down to your house?" [11]And Uriah said to David, "If the holy
ark, and Israel, and Judah, live in booths, and my lord Joab,
and the servants of my lord, are camped in the open field, how
then shall I go into my house, to eat and to drink, and to lie
with my wife? As your soul lives, I will not do this thing."
[12]And David said to Uriah, "Stay here today too, and tomor-
row I will let you leave." And Uriah stayed in Jerusalem that
day. And on the following day [13]David called him and he ate
and drank before him, and he became drunk. And at evening
Uriah went out and lay on a bed with the servants of his lord,
and he did not go down to his house. [14]And it happened in
the morning, that David wrote a letter to Joab, and sent it by
the hand of Uriah. [15]And he wrote in the letter, saying, "Put
Uriah into the strong fighting and withdraw from him, so that
he may be struck and die." [16]And it happened, when Joab
kept watch on the city, that he assigned Uriah to a weak place
because he knew there were valiant men. [17]And the men of
the city went out, and fought with Joab, and some of the peo-
ple fell there according to David's words, and Uriah the Hittite
died too.

[11:18]Then Joab sent and told David all the things con-
cerning the war, [19]and Joab charged the messenger, saying,
"When you have finished telling the king all the things con-
cerning the war, [20]it shall be that, if the king's anger rises,
and he says to you, 'Why did you‡ go so near the city to fight?
Didn't you‡ know they would shoot from the wall? [21]Who
struck Abimelech the son of Jerubbaal? Didn't a woman
throw an upper millstone on him from the wall, and he died
at Thebez? Why did you‡ go so near the wall?' then you shall
say, 'The men prevailed against us and came out against us
in the field, and we were upon them as far as the entrance of
the city. And it was heavy with arrows on your servants from
the wall, so some eighteen of the king's servants are dead, and
your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.'"

[11:22]And the messenger went, and came to the king in
Jerusalem and showed David all that Joab had sent him for.
And David's anger burned against Joab, and he said to the
messenger, "Why did you‡ go so near the city to fight? Didn't
you‡ know they would shoot from the wall? Who struck down
Abimelech the son of Jerubbaal? Didn't a woman throw an
upper millstone on him from the wall, and he died at The-
bez? Why did you‡ go so near the wall?" [23]And the messen-
ger said to David, "The men prevailed against us, and came
out to us into the field, and we were upon them as far as the
entrance of the city. [24]And it was heavy with arrows on your
servants from the wall, so some eighteen of the king's servants
are dead, and your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also."
[25]Then David said to the messenger, "Thus shall you say to
Joab, 'Don't let this thing be evil in your eyes, for the sword
consumes one as well as another. Make your battle stronger
against the city, and overthrow it.'"

[11:26]And when the wife of Uriah heard that Uriah her hus-
band was dead, she mourned for her husband. [27]And when
the mourning was past, David sent and took Bathsheba to his
house, and she became his wife, and bore him a son. And the
thing that David had done displeased the Lord.

Chapter 12

[12:1]And the Lord sent Nathan the prophet to David. And
Nathan came to David, and said to him, "Judge this case for
me. There were two men in one city, one rich, and the other
poor. [2]The rich man had very many flocks and herds, [3]and
the poor man had nothing, except one little ewe lamb, which
he had bought and kept safe and nourished. And it grew up
together with him, and with his children, it ate from his own
morsel, and drank from his own cup, and lay on his chest, and
was like a daughter to him. [4]And a stranger came to the rich
man, and he spared his own flock and his own herd from be-
ing taken to prepare for the wayfarer who had come to him,
and took the poor man's lamb, and slaughtered it for the man
who had come to him."

[12:5]And David's anger was greatly kindled against the man,
and he said to Nathan, "As the Lord lives, the man who has
done this is a son of death, [6]and he shall restore the lamb four-
fold, because he did this thing, and because he had no pity."
[7]And Nathan said to David, "You are the man. For thus says
the Lord, the God of Israel, 'I anointed you king over Israel,
and I delivered you out of the hand of Saul, [8]and I gave you
your master's house, and your master's wives into your bo-
som, and gave you the house of Israel and of Judah, and if that
had been too little, I would have added to you as many again
as these. [9]Why have you despised the Lord, to do that which
is evil in his sight? You have struck Uriah the Hittite with
the sword, and have taken his wife to be your wife, and have
killed him with the sword of the children of Ammon. [10]And
now the sword shall never leave your house, because you have
despised me, and have taken the wife of Uriah the Hittite to
be your wife.' [11]Thus says the Lord, 'Behold, I will raise up
evil against you out of your own house, and I will take your
wives before your eyes, and give them to your neighbour, and
he shall lie with your wives in the sight of this sun. [12]For you
did it secretly, and I will do this thing before all Israel, and
before this sun.'"

[12:13]And David said to Nathan, "I have sinned against the
Lord." And Nathan said to David, "The Lord has also put
your sin away, you shall not die. [14]However, because by this
deed you have despised the Lord the child also who is born
to you shall surely die."

[12:15]And Nathan departed to his house. And God struck
the child that Uriah's wife bore to David, and it was very sick.
[16]And David sought God for the child, and David fasted, and
went in, and lay all night in sackcloth on the earth. [17]And the
elders of his house came near him, to raise him up from the
earth, and he would not, neither did he eat bread with them.
[18]And it happened on the seventh day, that the child died.
And the servants of David feared to tell him that the child was
dead, for they said, "Behold, while the child was still alive, we
spoke to him to raise him up from the ground, and he did not
listen to our voice. How will he then vex himself, if we tell
him that the child is dead!" [19]And when David saw that his
servants were whispering together, David perceived that the
child was dead, and David said to his servants, "Is the child
dead?" And they said, "He is dead."

[12:20]Then David rose from the earth, and washed, and
anointed himself, and changed his clothes. And he came into

the house of the Lord, and worshipped, then he came to his
own house and he asked for food to eat, and food was brought
before him, and he ate. 21 Then his servants said to him, "What
is this thing you have done? While the child was alive, you
fasted and wept and watched; and when the child was dead,
you rose and ate food and drank." 22 And he said, "While the
child was still alive I fasted and wept, for I said, 'Who knows
whether the Lord will not be gracious to me, that the child
may live?' 23 And now the child is dead, why should I fast?
Can I bring him back? I shall go to him, and he will not re-
turn to me."

12:24 And David comforted Bath-sheba his wife, and went in
to her, and she lay with him, and she bore a son, and he called
his name Solomon. And the Lord loved him 25 and he sent
by the hand of Nathan the prophet, and he called his name
Jedidiah[a] , by the word of the Lord.

12:26 And Joab fought against Rabbah of the children of Am-
mon, and took the royal city. 27 And Joab sent messengers to
David, and said, "I have fought against Rabbah, also I have
taken the city of waters. 28 And now gather the rest of the peo-
ple together, and camp against the city, and take it yourself,
lest I take the city, and it be called after my name." 29 And
David gathered all the people together, and went to Rabbah,
and fought against it, and took it. 30 And he took the crown of
their king from his head, and the weight of it was a talent of
gold and there was a precious stone, and it was set on David's
head. And he brought out the spoil of the city in great abun-
dance. 31 And he brought forth the people who were in it, and
cut it with saws, and with harrows of iron, and with axes of
iron; and he made them pass to the brickwork. And thus he
did to all the cities of the children of Ammon. And David and
all the people returned to Jerusalem.

Chapter 13

13:1 And it happened after this, that Abishalom the son
of David had a sister very beautiful in appearance, whose
name was Tamar, and Aminon the son of David loved her.
2 And Aminon was so distressed that he became sick be-
cause of his sister Tamar, for she was a virgin and it seemed
hard to Aminon to do anything to her. 3 And Aminon had
a friend, whose name was Jonathan, the son of Shimeah,
David's brother, and Jonathan was very subtle. 4 And he said
to Aminon, "O son of the king, why are you so poor from day
to day? Won't you tell me?" And Aminon said to him, "I love
Tamar, my brother Abishalom's sister." 5 And Jonathan said
to him, "Lie down on your bed, and pretend to be sick, and
when your father comes to visit you, say to him, 'Please let my
sister Tamar come and give me to eat, and prepare the food in
my sight, that I may see it and eat it from her hand.'"

13:6 And Aminon lay down, and pretended to be sick, and
when the king had come to visit him, Aminon said to the
king, "Let my sister Tamar come to me, please, and make me
a couple of cakes in my sight, that I may eat from her hand."
7 Then David sent home to Tamar, saying, "Go to your brother
Aminon now, and prepare food for him. 8 And Tamar went
to her brother Aminon, and he was lying down. And Tamar
took dough, and kneaded it, and made cakes in his sight, and
baked the cakes. 9 And she took the pan and poured them out
before him and he refused to eat. And Aminon said, "Make
all the men go out from me." And they made all the men go
out from him.

13:10 And Aminon said to Tamar, "Bring the food into the
chamber, that I may eat from your hand." And Tamar took the
cakes which she had made, and brought them into the cham-
ber to Aminon her brother. 11 And when she had brought
them near him to eat, he took hold of her, and said to her,
"Come, lie with me." 12 And she answered him, "No, my
brother, do not force me, for no such thing ought to be done
in Israel. Don't do this folly. 13 And where wouldn't my re-
proach go? And as for you, you will be as one of the fools
in Israel. And now, please speak to the king, for he will not
withhold me from you." 14 And he would not listen to her, and
being stronger than she, he forced her, and lay with her.

13:15 Then Aminon hated her with very great hatred, for the
hatred with which he hated her was greater than the love with
which he had loved her. And Aminon said to her, "Arise, be
gone." 16 And she said to him, "No, my brother, because this
latter evil in putting me out is greater than the former that you
did to me." And he would not listen to her. 17 Then he called
his servant who ministered to him, and said to him, "Put this
woman out from me now, and bolt the door after her."

13:18 And she had a varicoloured[a] garment on her, for like
that the king's daughters who were virgins clothed them-
selves in their robes. Then his servant brought her out, and
bolted the door after her. 19 And Tamar took ashes and put
them on her head, and tore her varicoloured garment that was
on her, and she laid her hands on her head, and went her way,
crying aloud as she went. 20 And Abishalom her brother said
to her, "Has Aminon your brother been with you? And now
hold your peace, my sister. He is your brother, do not set your
heart to say anything." And Tamar remained and was deso-
late in her brother Abishalom's house.

13:21 And when king David heard of all these things, he was
very angry, but did nothing to pain his son Aminon, for he
loved him because he was his firstborn. 22 And Abishalom
spoke neither good nor bad to Aminon, for Abishalom hated
Aminon, because he had forced his sister Tamar.

13:23 And it happened after two years, that Abishalom had
sheep-shearers in Baal-hazor, which is beside Ephron, and
Abishalom invited all the king's sons. 24 And Abishalom came
to the king, and said, "Behold now, your servant has sheep-
shearers. Please let the king and his servants go to his ser-
vant." 25 And the king said to Abishalom, "No, my son, let
us not all go, lest we be burdensome to you." And he urged
him, and the king would not go, and blessed him. 26 Then
Abishalom said, "If not, please let my brother Aminon go
with me." And the king said, "Why should he go with you?"
27 And Abishalom urged him, and he let Aminon and all the
king's sons go with him. And Abishalom made a banquet like
a king's banquet.

13:28 And Abishalom commanded his servants, saying,
"Now see, when Aminon's heart is merry with wine, and
when I say to you, "Strike Aminon," then kill him. Do not fear,
for I have commanded you. Be courageous, and be valiant
men." 29 And the servants of Abishalom did to Aminon as

[a] 12:25: That is, beloved of the Lord.
[a] 13:18: Like Joseph's in Genesis 37:3.

Abishalom had commanded. Then all the king's sons arose, and every man got onto his mule, and fled.

13:30 And it happened, while they were on the way, that the news came to David, saying, "Abishalom has killed all the king's sons, and there is not one of them left." 31 Then the king rose, and tore his garments, and lay on the earth, and all his servants stood by with their clothes torn. 32 And Jonadab, the son of Shimeah, David's brother, answered and said, "Don't let my lord the king say that all the young men the king's sons are dead, for Aminon only is dead: because Abishalom has been angry against him from the day that he forced his sister Tamar. 33 And now don't let my lord the king take the thing to his heart, saying that all the king's sons are dead, for Aminon only is dead."

13:34 And Abishalom fled. And the young man that kept the watch lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, many people came by the Horonaim road by the side of the mountain in the descent. And the watchman came and told the king, and said, "I have seen men on the Horonaim road by the side of the mountain." 35 And Jonadab said to the king, "Behold, the king's sons have come. As your servant said, so it is." 36 And it happened, as soon as he had finished speaking, that behold, the king's sons came, and lifted up their voice, and wept. And the king also and all his servants wept with a very great weeping.

13:37 And Abishalom fled, and went to Talmai the son of Ammihur, king of Geshur. And the king mourned for his son every day. 38 And Abishalom fled, and went to Geshur in the region of Helam, and was there three years. 39 And the spirit of the king stopped going out against Abishalom, for he was comforted concerning Aminon, seeing he was dead.

Chapter 14

14:1 And Joab the son of Zeruiah knew that the king's heart was on Abishalom. 2 And Joab sent to Tekoa, and fetched from there a wise woman, and said to her, "Please pretend to be a mourner, and put on mourning clothes, and please, do not anoint yourself with oil, and be as a woman who has mourned a long time for the dead, 3 and go in to the king, and speak in this manner to him." And Joab put the words in her mouth.

14:4 And when the woman of Tekoa came to the king, she fell on her face to the ground, and did obeisance, and said, "Help, O king, help." 5 And the king said to her, "What ails you?" And the woman answered, "Truly, I am a widow, and my husband is dead. 6 And your handmaid had two sons, and they struggled together in the field, and there was no mediator between them, and one struck his brother, and killed him. 7 And, behold, the whole family has risen against your handmaid, saying, "Deliver him who struck his brother, that we may kill him for the life of his brother who he killed," and destroy your heir. Thus they will quench the one coal that I have left to me, and will leave to my husband neither name nor remainder on the face of the earth."

14:8 And the king said to the woman, "Go to your house in peace, and I will give charge concerning you." 9 And the woman of Tekoa said to the king, "My lord, O king, the iniquity be on me and on my father's house, and the king and the king's throne be guiltless." 10 And the king said, "Whoever says a word to you, bring him to me, and he shall not touch you any more." 11 Then said she, "Please, let my lord the king remember the Lord your God, that the avengers of blood not destroy any more, lest you destroy my son." And the king said, "As the Lord lives, not one hair of your son shall fall to the earth."

14:12 Then the woman of Tekoa said, "Let your handmaid, please, speak a word to my lord the king." And the king said, "Say on." 13 And the woman said, "Why then have you devised such a thing against the people of the Lord? For because the king has put aside this thing, the king is as one who is guilty, in that the king does not fetch home again the one banished from him. 14 For your son is dead, and as water spilled on the ground cannot be gathered up again, he cannot take up his soul again, yet the king thinks to banish the banished one from him. 15 And now, seeing that I have come to speak this word to the king, it is because the people have made me afraid, and your handmaid said, 'Your handmaid will now speak to the king. It may be that the king will perform the request of his servant. 16 For the king will hear, and deliver his servant out of the hand of the man who is seeking to destroy me and my son together out of the inheritance of the Lord.' 17 Then your handmaid said, 'Please let the word of my lord the king be comfortable, for as an angel of the Lord, so is my lord the king to discern good and bad, and the Lord your God will be with you.'"

14:18 Then the king answered and said to the woman, "Please do not hide from me anything that I shall ask you." And the woman said, "Let my lord the king now speak." 19 And the king said, "Is the hand of Joab with you in all this?" And the woman answered and said to the king, "As your soul lives, my lord the king, none can turn to the right hand or to the left from anything that my lord the king has spoken, for your servant Joab, he told me, and he put all these words in the mouth of your handmaid. 20 Your servant Joab has done this thing to change the face of the matter. And my lord is wise, according to the wisdom of an angel of God, to know what is in the earth."

14:21 And the king said to Joab, "Behold now, I will do according to your advice. And go, bring the young man Abishalom back." 22 And Joab fell to the ground on his face, and did obeisance, and blessed the king. And Joab said, "Today your servant knows that I have found favor in your sight, my lord, O king, in that the king has performed the request of his servant." 23 And Joab rose and went to Geshur, and brought Abishalom to Jerusalem. 24 And the king said, Let him turn to his own house, and let him not see my face. And Abishalom turned to his own house, and did not see the king's face.

14:25 And there was no one in Israel to be praised for his beauty as much as Abishalom. From the sole of his foot even to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him. 26 And when he cut the hair of his head (now it was at every year's end that he cut it, because it was heavy on him, and he cut it), he weighed the hair of his head at 100 shekels, by the king's shekel. 27 And to Abishalom there were born three sons, and one daughter, whose name was Maacah. She was a woman of a beautiful appearance, and she became the wife of Rehoboam son of Solomon, and bore to him Abijah.

14:28 And Abishalom lived two full years in Jerusalem and he did not see the king's face. 29 Then Abishalom sent for Joab, to send him to the king, and Joab would not come to him. And

he sent again a second time, and he would not come. [30]And Abishalom said to his servants, "See, Joab's portion in the field is near ours, and he has barley there. Go and see, and set it on fire." And Abishalom's servants set the field on fire. Then Joab's servants came to him with their clothes torn, and said, "Abishalom's servants have set the field on fire." [31]And Joab rose, and came to Abishalom at his house, and said to him, "Why have your servants set my field on fire?" [32]And Abishalom answered Joab, "Behold, I sent to you once and a second time, saying, 'Come here, that I may send you to the king, to say, "Why have I come from Geshur? It would be better for me to be still there. And now let me see the king's face, and if there is iniquity in me, let me be put to death."'"

[14:33]And Joab came to the king and told him. And when he had called for Abishalom, he came to the king, and bowed himself to him and fell on his face to the ground before the king, and the king kissed Abishalom.

Chapter 15

[15:1]And it happened after this, that Abishalom prepared for himself a chariot and horses, and fifty men to run before him. [2]And Abishalom rose up early, and stood beside the way of the gate. And whenever there was any man who had a suit that should come to the king for judgment, then Abishalom called to him, and said, "What city are you from?" And he answered and said, "Your servant is from one of the tribes of Israel." [3]And Abishalom said to him, "See, your matters are good and right, and there is no one from the king to hear you." [4]And Abishalom said, "Who shall make me judge over the land, over Israel, that every man who has any suit might come to me, and I would do him justice?" [5]And it happened that when any man came near to bow down to him, he put out his hand, and took hold of him, and kissed him. [6]And Abishalom behaved like this to all Israel who came to the king for judgment. And Abishalom stole the hearts of all the men of Israel.

[15:7]And it happened at the end of four years, that Abishalom said to the king, saying, "Please, let me go and pay my vow, which I have vowed to the Lord, in Hebron. [8]For your servant vowed a vow while I stayed at Geshur in Aram, saying, 'If the Lord shall indeed bring me again to Jerusalem, then I will serve the Lord in Hebron.'" [9]And the king said to him, "Go in peace." And Abishalom arose, and went to Hebron. [10]And Abishalom sent spies throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, "As soon as you hear the sound of the trumpet, then you shall say, 'Abishalom is king in Hebron.'"

[15:11]And two hundred men who were invited went with Abishalom out of Jerusalem. And they went in their simplicity, and they did not know anything. [12]And Abishalom sent and called Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counsellor, from his city, Giloh, while he was offering the sacrifices. And the conspiracy was going on and was strong, and the people went on increasing with Abishalom.

[15:13]And a messenger came to David, saying, "The hearts of all Israel are with Abishalom." [14]And David said to all his servants who were with him at Jerusalem, "Rise, and let us flee, otherwise none of us shall escape from Abishalom. Leave quickly, lest the people overtake us quickly, and bring down the city upon us, and strike the city with the edge of the sword." [15]And the king's servants said to him, "Behold, we are your servants in whatever the king shall choose." [16]And the king went out, and all his household with him. And the king left ten of his concubines to keep his house.

[15:17]And the king went forth, and all the people with him, and they waited in Beth-merhak. [18]And all his servants passed on beside him, and all the Cherethites and all the Pelethites, and they stopped beside a certain olive tree in the wilderness, and all the people passed on beside him. And all those who were with him, all the officers and the warriors, were 600 men, and they passed on beside him. And when all the Cherethites, all the Pelethites, and all the Gittites who had come to his feet from Gath, passed on,

[15:19]then the king said to Ittai the Gittite, "Why are you going with us too? Return, and stay with the king, for you are a foreigner, and an exile from your own place. [20]Since you only came yesterday, should I today make you go up and down with us, seeing I go where I may? Go, return and take your brothers back, may the Lord show mercy and truth to you." [21]And Ittai answered the king, and said, "As the Lord lives, and as you yourself live, my lord the king, surely in whatever place my lord the king shall be, whether for death or for life, even there also will your servant be." [22]And David the king said to Ittai the Gittite, "Go and pass over with me." And Ittai passed over, and all his servants, and the king and all his men. [23]And all the country blessed and wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over. The king himself also passed over the brook Kidron, and all the people passed over before him on the Way of Olives in the wilderness.

[15:24]And, behold, Zadok also *passed over*, and all the Levites with him, bearing the ark of the covenant of God. And they set down the ark of the covenant until all the people had finished passing out of the city. [25]And the king said to Zadok, "Carry the ark of God back into the city and set it in its place. If I find favor in the eyes of the Lord, he will bring me again, and show me both it, and his dwelling place. [26]And if he says to me thus, 'I have no delight in you,' behold, here I am, let him do to me as is good in his eyes." [27]The king also said to Zadok the priest, "Behold, return into the city in peace, together with your two sons, Ahimaaz your son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar. [28]See, I will wait beside an olive tree in the wilderness, until there word comes from you to report to me." [29]And Zadok and Abiathar carried the ark of God to Jerusalem again and set it there.

[15:30]And David went up by the ascent of the Olives, and wept as he went up, and he had his head covered, and went barefoot. And of all the people who were with him every man covered his head, and they went up, weeping as they went up. [31]And it was told to David, saying, "Ahithophel also is among the conspirators with Abishalom." And David said, "O Lord God, please, turn the counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness."

[15:32]And it happened that when David had come to the top, and worshipped the Lord there, behold, David's friend Hushai the Archite came to meet him there with his coat torn, and earth on his head. [33]And the king said to him, "If you pass on with me, then you will be a burden to me, [34]and if you return to the city, and say to Abishalom, 'Your brothers departed, O king, after your father departed, and now I will be your servant, O king. Let me live. I have been your father's servant in time past, and I will now be your servant,'—then defeat for me the counsel of Ahithophel. [35]And Zadok

and Abiathar will be the priests with you there. And it shall be, that whatever thing you hear from the king, you shall tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests. 36Behold, they have there with them their two sons, Ahimaaz, Zadok's son, and Jonathan, Abiathar's son, and by them you shall send to me everything that you shall hear." 37And Hushai the Archite, David's friend, came into the city, and Abishalom came into Jerusalem, and Ahithophel was with him.

Chapter 16

16:1And when David was a little past the top, behold, Ziba the servant of Mephibaal met him, with a couple of donkeys saddled, and on them two hundred loaves of bread, an ephah of raisins, two hundred date-cakes, and a bottle of wine. 2And the king said to Ziba, "What do you mean by these?" And Ziba said, "The saddled donkeys are for the king's household to ride on, and the bread and date-cakes and raisins for the young men to eat, and the wine is so that whoever is faint in the wilderness may drink." 3And the king said, "Where is your master's son?" And Ziba said to the king, "Behold, he is staying in Jerusalem, and he said, 'Today the children of Israel will restore me the kingdom of my father.'" 4Then the king said to Ziba, "Behold, all that belongs to Mephibaal is yours." And Ziba said, "I bow down! I have found favour in your sight, my lord, O king."

16:5And when king David came to Bahurim, behold, a man from the family of the house of Saul, whose name was Shimei the son of Gera, was coming out from there. He came out, cursing as he came, 6and throwing stones at David, and at all his servants. And all the people and all the mighty men were on the right hand and on the left of the king. 7And as he cursed, Shimei said, "Go away, go away, you man of blood, and man of belial[a] . 8The Lord has returned on you all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose place you have reigned, and the Lord has delivered the kingdom into the hand of Abishalom your son, and he caused you to see your own evil, because you are a man of blood."

16:9Then Abishai the son of Zeruiah said to the king, "Why should this accursed dog curse my lord the king? Please let me go over and take off his head." 10And the king said to Abishai, "What do I have to do with you, O son of Zeruiah? And let him alone; for he curses me because the Lord has said to him, 'Curse David;' and who shall say, 'Why have you done so?'" 11And David said to Abishai, and to all his servants, "Behold, my son who came forth from my body[b] seeks my life: how much more this Benjamite now? Leave him alone and let him curse, for the Lord has spoken to him. 12It may be that the Lord will look on my affliction, and that the Lord will return me good for his cursing of me this day."

16:13And David and his men went by the way, and Shimei went along on the hill-side over against him, and cursed as he went, and threw stones at him, and threw dust.

16:14And the king, and all the people who were with him, came weary at the Jordan, and he refreshed himself there. 15And Abishalom, and all the people, the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel was with him. 16And it happened, when Hushai the Archite, David's friend, had come to Abishalom, to the city, that Hushai said to Abishalom, "May the king live! 17And Abishalom said to Hushai, "Is this your kindness to your friend? Why didn't you go with your friend?" 18And Hushai said to Abishalom, "No! for I will belong to the one the Lord, this people, and all the men of Israel have chosen, and I will stay with him. 19And again, who should I serve? Is it not in the presence of his son? As I have served your father, so will I be with you."

16:20Then Abishalom said to Ahithophel, "Give your advice what we shall do." 21And Ahithophel said to Abishalom, "Go in to your father's concubines, who he has left to keep the house, and all Israel will hear that you have put your father to shame. Then your hands and the hands of all who are with you will be strong." 22And they spread Abishalom a tent on the top of the house and Abishalom went in to all his father's concubines in the sight of all Israel. 23And the advice of Ahithophel, which he gave in former days, was as if a man inquired at the oracle of God, so was all the advice of Ahithophel both with David and with Abishalom.

Chapter 17

17:1And Ahithophel said to Abishalom, "Please let me choose for myself 10,000 men, and I will rise and pursue David tonight, 2and I will come upon him while he is weary and weak-handed, and I will make him afraid. And all the people who are with him will run away, and I will strike the king only. 3And all the people will come back to you, as a bride returns to her husband. It is only the life of one man that you seek, and all the people will be at peace." 4And the saying pleased Abishalom well, and all the elders of Israel. 5Then Abishalom said, "Please call Hushai the Archite also, and let us hear what he says."

17:6And when Hushai had come to Abishalom, Abishalom spoke to Hushai about the word that Ahithophel had said. Shall we do his word? And if not, you speak." 7And Hushai said to Abishalom, "The advice that Ahithophel has given this time is not good." 8And Hushai said again, "You know your father and the men with him, that they are very mighty men, and they are bitter of soul, as a bear robbed of her cubs in the field. And your father is a man of war, and will not spend the night with the people. 9And behold, he will be hidden in some pit, or somewhere. And it will happen, when the people fall at the first attack, that whoever hears it will say, "There is a slaughter among the people who follow Abishalom." 10And even he who is valiant, whose heart is as the heart of a lion, will absolutely melt, for all Israel knows that your father is a mighty man, and those who are with him are valiant men. 11For this is the advice that I advise: Let all Israel be gathered together to you, from Dan even to Beer-sheba, like the sand that is by the sea in number, and that you go into their midst in your own person. 12And we shall come upon him in some place where he shall be found, and we will fall on him as the dew falls on the ground, and of him and of all the men who are with him we will not leave so much as one. 13And, if he has gone into a city, then all Israel shall bring ropes to that city, and we will draw it into the river, until there is not one small stone found there."

[a]16:7: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.

[b]16:11: Hebrew: inward parts. The word is used to refer to either reproductive (as here) or digestive organs.

17:14 And Abishalom and all Israel said, "The advice of Hushai the Archite is better than the advice of Ahithophel." For the Lord had commanded the defeat of the good counsel of Ahithophel, so that the Lord's evil might be brought on Abishalom. 15 Then Hushai said to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, "Ahithophel gave such and such advice to Abishalom and the elders of Israel, and I have given such and such advice. 16 And now quickly tell the king, saying, 'Do not spend the night tonight at the fords of the wilderness, and also pass over the waters, lest the king and all the people who are with him be swallowed up.'"

17:17 And Jonathan and Ahimaaz were staying by En-rogel, and a maid-servant used to go and tell them, and they went and told king David. For they could not be seen or come into the city. 18 And a young man saw them and told Abishalom, and both of them went away quickly and came to the house of a man in Bahurim, and the man had a well in his court, and they went down it. 19 And the woman took the covering and spread it over the well's mouth and spread grain on it, and nothing was known. 20 And Abishalom's servants came to the woman at the house and said, "Where are Ahimaaz and Jonathan?" And the woman said to them, "They have gone quickly over the water." And when they had looked and could not find them, they returned to Jerusalem.

17:21 And it happened, after they had gone, that they came up out of the well, and went and told king David. And they said to him, "Get up, and quickly cross the water, for Ahithophel has advised thus against you." 22 Then David and all the people who were with him got up, and they passed over the Jordan. By the morning light not even one was left behind. Thus they crossed the Jordan.

17:23 And when Ahithophel saw that his advice was not followed, he saddled his donkey, and got up, and went home to his city, and set his house in order, and hanged himself. And he died, and was buried in the sepulchre of his father.

17:24 Then David came to Mahanaim. And Abishalom passed over the Jordan, he and all the men of Israel with him. 25 And Abishalom set Amasa over the army instead of Joab. And Amasa was the son of a man whose name was Jether the Ishmaelite, who went in to Abigail the daughter of Jesse, sister to Zeruiah, Joab's mother. 26 And Abishalom and all the men of Israel encamped in the land of Gilead.

17:27 And it happened, when David had come to Mahanaim, that Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel of Lodebar, and Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim, 28 brought ten beds, and rugs, and ten basins, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and barley, and meal, and parched grain, and beans, and lentils, 29 and honey, and butter, and sheep, and cheese from the herd, and the brought them near for David and for his people to eat; for they said, "The people are hungry, and weary, and thirsty, in the wilderness."

Chapter 18

18:1 And David numbered all the people who were with him, and set captains of thousands and captains of hundreds over them. 2 And David divided the people into three parts, one third under the hand of Joab, one third under the hand of Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and one third under the hand of Ittai the Gittite. And the king said to the people, "I also will surely go forth with you myself." 3 And the people said, "You shall not go forth, for if we run away no-one will set their heart on us, neither will anyone set their heart on us if half of us die. For you are like ten thousand of us. Therefore now it is better for us that you be ready to help us in the city." 4 And the king said to them, "I will do what is good in your eyes." And the king stood beside the gate, and all the people went out by hundreds and by thousands.

18:5 And the king commanded Joab and Abishai and Ittai, saying, "Deal gently with the young man, with Abishalom, for my sake." And all the people heard when the king gave all the captains charge concerning Abishalom. 6 And all the people went out into the field against Israel, and the battle was in the forest of Mahanaim. 7 And the people of Israel were struck there before the servants of David, and there was a great slaughter of 20,000 men that day. 8 For the battle was spread over the whole forest, and the forest consumed more people that day than the sword consumed.

18:9 And Abishalom was far ahead of the servants of David. And he was riding on his mule, and the mule went under the thick boughs of a great oak, and his head caught hold of the oak, and he was left hanging in the tree between heaven and earth, and the mule that was under him went on. 10 And a certain man saw it, and told Joab, and said, "Behold, I saw Abishalom hanging in an oak." 11 And Joab said to the man who had told him, "And, behold, you saw it, and why did you not strike him to the ground there? And I would have given you fifty of silver, and a girdle." 12 And the man said to Joab, "Though I should receive a thousand of silver in my hand, I would still not put out my hand against the king's son, for the king charged you and Abishai and Ittai in our hearing saying, "Beware that no one touch the young man Abishalom." 13 And how can I deal falsely against my soul? For no matter is hidden from the king, and you yourself have set yourself against *me*."

18:14 Then Joab said, "Then I will begin before you." And Joab took three darts in his hand, and thrust them through the heart of Abishalom, while he was still alive in the midst of the oak. 15 And ten young men who bore Joab's armour circled about and struck Abishalom, and killed him. 16 And Joab blew the trumpet, and the people returned from pursuing Israel, for Joab held the people back. 17 And Joab took Abishalom, and threw him into the great pit in the forest, and raised a very great heap of stones over him. And all Israel fled, every one to his tent.

18:18 And when he was still alive Abishalom had taken and raised up the pillar which is in the king's dale, for he said, "I have no son to keep my name in remembrance." And he called the pillar after his own name, and it is called Abishalom's monument to this day.

18:19 Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said to Joab, "Let me run now, let me bring news to David the king, for the Lord has avenged him from the hand of his enemies." 20 And Joab said, "You shall not be the one who brings news on this day, and you shall bring news another day. And today you shall bring no news, because the king's son is dead." 21 Then said Joab to the Cushite, "Go and tell the king what you have seen." And the Cushite bowed to Joab, and ran. 22 Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said yet again to Joab, "And come what may,

please let me also run after the Cushite." And Joab said, "Why do you want to run, my son, seeing that you will have no reward for the news?" [23]And Ahimaaz said, "And come what may, let me run." And he said to him, "Run." Then Ahimaaz ran by the way of the Plain, and outran the Cushite.

[18:24]And David was sitting between the two gates, and the watchman went up to the roof of the gate to the wall, and lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, a single man was running towards him. [25]And the watchman called, and told the king. And the king said, "If he runs alone there is news in his mouth." And he came quickly and drew near. [26]And the watchman saw another man running, and the watchman on the gate called and said, "Behold, another man running alone." And the king said, "He is also bringing news." [27]And the watchman said, "I think the running of the first is like the running of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok." And the king said, "He is a good man, he comes with good news."

[18:28]And Ahimaaz drew near, and said to the king, "All is well." And he bowed himself before the king with his face to the earth, and said, "Blessed be the Lord your God, who has delivered up the men who lifted up their hand against my lord the king." [29]And the king said, "Is the young man Abishalom alright?" And Ahimaaz answered, "When Joab the king's servant was sending your servant, I heard a great noise behind me, and I did not know what was there." [30]And the king said, "Turn aside, and stand here." And he turned aside and stood behind him.

[18:31]And, behold, the Cushite came, and he said to the king, "Tidings for my lord the king, for the Lord has avenged you today of all those who rose up against you." [32]And the king said to the Cushite, "Is it well with the young man Abishalom?" And the Cushite answered, "May the enemies of my lord the king, and all who rise up against you to harm you, be as that young man is." [33a] And the king began to weep, and went up to the chamber over the gate, and wept. And as he wept, he said thus, "O my son Abishalom, my son, my son Abishalom! Would that I had died for you, O Abishalom, my son, my son!"

Chapter 19

[19:1]And they told Joab, "Behold, the king weeps and mourns for Abishalom." [2]And the victory that day was turned into mourning for all the people, for the people heard it said that day, "The king is dismayed and grieves for his son." [3]And the people came into the city stealthily that day, as people who are shattered and ashamed steal away when they run away in battle. [4]And the king covered his face, and he cried with a loud voice, "O my son Abishalom, O Abishalom, my son!"

[19:5]And Joab came into the house to the king, and said, "Today you have shamed the faces of your servants, who have saved your life today, and the lives of your sons and of your daughters, and the lives of your wives, and the lives of your concubines, [6]because you love those who hate you, and hate those who love you. For you have declared this day, that princes and servants are nothing to you, for you know that if Abishalom were alive today, we would all have died; then you would have been well pleased. [7]And now rise, go out and speak comfortably to your servants, for they have promised by the Lord that if you do not go out there to meet with the people, not a man will stay with you this night. And know for yourself that will be worse to you than all the evil that has happened to you from your youth until now."

[19:8]Then the king rose, and sat in the gate. And they told all the people, saying, "Behold, the king is sitting in the gate," and all the people came before the king. And every man of Israel had fled to his tent.

[19:9]And all the people were murmuring throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, "David the king saved us from all our enemies, and he saved us out of the hand of the Philistines, and now he has fled out of the land and from being over the kingdom and from Abishalom. [10]And Abishalom, who we anointed king over us, is dead in battle. And now, why don't you‡ speak a word to bring the king back? And when the word of all Israel came to the king,

[19:11]then king David sent to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, saying, "Speak to the elders of Judah, saying, 'Why are you the last to bring the king back to his house? [12]You are my brothers, you are my bone and my flesh. Why then are you the last to bring the king back to his house?' [13]And say to Amasa, 'Are you‡ not my bone and my flesh? And now, God do so to me, and more also, if you are not captain of the army before me continually in place of Joab.'" [14]And Amasa bowed the heart of all the men of Judah as one man and they sent to the king, "Return, you and all your servants." [15]And the king returned, and came to the Jordan. And the men of Judah came to Gilgal, to go down to meet the king, to bring the king over the Jordan.

[19:16]And Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite, who was from Bahurim, hurried and came down with the men of Judah to meet king David. [17]And there were a thousand men of Benjamin with him, and Ziba the servant of the house of Saul, and his fifteen sons and his twenty servants with him, and they sent across the Jordan in the presence of the king. [18]And they performed the service of bringing the king over, and doing what was good in his eyes. And Shimei the son of Gera fell on his face before the king, when he had come over the Jordan.

[19:19]And he said to the king, "Let my lord not impute iniquity, and do not remember that which your servant did perversely on the day that my lord the king went out of Jerusalem, that the king should take it to his heart. [20]For your servant knows that I have sinned, and behold, I have come today as the first of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king."

[19:21]And Abishai the son of Zeruiah answered and said, "Shimei shall be put to death for this, because he cursed the Lord's anointed." [22]And David said, "What do I have to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah, that you should be adversaries to me today? Shall any man be put to death today in Israel? For don't you know that today I am king over Israel?" [23]And the king said to Shimei, "You shall not die." And the king promised to him.

[19:24]And Mephibaal the son of Jonathan the son of Saul came down to meet the king, and he had neither dressed his feet nor his hands, nor trimmed his beard, nor washed his

[a]18:33: Some other editions count this verse (18:33) as 19:1 and number the verses numbered here as chapter 19 one verse number higher (i.e. 19:2 And they told Joab

clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came home in peace to Jerusalem. [25]And it happened, when he had come from Jerusalem to meet the king, that the king said to him, "Why didn't you go with me, Mephibaal?" [26]And Mephibaal said to him, "My lord, O king, my servant deceived me. For your servant said to him, "Saddle me a donkey, so I may ride on it, and go with the king," because your servant is lame. [27]And he has slandered your servant to my lord the king, and my lord the king, as the angel of God, did what was good in my sight. [28]For all my father's house were but dead men before my lord the king, yet you put your servant among those who ate at your own table. From whose hand could I receive justice?" And he cried out to the king. [29]And the king said to him, "Why multiply your words? I say, you and Ziba divide the land." [30]And Mephibaal said to the king, "Yes, let him take it all, for my lord the king has come in peace to his own house."

[19:31]And Barzillai the Gileadite came down from Rogelim, and he went from the Jordan with the king, to conduct him from the Jordan. [32]Now Barzillai was a very old man, even eighty years old, and he had provided the king with sustenance while he lay at Mahanaim, for he was a very great man.

[19:33]And the king said to Barzillai, "Come over with me, and I will sustain your old age with me in Jerusalem." [34]And Barzillai said to the king, "How many days would I live there, that I should go up with the king to Jerusalem? [35]Today I am eighty years old. Can I discern between good and bad? Can your servant taste what I eat or what I drink? Can I hear the voice of singing men and singing women? Why then should your servant be a burden to my lord the king? [36]For your servant would but just go over the Jordan with the king. And why should the king repay me with such a reward? [37]Please let your servant turn back again, that I may die in my own city, and be buried in the grave of my father and my mother. And behold, your servant Chimham my son; let him go over with my lord the king, and do to him what is good in your eyes."

[19:38]And the king said to him, "Chimham shall go over with me, and I will do to him that which is good in my eyes. And whatever you shall require of me I will do for you." [39]And all the people went over the Jordan, and the king stayed, and the king kissed Barzillai, and blessed him. And Barzillai returned to his own place. [40]And the king went over to Gilgal, and Chimham went over with him, and all the people of Judah and also half the people of Israel brought the king over.

[19:41]And, behold, all the men of Israel came to the king, and said to the king, "Why have our brothers the men of Judah stolen you away, and brought the king, and his household, over the Jordan, and all David's men with him?" [42]And the men of Judah answered the men of Israel and said, "Because the king is a close relative to us. Why then are you angry because of this? Have we eaten at all at the king's cost? Or has he given us any gift? Or has he brought us a present?" [43]And the men of Israel answered the men of Judah, and said, "We have ten parts in the king, and also I am the firstborn rather than you. Why then did you despise us, that our advice should not be first had in bringing back our king?" And the words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel.

Chapter 20

[20:1]And there happened to be there a worthless fellow, whose name was Sheba, the son of Bichri, a Benjamite. And he blew the trumpet, and said, "We have no portion in David, neither do we have any inheritance in the son of Jesse. Every man to his tents, O Israel." [2]And all Israel went up from following David, and followed Sheba the son of Bichri. And the men of Judah clung to their king, from the Jordan as far as Jerusalem.

[20:3]And David came to his house at Jerusalem, and the king took the ten women, his concubines who he had left to keep his house, and put them in a watch-house and sustained them, and he did not go into them. And they were shut up to the day of their death, living as widows.

[20:4]Then said the king to Amasa, "Call the men of Judah together to me within three days, and you be here present. [5]And Amasa went to call Judah together, and he delayed longer than the time which he had appointed him. [6]And David said to Abishai, "Now Sheba the son of Bichri will do us more harm than Abishalom did. And now, take with you your lord's servants, and pursue after him, lest he should get fortified cities, and cast a shadow on our sight." [7]And after Abishai he called out the people and Joab, and the Pelethites, and all the mighty men from Jerusalem to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri.

[20:8]When they were at the great stone which is on the hill, Amasa came to meet them. And Joab was girded in his tunic for clothing, and he was girded with a sword in its sheath fastened at his waist, and it came out and fell. [9]And Joab said to Amasa, "Is it well with you, my brother?" And Joab took Amasa by the beard with his right hand to kiss him. [10]And Amasa was not on guard against the sword that was in Joab's hand, and he struck him with it in the body, and spilled his bowels to the ground. And he did not strike him again, and he died. And Joab and Abishai his brother pursued after Sheba the son of Bichri.

[20:11]And one of Joab's young men stood beside Amasa, and said, "He who favours Joab, and he who is for David, let him follow Joab." [12]And Amasa lay wallowing in his blood in the middle of the highway. And when the man saw that all the people stood still, he carried Amasa out of the highway into the field, and threw a garment over him, when he saw that everyone who came by him stood still. [13]When he had removed Amasa from the highway, all the people went on after Joab, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri.

[20:14]And he went through all the tribes of Israel, even to Abel, and to Beth-maacah, and all the cities gathered together and also went after him. [15]And they came and besieged him in Abel of Beth-maacah, and they cast up a mound against the city, and it stood against the rampart. And all the people who were with Joab were intending to topple the wall.

[20:16]Then a wise woman cried out of the city, "Hear, hear! Please tell Joab to come here so I may speak with him."" [17]And Joab came near her, and the woman said, "Are you Joab?" And he answered, "I am." Then she said, "Hear the words of your handmaid." And he answered, "I hear. Speak." [18]Then she said, "They used to say a saying in the old time, "They shall surely ask at Abel and Dan, whether what the builders of Israel intended has been carried out." [19]You seek to destroy a city and a mother in Israel. Why will you swallow up the inheritance of the Lord?" [20]And Joab answered and said, "Far be it from me, that I should swallow up or de-

stroy. [21]The matter is not so. For a man of the hill-country of Ephraim, Sheba the son of Bichri, has lifted up his hand against the king, even against David. Deliver him only, and I will leave the city." And the woman said to Joab, "Behold, his head shall be thrown to you from the wall." [22]And she spoke wisely to all the city. And they cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri, and threw it out to Joab. And Joab blew the trumpet, and they were dispersed from the city, every man to his tent. And Joab returned to Jerusalem to the king.

[20:23]And Joab was over all the host of Israel, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and over the Pelethites, [24]and Adonairam was over the forced labour, and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder, [25]and Shavsha was scribe, and Zadok and Abiathar were priests, [26]and also Jehoiada the Jairite was chief minister to David.

Chapter 21

[21:1]And there was a famine in the land in the days of David three years, year after year, and David sought the face of the Lord. And the Lord said, "There is blood on Saul and on his house. The guilt is because of his killing of the Gibeonites." [2]And the king called the Gibeonites, and spoke to them. (And the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, for they were of the remnant of the Amorites, and the children of Israel had promised them not to destroy them. And Saul had risen to exterminate them in zeal for Israel and Judah).

[21:3]And David said to the Gibeonites, "What shall I do for you? and how shall I make atonement, that you may bless the inheritance of the Lord?" [4]And the Gibeonites said to him, "It is no matter of silver or gold between us and Saul, or his house, neither is it for us to put any man to death from all Israel." And he said, "What do you want? For I will do it for you." [5]And they said to the king, "The man who set himself against us and persecuted us, and that plotted against us, *that* we should be destroyed from remaining in any of the borders of Israel, [6]let seven men of his sons be delivered to us, and we will hang them up to the Lord in Gibeah of Saul, the chosen of the Lord." And the king said, "I will give them to you."

[21:7]And the king spared Mephibaal, the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, because of the Lord's oath that they had sworn between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul. [8]And the king took the two sons of Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, who she bore to Saul, Armoni and Mephibaal, and the five sons of Merab the daughter of Saul, who she bore to Adriel the son of Barzillai the Meholathite. [9]And he delivered them into the hands of the Gibeonites, and they hanged them in the mountain before the Lord, and the seven fell there together. And they were put to death in the days of Ziv, at the beginning of barley harvest.

[21:10]And Rizpah the daughter of Aiah the concubine of Saul took sackcloth, and spread it for her upon the rock, from the beginning of harvest until the water of God poured from heaven. And she did not allow the birds of the heavens to rest on them by day, nor the beasts of the field by night. [11]And it was told David all that Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done. [12]And David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of Jabesh-gilead, who had stolen them from the street of Beth-shan, where the Philistines had hanged them, in the day that the Philistines slew Saul in Gilboa. [13]And he brought the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son up from there, and they gathered the bones of those who were hanged, [14]and they buried the bones of Saul and Jonathan and the bones of those who were hanged in the country of Benjamin in Zela, in the sepulchre of Kish his father. And they performed all that the king commanded. And after that God atoned for the land.

[21:15]And the Philistines had war again with Israel, and David went down with his men and fought against the Philistines. And David grew faint, [16]and Dado the son of Joash, who was of the sons of the giant captured him; the weight of his spear was 300 shekels of brass in weight, he being clothed with armour, thought he would kill David. [17]And Abishai the son of Zeruiah saved David, and struck the Philistine, and killed him. Then the men of David promised, saying, "You shall not go out to battle with us any more, that you should not extinguish the lamp of Israel."

[21:18]And it happened after this, that there was again war with the Philistines at Gezer. Then Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Sippai, who was of the sons of the giant. [19]And there was again war with the Philistines at Gob, and Elhanan the son of Jaar killed Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the staff of whose spear was like a weaver's beam. [20]And there was again war at Gath with the Philistines, where there was a man of great stature, who had six fingers on every hand, and six toes on every foot, twenty four in number, and he also was born to the giant. [21]And when he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimeah, David's brother, killed him. [22]These four were born to the giant in Gath, and they fell by the hand of David, and by the hand of his servants.

Chapter 22

[22:1]And David spoke to the Lord the words of this song in the day that the Lord delivered him out of the hand of all his enemies, and out of the hand of Sheol. [2]And he said,"I have compassion on you." O Lord, my strength, The Lord is my rock, and my fortress, and my deliverer, even mine;

[22:3]My God, my rock, in him will I take refuge; My shield, and the horn of my salvation, my high tower, and my refuge; My saviour, he saves me from violent men, who is worthy to be praised.

[22:4]I will call upon the Lord, So shall I be saved from my enemies.

[22:5]For the cords of death were around me; The floods of ungodliness made me afraid.

[22:6]The cords of Sheol were around me; The snares of death came upon me.

[22:7]In my distress I called upon the Lord; Yes, I cried to my God: And he heard my voice out of his temple, And my cry *came* into his ears.

[22:8]Then the earth shook and trembled, The foundations of heaven quaked and were shaken, because he was angry.

[22:9]Smoke went up out of his nostrils, And fire out of his mouth devoured: coals were kindled by it.

[22:10]He bowed the heavens also, and came down; And thick darkness was under his feet.

[22:11]And he rode on a cherub, and he did fly; Yes, he sped on the wings of the wind.

[22:12]And he made darkness his hiding place, Canopies around him, darkness of waters, thick clouds of the skies.

22:13 At the brightness before him passed hailstones and coals of fire.
22:14 The Lord thundered from heaven, And the Most High uttered his voice.
22:15 And he sent out arrows, and scattered them; Lightnings, and discomfited them.
22:16 Then the channels of the sea appeared, The foundations of the world were laid bare, By the rebuke of the Lord, At the blast of his nostrils.
22:17 He sent from on high, he took me; He drew me out of many waters;
22:18 He delivered me from my enemies of strength, From those who hated me; for they were too mighty for me.
22:19 They came upon me in the day of my calamity; And the Lord was my stay.
22:20 He also brought me forth into a large place; He delivered me, because he delighted in me.
22:21 The Lord rewarded me according to my righteousness; According to the cleanness of my hands he has recompensed me.
22:22 For I have kept the ways of the Lord, And have not wickedly departed from my God.
22:23 For all his ordinances were before me; And I did not put away his statutes from me.
22:24 I was also blameless with him; And I kept myself from my iniquity.
22:25 And the Lord has recompensed me according to my righteousness, According to the cleanness of my hands in his eyes.
22:26 With the merciful you will show yourself merciful; With the perfect man you will show yourself perfect;
22:27 With the pure you will show yourself pure; And with the perverse you will show yourself astute.
22:28 For you will save the afflicted people; And you bring down haughty eyes.
22:29 For you light my lamp, O Lord; And the Lord my God will lighten my darkness.
22:30 For by you I run upon a troop; By my God I leap over a wall.
22:31 As for God, his way is perfect: The word of the Lord is tried; He is a shield to all those who take refuge in him.
22:32 For who is God, but the Lord? And who is a rock, but our God?
22:33 The God who girds me with strength, And sets my way blameless,
22:34 He makes my feet like those of hinds, And sets me upon my high places.
22:35 He teaches my hands to war, So that my arms bend a bow of brass.
22:36 You have also given me the shield of your salvation; And your right hand upholds me, And your condescension makes me great.
22:37 You have enlarged my steps under me; And my feet have not slipped.
22:38 I have pursued my enemies, and destroyed them; Neither did I turn again until they were consumed.
22:39 And I shattered them through, and they cannot arise: Yes, they have fallen under my feet.
22:40 For you have girded me with strength for the battle; You have subdued under me those who rose up against me.
22:41 And my enemies, you have given me their neck, That I might cut off those who hate me.
22:42 They cried for help, and there was none to save; Even to the Lord, and he did not answered them.
22:43 Then I beat them small as the dust before the wind; I emptied them out as the mire of the streets.
22:44 You have also delivered me from the strivings of the people; You have placed me to be the head of the nations: A people who I have not known shall serve me.
22:45 The foreigners shall submit themselves to me: As soon as they hear of me, they shall obey me.
22:46 The foreigners shall fade away, And shall come trembling out of their close places.
22:47 The Lord lives; and blessed be my rock; And exalted be God, the rock of my salvation,
22:48 Even the God who executes vengeance for me, And who subdues peoples under me,
22:49 And who brings me forth from my enemies: Yes, you lift me up above those who rise up against me; You deliver me from the violent man.
22:50 Therefore I will give thanks to you among the nations, O Lord, And will sing praises to your name.
22:51 He gives great deliverance to his king, And shows mercy to his anointed, To David and to his seed, for evermore.

Chapter 23

23:1 And these are the last words of David. David the son of Jesse says, And the man who God established says, The anointed of the God of Jacob, And the sweet psalmist of Israel:
23:2 The Spirit of the Lord spoke by me, And his word was upon my tongue.
23:3 The God of Jacob said, The Rock of Israel spoke by me: One who rules over men righteously, Who rules in the fear of God,
23:4 *He shall be* as the light of the morning, when the sun rises, A morning without clouds, *When* the tender grass *springs* out of the earth, Through clear shining after rain.
23:5 For is not my house so with God? For he has made an everlasting covenant To save me, until now, in all things; And he will keep it: For all those that are set against me he will not desire, For all those that grow like a thorn.
23:6 And those of belial[a] are, all of them, as a thorn of a fire, Because they cannot be taken with the hand;
23:7 Nor can a man touch them, Except with iron or wood: And burning,they shall be utterly burned with fire in their shame.
23:8 These are the names of the mighty men David had: Jeshbaal the son of a Hachmonite, chief of the three; he lifted up his spear against 900 killed at one time. 9 And after him was Eleazar the son of Dodai, one of the three mighty men. He was with David at Pasdammim when the Philistines were gathered together there to battle, and the men of Israel went up to meet them. 10 He rose, and struck the Philistines until his hand

[a] 23:6: "son of belial" or "daughter of belial" is a Hebrew idiom meaning 'worthless' or 'wicked'.

was weary, and his hand stuck to the sword. And the Lord
worked a great salvation that day, and the people returned af-
ter him only to take spoil. 11And after him was Shammah the
son of Agee a Hararite. And the Philistines were gathered to-
gether at Lehi, where there was a plot of ground full of lentils,
and the people fled from the Philistines. 12And he stood in the
middle of the plot, and defended it, and killed the Philistines.
And the Lord worked a great salvation that day.

23:13And three of the thirty chief men went down, and
came to the rock to David at the cave of Adullam, and
the troop of the Philistines was encamped in the valley of
Rephaim. 14And David was in the stronghold then, and the
garrison of the Philistines was in Bethlehem then. 15And
David longed, and said, "Oh that someone would give me
water to drink of the well of Bethlehem, which is by the gate!"
16And the three mighty men broke through the host of the
Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Bethlehem, that
was by the gate, and took it, and brought it to David. And
David would not drink of it, and poured it out to the Lord.
17And he said, "Far be it from me before the Lord, that I
should do this! Shall I drink the blood of the men who went
with their souls?" And he would not drink it. These things
the three mighty men did.

23:18And Abishai, the brother of Joab, the son of Zeruiah,
was chief of the thirty. And he lifted up his spear against
three hundred and killed them, and had a name among the
three. 19By the three he was honoured like two men, and he
was made their captain; and he did not attain to the three.

23:20And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant
man of Kabzeel, who had done mighty deeds, he killed the
two sons of Ariel of Moab. He also went down and killed a
lion in the middle of a pit in time of snow. 21And he killed
an Egyptian, a man of appearance. And the Egyptian had
a spear in his hand, and he went down to him with a staff,
and plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and killed
him with his own spear. 22These things Benaiah the son of
Jehoiada did, and had a name among the three mighty men.
23By the three he was honoured, and he did not attain to the
three. And David set him over his guard. And these are the
names of the mighty men of king David:

23:24Asahel the brother of Joab was one of the thirty, El-
hanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem, 25Shammah the Haro-
dite, Elika the Harodite, 26Helez the Pelonite, Ira the son of
Ikkesh the Tekoite, 27Abiezer the Anathothite, Sibbecai the
Hushathite, 28Zalmon the Ahohite, Maharai the Netophathite,
29Heldai the son of Baanah the Netophathite, Ittai the son of
Ribbai of Gibeah of the children of Benjamin, 30Benaiah a Pi-
rathonite, Hurai of the brooks of Gaash, 31Abiel the Arbathite,
Azmaveth the Bahurumite, 32Eliahba the Shaalbonite, Jashen
the Gunite, Jonathan the son of 33Shammah the Hararite,
Ahiam the son of Sachar the Hararite, 34Eliphelet the son of
Ahasbai the Mecherathite, Eliam the son of Ahithophel the
Gilonite, 35Hezro the Carmelite, Paarai the Arbite, 36Joel the
brother of Nathan of Zobah, Mibhar the son of Hagri, 37Zelek
the Ammonite, Naharai the Beerothite, the armour-bearer to
Joab the son of Zeruiah, 38Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite,
39Uriah the Hittite: thirty seven in all.

Chapter 24

24:1And the anger of God was kindled against Israel again,
and he moved David against them, saying, "Go, number Israel
and Judah." 2And the king said to Joab and to the captains
of the host who were with him in Jerusalem, "Go about now
through all Israel and Judah, from Dan even to Beer-sheba,
and number the people, and bring it to me that I may know
the sum of the people." 3And Joab said to the king, "And
may the Lord your God add to the people, however many
they may be, a hundredfold, and may the eyes of my lord the
king see it! And why does my lord the king delight in this
thing?" 4Nevertheless, the king's word defeated Joab and the
captains of the host. And Joab and the captains of the host
went out from the presence of the king, to number the people
of Israel.

24:5And they passed over the Jordan, and began from
Aroer, and from the city that is in the middle of the valley of
Gad, and to Jazer. 6Then they came to Gilead, and to Kadesh
of the Hittites, and they came to Dan, and they went around
Sidon, 7and came to the stronghold of Tyre, and to all the cities
of the Hivites, and of the Canaanites, and they went out to
the south of Judah, at Beer-sheba. 8And when they had gone
about through all the land, they came to Jerusalem at the end
of nine months and twenty days. 9And Joab gave up the sum
of the numbering of the people to the king. And there were
in Israel 900,000 men who drew the sword, and the men of
Judah were 400,000 men who drew the sword.

24:10And David's heart struck him after he had numbered
the people. And David said to the Lord, "I have sinned
greatly in this thing that I have done. And now, O Lord,
please put away the iniquity of your servant, for I have done
very foolishly." 11And when David rose up in the morn-
ing, the word of the Lord came to Gad, David's seer, say-
ing, 12"Go and speak to David, 'Thus says the Lord, "I of-
fer you three things, choose one of them, that I may do it to
you."'" 13And Gad came to David, and told him, and said to
him, "Choose for yourself: shall three years of famine come to
you in your land, or will you run away from your enemies for
three months while they pursue you, or shall there be three
days' pestilence in the land? And now consider and see what
answer I shall return to him who sent me." 14And David said
to Gad, "I am in great distress! Only now let me fall into the
hand of the Lord, for his mercies are great, and do not let me
fall into the hand of man." And David chose the pestilence,
and in the days of the wheat harvest,

24:15the Lord gave a pestilence on Israel from the morn-
ing even to the time of nourishment. And the plague caused
sickness among the people, and 70,000 men of the people died
from Dan even to Beer-sheba. 16And when the angel stretched
out his hand toward Jerusalem to destroy it, the Lord re-
pented of the evil, and said to the angel who destroyed the
people, "It is enough. Now hold back your hand." And the
angel of the Lord was by the threshing-floor of Araunah the
Jebusite. And David lifted up his eyes, and saw the angel of
the Lord standing between earth and heaven, with a drawn
sword in his hand stretched out over Jerusalem. And David
and the elders, covered in sackcloth, fell on their faces.

24:17And David spoke to the Lord when he saw the angel
who struck the people, and said, "Behold, it is I who have
sinned. And it is I, the shepherd, who have done wrong. And
these sheep, what have they done? Please let your hand be
against me and against my father's house."

[24:18] And Gad came to David that day, and said, "Go up,
raise an altar to the Lord in the threshing-floor of Araunah
the Jebusite." [19] And David went up as Gad had said, as the
Lord commanded. [20] And Araunah looked out, and saw the
king and his servants approaching him, and Araunah went
out and bowed himself before the king with his face to the
ground. [21] And Araunah said, "Why has my lord the king
come to his servant?" And David said to him, "To buy the
threshing-floor from you, to build an altar to the Lord, that
the plague may be stopped from the people." [22] And Araunah
said to David, "Let my lord the king take and offer up what is
good in his eyes. Behold, the oxen for the burnt-offering, and
the threshing instruments and the yokes of the oxen for the
wood. [23] All this, O king, Araunah gives to the king." And
Araunah said to the king, "May the Lord your God accept
you." [24] And the king said to Araunah, "No, for I will surely
buy it from you at a price. Neither will I offer burnt-offerings
to the Lord my God which cost me nothing." And David
bought the threshing-floor and the oxen for fifty shekels of
silver.

[24:25] And David built an altar to the Lord there, and offered
burnt-offerings and peace-offerings. And Solomon added to
the altar later, for it was small at first. And the Lord was en-
treated for the land, and the plague was stayed from Israel.

Samuel, Saul and David, Third part called First Kings

Chapter 1

1:1 And king David was very old and stricken in days, and they covered him with clothes, and he had no heat. 2 And his servants said to him, "Let a young woman be sought for my lord the king, and let her stand before the king, and cherish him, and let her lie in his bosom, that the king may have heat." 3 And they sought for a beautiful young woman throughout all Israel, and found Abishag the Shunammite, and brought her to the king. 4 And the young woman was very beautiful to look on, and she cherished the king, and served him, and the king did not know her.

1:5 Then Adonijah the son of David exalted himself, saying, "I will be king." And he prepared chariots and horsemen for himself, and fifty men to run before him. 6 And his father had not grieved him at any time by saying, "Why have you done so?" And he was also a very well formed man to look on, and he was born after Abishalom. 7 And he conferred with Joab the son of Zeruiah and with Abiathar the priest, and they followed Adonijah and helped him. 8 And Zadok the priest, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and Nathan the prophet, and Shimei, and Rei, and David's mighty men, were not with Adonijah.

1:9 And Adonijah killed oxen and sheep by the stone of Zoheleth which is beside En-rogel. And he called all his brothers, the king's sons, and the men of Judah, David the king's servants. 10 And he did not call Nathan, or Benaiah, or the mighty men, or Solomon.

1:11 Then Nathan came and spoke to Bath-sheba the mother of Solomon, saying, "Haven't you heard that Adonijah the son of Haggith reigns, and David our lord does not know it? 12 And now come, please let me give you counsel, that you may save your own life and the life of your son Solomon. 13 Go and get yourself in to king David, and say to him, 'Didn't you, my lord, O king, promise by the Lord God to your handmaid, saying, "Surely Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne?" Why then does Adonijah reign?' 14 While you are still talking with the king there, I will also come in after you, and confirm your words."

1:15 And Bath-sheba went in to the king in the chamber. And the king was very old, and Abishag the Shunammite was serving the king. 16 And Bath-sheba bowed, and did obeisance to the king. And the king said, "What do you want?" 17 And she said to him, "My lord, O king, you promised by the Lord your God to your handmaid, saying, 'Surely Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne.' 18 And now, behold, Adonijah reigns, and you, my lord the king, do not know it. 19 And he has killed many sheep and oxen and has called all the sons of the king, and Abiathar the priest, and Joab the captain of the host. 20 And you, my lord the king, the eyes of all the people are on you, that you should tell them who shall sit on the throne of my lord the king after him. 21 Otherwise it will happen, when my lord the king shall sleep with his fathers, that I and my son Solomon shall be counted sinners."

1:22 And, behold, while she was still talking with the king, Nathan the prophet came in. 23 And they told the king, saying, "Behold, Nathan the prophet." And when he had come in before the king, he bowed himself before David the king with his face to the ground. 24 And he said, "My lord, O king, have you said, 'Adonijah shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne?' 25 For he has gone down this day, and has killed many oxen and sheep, and has called all the king's sons, and Joab the captain of the host, and Abiathar the priest, and, behold, they are eating and drinking before him, and say, 'May king Adonijah live!' 26 And he has not called me, even me your servant, or Zadok the priest, or Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, or your son Solomon. 27 And has this thing been done by my lord the king, and you have not shown your servant who should sit on the throne of my lord the king after him?"

1:28 Then David answered and said, "Call to me Bath-sheba." And she came and stood before the king. 29 And the king promised, and said, "As the Lord lives who has redeemed my soul out of all adversity, 30 surely as I promised to you by the Lord, the God of Israel, saying, 'Surely Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne in my place,' I will truly do so this day." 31 Then Bath-sheba bowed with her face to the earth, and did obeisance to the king, and said, "Let my lord king David live for ever."

1:32 And the king said, "Call to me Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada." And they came before the king. 33 And the king said to them, "Take with you the servants of your lord, and make Solomon my son ride on my own mule, and bring him down to Gihon. 34 And let Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet anoint him there king over Israel. And blow the trumpet, and say, "May king Solomon live!" 35 Then you shall come up after him, and he shall come and sit on my throne, for he shall be king in my place. And I have appointed him to be prince over Israel and over Judah." 36 And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada answered the king, and said, "Amen! Thus may the Lord, the God of my lord the king, confirm *it*. 37 And as the Lord has been with my lord, even so may he be with Solomon, and make his throne greater than the throne of my lord king David."

1:38 And Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites and the Pelethites, went down, and made Solomon ride on king David's mule, and went after him to Gihon. 39 And Zadok the priest took the horn of oil out of the tent, and anointed Solomon. And they blew the trumpet, and all the people said, "May king Solomon live!" 40 And all the people came up after him, and all the people piped with pipes, and rejoiced with great joy, and the earth shook with the sound of them.

1:41 And Adonijah and all the guests who were with him heard it as they had finished eating. And when Joab heard the sound of the trumpet, he said, "What is the reason for this noise of the city being in an uproar?" 42 While he was still speaking, behold, Jonathan the son of Abiathar the priest. And Adonijah said to him, "Come in, for you are a worthy man, and bring good news."

1:43 And Jonathan answered and said to Adonijah, "Surely
our lord king David has made Solomon king. 44 And he has
sent with him Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet,
and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites and
the Pelethites. And they have made him ride on the king's
mule. 45 And Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet have
anointed him in Gihon, and they have come up from there
rejoicing, and the land rang again. This is the noise that you
have heard. 46 And also Solomon sits on the throne of the king-
dom. 47 And also the king's servants came to bless our lord
king David, and they came, saying, 'May your God make the
name of Solomon better than your name, and make his throne
greater than your throne.' And the king bowed himself on
his bed. 48 And also the king said thus, 'Blessed be the Lord,
the God of Israel, who has given one of my seed to sit on my
throne this day, my eyes even seeing it.'"

1:49 And all the guests of Adonijah were afraid, and rose up,
and every man went his way. 50 And Adonijah feared because
of king Solomon, and he arose and went to the tent of the
Lord and caught hold on the horns of the altar. 51 And it was
told Solomon, saying, "Behold, Adonijah fears king Solomon,
for behold, he has laid hold of the horns of the altar, saying,
'Let Solomon promise to me first that he will not kill his ser-
vant with the sword.'" 52 And Solomon said, "If he shall show
himself to be a worthy man, not a hair of his head shall fall
to the earth. And if wickedness is found in him, he shall die."
53 And Solomon sent, and they brought him down from the al-
tar. And he came and bowed down to Solomon, and Solomon
said to him, "Go to your house."

Chapter 2

2:1 And the days drew near for David to die, and he charged
Solomon his son before his death, saying, 2 "I am going the
way of all the earth. And you be strong, and show yourself a
man, 3 and keep the charge of the God of Israel, to walk in his
ways, to keep his statutes, his commandments, and his ordi-
nances, and his testimonies, according to that which is written
in the law of Moses, that you may prosper in all that you do,
and where-ever you turn yourself, 4 that the Lord may estab-
lish his word which he spoke concerning me, saying, 'If your
children take heed to their ways, to walk before me in truth
with all their heart and with all their soul, you shall not fail to
have a man on the throne of Israel.'

2:5 "And also, you know also what Joab the son of Zeruiah
did to me, even what he did to the two captains of the hosts of
Israel, to Abiner the son of Ner, and to Amasa the son of Jether,
who he killed, and avenged the blood of war in peace. And
he put innocent blood on the belt that was about my waist,
and on my shoes that were on my feet. 6 And do according to
your wisdom, and do not let his grey hair go down to Sheol in
peace. 7 And show kindness to the sons of Barzillai the Gilea-
dite, and let them be among those who eat at your table, for
so they came to me when I fled from Abishalom your brother.

2:8 "And, behold, Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite, of
Bahurim, who cursed me with a grievous curse in the day
when I went to Mahanaim, and he came down to meet me
at the Jordan, and I promised to him by the Lord, saying, 'I
will not put you to death with the sword.' 9 And as for you, do
not hold him guiltless, for you are a wise man, and you will
know what you ought to do to him, and you shall bring his
grey hair down to Sheol with blood."

2:10 And David slept with his fathers, and was buried in the
city of David. 11 And the days that David reigned over Israel
were forty years. He reigned seven years in Hebron, and he
reigned thirty three years in Jerusalem.

Concordance

This is not an exhaustive concordance. Words such as prepositions, conjunctions, articles, etc. that are of little value here are excluded.

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